THY KINGDOM COME

VOLUME TWO

The People

A character and scripture companion for the drafting and revision of the novel. One dossier for everyone who matters in the 39th Trial, with room to find out who they are.

DANY · OCTOBER 2026

NOTES

ANYTHING THIS SPREAD STARTED AND DID NOT FINISH

VOLUME TWO

Contents

Five parts and the back matter. Each part opens with its own contents, and every dossier opens with a portrait.

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What this volume is

Volume One is the world: the scripture the Empire inherited, the history it rewrote, and the institutions, Dominions and Trials it built. This volume is the people who have to live inside all of that. It holds one dossier for every character with weight in the 39th Trial, from the woman at the kitchen table in Aurelia's outer districts to the man on the throne who taught himself never to be surprised.

A dossier here does what an entry in Volume One's people of the text does. It starts from what the files already say, keeps that separate from what's only inferred, and leaves most of the page ruled for you. The difference is that these people are yours. Nothing in a dossier outranks the manuscript, and where your files disagree with each other the page says so out loud instead of quietly picking a winner. Every major character gets a faith and scripture spread. It covers what they believe and who taught it to them, what the Temple teaches about someone like them, the biblical name or story they echo and where the echo breaks, the verses they'd quote and the ones nobody has ever read to them, and the exact pages in Volume One to go back to. The novel's religious line runs between faith the Temple can use and faith that answers to something it doesn't control. Every person in this book stands somewhere on that line, and the faith spread is where you find out where.

WHAT IT ISN'T

It won't replace a cast list or a plot summary, and it won't answer anything for you. Where the files are silent the page is ruled, and the ruled space outranks anything printed near it.

VOLUME ONE PAGES

Cross-references give the folio in Volume One, so "Vol. I, 393" means page 393 of The World Dossier, where Hannah, Abigail and Michal are.

MARGINALIA

✤ *See also:* Volume One, the people of the text, page 369.

"Belief has a cost and a teacher." Rule IV, from Volume One.

How a dossier works

Every dossier opens with a portrait page, a frame for a drawing, a reference image or Canva art, and the person's record underneath it. After that the pages run in the same order for everyone at the same length, so you can read across the cast and see where the Empire holds and where it's already coming apart.

THE FULL DOSSIER, ABOUT SIXTEEN PAGES

1. The portrait and the record.
2. The Registry card and every name they answer to.
3. The years, set against the Empire's calendar.
4. Standing, the clerk's version and the true one.
5. Faith and scripture, what they believe and who taught it.
6. Faith and scripture, the text: the name, the verses, Volume One.
7. Body and fear, belief arc, power and people, voice and contradiction.
8. The working pages: the machinery around them, one excavated scene, one ordinary hour, one relationship from both sides, and a scene lab.

THE SHORTER DOSSIERS

Thomas, Zion, Solomon, the House Aurem staff, Senior Minister Bell and the Prelate get about seven pages each, with the faith spread pressed onto a single page. Each Covenant Daughter gets about eight, with a page tracking her through the three phases.

THE ONE RULE

No character gets a belief they've never paid for. If the creed page names a conviction, the contradiction page has to name what it cost.

PHOTOCOPY FIRST

The working pages expect a second and third draft. Copy them before you fill them.

MARGINALIA

✤ *See also:* The labels, on the next page.

VOL. I · 6–7

Labels and sources

The page signals are the ones in Volume One. Quoted scripture sits behind a fine rule with its reference underneath. The heavy frame with the pink edge is always the Empire's reading and never the text's. A broken frame marks a real dispute among serious readers. Ruled space is yours.

LABEL	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
(NO LABEL)	Your files say it, with the source tag in parentheses. Scripture and history with a reference are research, as in Volume One.
INTERPRETATION	A reading of a character or a passage, offered as a reading
CONTESTED	A real dispute about scripture among scholars or traditions
INFERENCE	A conclusion drawn from your files that they don't state
POSSIBLE	An idea worth considering, and not canon
OPEN QUESTION	Something only you can decide
CONFLICT	Two of your files disagree
SUPERSEDED	Older material that no longer controls
DECIDED	A call you've made. Canon from here on.

TAG	SOURCE
FR 0–44	Final Rulings. These outrank everything.
TL · TR · DOM · MEN · CR	Timeline · Trials · Dominions · Men in the Empire · The Crownward
DR3 · WR · AM	Draft Three (chapter one) · Writing Rules · the old Companion
RULING	A call you've made in conversation, logged in the back of this volume

The cast at a glance

TKC: TL · TR · MEN · CR · FR 0 · FR 11 · RULING

Ages are at the opening of the 39th Trial, summer 2104.

NAME	WHO	AGE	DOSSIER
CELESTE PARISH	Eden's grandmother, Unbound, head of household	69	I · full
EDEN SELAH OSEI	Covenant Daughter of Aurem	21	I · full
MIRIAM OSEI	Eden's mother, gone since 2090	42	I · full
THOMAS OSEI	Eden's father, gone since 2084		I · short
LEAH OSEI	Eden's younger sister, a Commonwife	20	I · full
ZION OSEI	Eden's brother, labor track	18	I · short
SOLOMON OSEI	Eden's youngest brother	16	I · short
HANNAH	House Mother, House Aurem		II · full
NAOMI	Hannah's daughter, in Vowed education		II · full
MIRIELLE · GAVIN · ABIGAIL	Coordinator · stylist · Debate and Protocol Advisor		II · short
SENIOR MINISTER BELL	The Aurelia Temple		II · short

DECIDED Zion is eighteen (**Ruling**) and Solomon is sixteen. Miriam's age follows from her birth in 2062 (**TL**). The blanks are yours.

TKC: TR · TL · CR · RULING · FR 33

THE CAST AT A GLANCE, CONTINUED

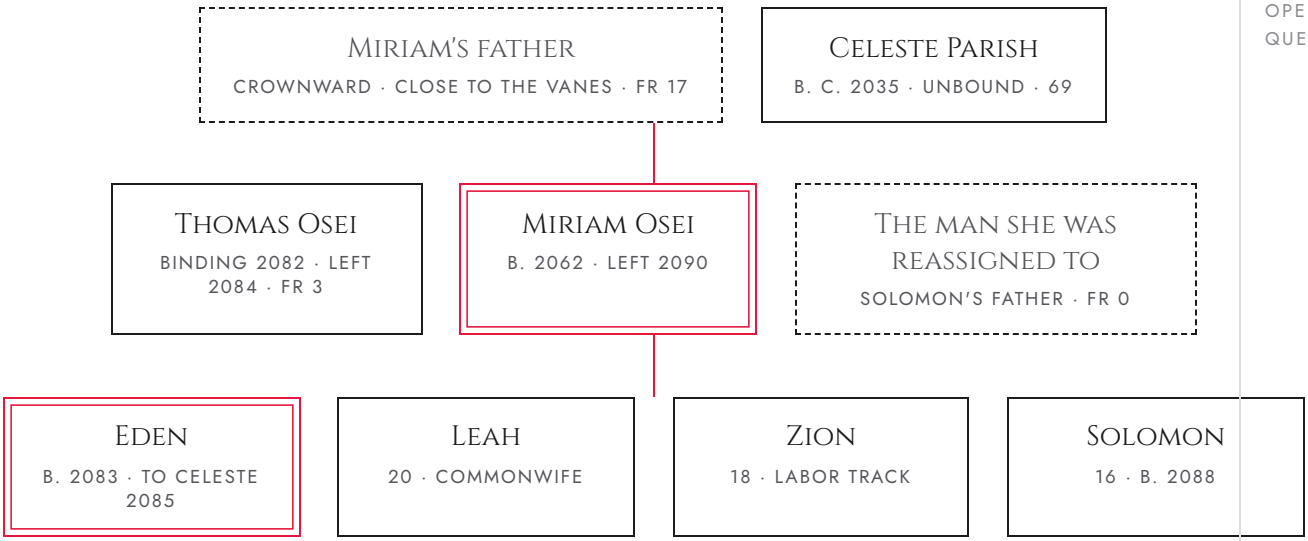
NAME	WHO	AGE	DOSSIER
DELPHINE FONTENOT	Gulf · Port Seraphine	22	III
MAREN COLE	Ardenne · Ashford	23	III
CORINNE VALE	Meridian · Blessed Shore	22	III
CALLA MERRITT	Vane · Saint Meridian	21	III
NADIA ORIN	Irongate · Iron Benediction	20	III
RUTH GIDEON	Heartland · Providence Cross	22	III
DELIA CROSS	Red Earth · Canaan's Gate	24	III
VIVIENNE HALE	Lone · Covenant Basin	23	III
PETRA SOLANO	Mountain · Crestfall	22	III
ZARA VOSS	Sable · Sable Reach	21	III
SERA MONTOYA	Pacific · Westhold	24	III
DORIAN VANE	Emperor since 2085	59	IV · full
LYRIS VANE	Empress, from Mountain	58	IV · full
JUDAH ELIJAH VANE	Crown Heir	25	IV · full
AZRAEL VANE	"Deceased" since 2100	27	IV · full
THE PRELATE	Head of the Crownward Vowed	67	IV · short

Calla's surname is Merritt (**Ruling**). The Prelate's working name is Aurelia, which is POSSIBLE, and she's never Huldah or Naomi (**FR 33**).

The household, drawn

TKC: TL · FR 0 · FR 3 · FR 4–5 · FR 17 · MEN

OPEN QUESTION



Eden went to Celeste alone in 2085. Leah, Zion and Solomon came together in 2090, when Miriam left (**FR 4–5**). Celeste's reclassification absorbed all four as her dependents (**FR 2, 10**). **INFERENCE** Leah was born in 2084 and Zion in 2085. Zion was conceived before Thomas left and born after (**FR 0**), which fits eighteen if his birthday falls after chapter one.

WHO ELSE BELONGS ON THIS TREE: CELESTE'S MOTHER, HER GRANDMOTHER, LEAH'S HUSBAND, THE THREE CELESTE BURIED

FINAL RULINGS

RULING

DECIDED

The canon this volume runs on

Every dossier was written against these. Where a file disagrees, the page prints the file's version as SUPERSEDED and moves on.

RULING	WHAT IT FIXES
FR 0	Solomon's father is the man Miriam was reassigned to after Thomas left. Zion is Thomas's.
FR 3	Thomas left voluntarily in 2084, for another Dominion, another woman, another life.
FR 4–6	Eden went to Celeste alone in 2085. The younger three came in 2090. Miriam left all four and went alone.
FR 11–16	What each child saw on the day she left, what they were told, and the 2094 letter nobody received. Celeste has no proof Miriam is alive.
FR 17–18	Miriam's father, his household, and why she came back
FR 19–25	What the Trials do with all twelve women, and the rules around the Declaration
FR 26–34	Hannah's career, Naomi, the 2085 cohort, and the Prelate's name
FR 35–44	The House of Vane, the removed heir, and the documents
RULING	Zion is eighteen. Solomon is sixteen. Leah is younger than Eden and sat for an assessment. Dorian is fifty-nine. Calla's surname is Merritt.

Every ruling is printed in full in the back matter, with the conflicts it settles.

Where the faith pages point

VOL. I · 382 · 417 · 509–518 · 521–530

Each faith spread ends with a box of Volume One pages. These are the ones the cast comes back to most.

FOR	GO TO VOLUME ONE
A CHARACTER'S BIBLICAL NAME	The names in the cast, 417, and echoes, labeled, 419
THE WOMEN THEY'RE COMPARED TO	The people of the text, from Eve on 383
THE MEN THEY'RE COMPARED TO	The founders, 397. David, 399. Kingmakers, prophets and priests, 400.
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES	The official religion, 494. The founding texts, 496.
WHAT PEOPLE ACTUALLY PRACTICE	Lived religion, 513–518
WHERE A WOMAN SITS	The designations, 506. Being sorted, 508. The Binding, 510.
THE HOUSEHOLD ON PAPER	Commonwives and the Arrangement, 512. Four households, 514.
A MAN'S PLACE	Men, labor and the economy, 507
THE PRAYER THE BOOK IS NAMED FOR	The Lord's Prayer, from 428
PASSAGES THE EMPIRE USES AND BURIES	Passages put to work, 440. Passages kept quiet, 442.
A CHARACTER'S HOME	The twelve Dominions, 536–555

THE VOLUME ONE PAGE I KEEP GOING BACK TO WHILE I DRAFT, AND WHY

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE VOLUME ONE PAGE I KEEP GOING BACK TO WHILE I DRAFT, AND WHY

Before you begin

YOURS

Answer these once, in ink, before you open a single dossier. The point is a record of where you started with these people.

THE CHARACTER I UNDERSTAND LEAST, AND WHAT I'M AFRAID I'LL FIND

THE CHARACTER I'D DEFEND TO ANYONE, AND THE ONE I'D NEVER FORGIVE

WHO IN THIS BOOK BELIEVES MOST HONESTLY, AND WHO BELIEVES MOST USEFULLY

DECIDED **DATE**

NOTES

ANYTHING THIS SPREAD STARTED AND DID NOT FINISH

I

PART ONE · ◈

The Parish Household

One small house in Aurelia's outer district, a grandmother on the authority line in all but name, and four children who arrived in two waves.

i · The household as a teaching	016
Celeste Parish	020
Eden Selah Osei	043
Miriam Osei	065
Thomas Osei	084
Leah Osei	089
Zion Osei	103
Solomon Osei	108
Working questions for the household	113

TL | MEN | FR 0–18

THE TWO WAVES

2085, Eden alone, about two years old. 2090, Leah, Zion and Solomon together, after Miriam left (FR 4–5).

THE HOUSEHOLD ON PAPER

Unbound, reclassified after six years, with a young man on the authority line (Vol. I, 529).

MARGINALIA

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the household on paper, 529. Aurem, 536.

The household as a teaching

Everything Eden carries into the Crownward was assembled in one house, and most of it at one kitchen table. Celeste taught there. Leah comes back to it twice a week to breathe. Zion signs the forms that come to it, and Solomon is being coached at it on how much of his own mind to show. Miriam left it, and Thomas never lived in it (TL, MEN, FR 4–5).

The Empire reads this household as a set of failures on paper: an Unbound woman with no husband, a mother whose registration was deactivated, a father who relocated, a daughter under Temple review. Read the same facts from inside the house and they're a faith that has survived an institution by never handing it everything. The dossiers in this part are written from inside the house. They're also written after the Final Rulings, which changed this family more than any other. Thomas left voluntarily, and the paperwork that said so was accurate (FR 3). Celeste has no proof Miriam is alive (FR 16). Eden grew up as Celeste's child, and the younger three remember arriving into a house that was already running (FR 5). Solomon's father is someone else (FR 0). Any older page that says otherwise is SUPERSEDED.

THE DAY SHE LEFT

TKC: FR 11–15 · TL

CONTENT NOTE A mother leaving her children. Nothing graphic.

Four children were in or near the house when Miriam left in 2090, and each kept a different piece of it. The rulings fix what each one has.

CHILD	AGE THEN	WHAT THEY HAVE	SOURCE
EDEN	7	Being given a task, to take Zion outside. Fourteen years understanding that the task was to get her out of the room.	FR 11, 13
LEAH	6	She watched her pack. She remembers a decision more than a disappearance, which is why she's the angriest and why she defends Miriam to the others.	FR 11, 14
ZION	4	The yard. He's never mentioned it.	FR 11, 13
SOLOMON	2	Nothing he can know is his own	FR 11

WHAT THEY WERE TOLD	"She's coming back." It held about a year, then stopped being said, and nothing ever replaced it (**FR 12**).
WHY NOBODY HEARD	Being unreachable wasn't selective. No version existed where she was hidden from her father and available to her children (**FR 15**).
THE LETTER	One attempt, in 2094, intercepted before it reached Celeste. Celeste never knew it existed. Who intercepted it is still open (**FR 16**).

THE FIRST EVENING THE THREE OF THEM SPENT IN CELESTE'S HOUSE, AND WHO COOKED

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE FIRST EVENING THE THREE OF THEM SPENT IN CELESTE'S HOUSE, AND WHO COOKED

The household's years

TKC: TL · MEN · FR 0 · FR 3–5 · FR 16 · RULING

YEAR	IN THE HOUSE	SOURCE
c. 2035	Celeste born. She's about nine in 2044 when the signs change.	TL
2062	Miriam born to Celeste, who raises her alone, Unbound	TL
2071	Celeste settles in Aurelia for good after years moving between Dominions	TL
2082	Miriam, twenty, is Bound to Thomas Osei as a Commonwife	TL, FR 1
2083	Eden born, Celeste present	TL
2084	Leah born. Thomas leaves, voluntarily. Miriam reassigned to another man's household.	FR 0, FR 3, INFERENCE
2085	Zion born. Eden goes to Celeste, alone.	FR 0, FR 4, INFERENCE
2088	Solomon born to the man Miriam was reassigned to	FR 0, FR 11
2090	Miriam leaves. Leah, Zion and Solomon come to Celeste. The reclassification is filed.	TL, FR 5
2094	Miriam's one letter, intercepted	FR 16
2096	The reclassification is approved. Celeste doesn't speak for three days.	TL
2101	Eden designates, highest score in Aurem's history, and is flagged	TL
2102	Leah Bound, at eighteen	MEN, INFERENCE
2103	Zion's Speaking and Covenant Declaration, at eighteen	MEN, Ruling
2104	Eden self-nominates, places first, and leaves for the Crownward	TL, TR

CONFLICT The timeline has Miriam born "in Aurelia" in 2062 and Celeste settling there in 2071.
INFERENCE Both hold if Celeste was in the city in 2062 without settling.

TKC: TL · DR3 · DOM · AM

VOL. I · 482 · 513 · 529

PORTRAIT · CELESTE PARISH · SIXTY-NINE · DRAW, PASTE OR PIN

PART I · DOSSIER 1 · ◈

CELESTE

Everything Eden knows about faith she learned at this woman's kitchen table. Everything she knows about hiding she learned there too, and only one of those was taught on purpose.

ON THE RECORD

Celeste Parish, sixty-nine. Unbound her whole life. Head of a reclassified household in Aurelia's outer district, and the oldest person in the cast (**TL**). About nine when they changed the signs.

STILL OPEN

Where she was born, who Miriam's father is to her, the three people she's buried the old way, and the second name she gave Eden.

The Registry card

TKC: TL · DR3 · FR 2 · FR 10

VOL. I · 505 · 529

Household Record

REGISTRY · AUREM · H-1

AS THE MINISTRY HOLDS IT · RECLASSIFIED 2096

NAME OF RECORD	*PARISH, Celeste*
DESIGNATION	*Unbound · held for life · no Binding on record*
BORN	*c. 2035 (INFERENCE from her age)*
RESIDENCE	*Aurelia, outer district · settled 2071*
HOUSEHOLD	*single-family unit, under her registration*
DEPENDENTS	*Eden, Leah, Zion, Solomon Osei, entered 2085 and 2090*
ADULT MALE AUTHORITY	*"deceased" · returned circled · Zion Osei*

UNBOUND

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HER
MOTHER PARISH	Minister Bell, the Temple	Respect she didn't ask for, from an institution she doesn't trust (**DR3**)
GRANDMAMA	The children	The only title she earned instead of survived (**DR3**)
HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD	The Ministry, since 2096	Six years of paperwork to be called this on one line (**TL**)

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE NAME HER OWN MOTHER CALLED HER, AND THE LAST PERSON ALIVE WHO USES IT

Her years against the Empire's

TKC: TL · DOM · DR3 · FR 4 · FR 16–17

VOL. I · 475 · 482

YEAR	AGE	HER LIFE	THE EMPIRE THAT YEAR
c. 2035	0	Born. Where is open.	Elias wins his Senate seat
2044	9	Watches her own grandmother cry when the signs change (TL)	The Dominion Act. Atlanta becomes Aurelia.
		Her mother taken through a Commonwife marriage (TL)	
2062	27	Miriam born. Raised alone, Unbound (TL).	Crest takes the throne. Quotas go Empire-wide.
2071	36	Settles in Aurelia for good (TL)	
2082	47	Performs the Salt Ceremony the night before Miriam's Binding (DOM)	
2085	50	Takes Eden, about two (TL, FR 4)	Crest dies. Dorian takes the throne.
2090	55	Miriam leaves. Three more children arrive. She files. (TL)	
2096	61	Reclassification approved. Three days without speaking. (TL)	
2101	66	Eden's score. She holds still, then goes back to the stove (TL)	
2104	69	The ten dollars, the cleared shelf, the real name of the city (DR3, TL)	The 39th Trial

INFERENCE She's about nine in 2044, so born around 2035, and the timeline's "mid thirties" in 2071 agrees.

THE YEAR SHE NEVER TALKS ABOUT, AND WHY

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE YEAR SHE NEVER TALKS ABOUT, AND WHY

The clerk's version and the true one

TKC: TL · DR3 · DOM

VOL. I · 505 · 521 · 529

ON THE LEDGER	Unbound, sixty-nine, head of a single-family household in the outer district. Never Bound, so never widowed in law. A woman with no husband, no office and no standing beyond what the reclassification granted her in writing (**TL**).
IN THE WIDOWS' ROW	She sits in the row reserved for widows at Temple, and nobody has ever asked her to move. Minister Bell has known her thirty-four years, eaten her sweet potato pie at harvest suppers, and called every winter when the Temple needed coats repaired. He greets her with both hands out. She looks at their joined hands and answers "Morning," and he keeps smiling (**DR3**).
THE SIX-YEAR FILING	When Miriam left in 2090 she filed to reclassify the household under her own registration. Approval took six years, because she had to prove the arrangement was permanent, which meant proving her daughter wasn't coming back. She put on her one good blouse, went downtown, and said what she needed to say (**TL**).
THE AUTHORITY LINE	A form for Solomon came demanding an adult male authority. She wrote "deceased" on the line. It came back with the word circled and a request for the next adult male, and Zion, at eighteen, signed. She hadn't wanted him to (**DR3**).
INFERENCE	She has no office, no money and no husband, and she may be the most powerful person in her district.

WHAT THIS HOUSEHOLD LIVES ON, WHO EARNS IT, AND WHAT IT DOESN'T COVER

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT THIS HOUSEHOLD LIVES ON, WHO EARNS IT, AND WHAT IT DOESN'T COVER

What She Believes

TKC: DOM · DR3 · TL · AM · FR 16

VOL. I · 509 · 513 · 518

Celeste is the most religious person in the book and the least Imperial (AM). Those don't pull against each other for her, and the pages where a reader feels that are the engine of the Parish house.

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	INFERENCE Keep part of yourself unregistered. It's what the salt water is for, what the second name is for, and what "morning" is instead of an answer. Faith can survive an institution by not handing it everything.
WHO TAUGHT HER	OPEN QUESTION Her grandmother, who cried at the signs (TL), or her mother, who lost her name to a Commonwife marriage? The files don't say who first put scripture in her hands.
WHAT SHE CAN RECITE	All of it, including the Covenant of Purpose (AM). INFERENCE Fluency is her camouflage.
WHAT SHE TRUSTS WHEN FRIGHTENED	Her hands. She prays from the moment they leave the house, thumb against her first knuckle, one tap per petition (DR3). When Eden paid the ten dollars she didn't pray about it. She cleared a shelf (DR3).
WHAT SHE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	The Salt Ceremony, which the Empire doesn't know exists, and burying the dead the old way (DOM). The real name of the city, said out loud to Eden the night before she leaves (TL).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

An Unbound woman is "difficult and surveilled" (TL), and every household form asks for a man (DR3). POSSIBLE The Temple seats her in the widows' row and preaches 1 Timothy 5.5, the "widow indeed" who "trusteth in God, and continueth in supplications and prayers." It honors her and files her in one gesture, without ever saying she was never anyone's widow.

SUPERSEDED An earlier round had Celeste knowing Miriam was alive and hiding it. She has no proof Miriam is alive (FR 16), so her silence about her daughter is grief with no information in it.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE ONE PIECE OF IMPERIAL DOCTRINE SHE HALF BELIEVES, AND HATES THAT SHE DOES

The text

HER NAME	*Celeste* is from the Latin *caelestis*, "heavenly." It has no biblical source. She's the only person in the house without scripture in her name, and the one who taught the others theirs.
LOIS · 2 TIMOTHY 1.5	**POSSIBLE** Paul names Timothy's grandmother: the "unfeigned faith... which dwelt first in thy grandmother Lois." A grandmother's faith passed down a household. **Where it breaks:** Lois's faith is honored by an apostle in writing. Celeste's is kept off every record on purpose.
NAOMI · RUTH 1–4	**POSSIBLE** A woman who's buried what she loved and sends the younger one where the future is. **Where it breaks:** Naomi sends Ruth to a man. Celeste sends Eden toward one and arms her against him in the same sentence (TL).
RIZPAH · 2 SAMUEL 21	**POSSIBLE** She guards the bodies of her sons on a rock from harvest until rain, until the king buries them properly. Celeste has buried three people the old way (DOM). **Where it breaks:** Rizpah's vigil is public and shames a king. Celeste's is arranged so no king ever hears of it.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER IN THE TEMPLE
"Ye are the salt of the earth" (Matt 5.13), at a Salt Ceremony	Isaiah 10.1–2, woe to those who decree unrighteous decrees "that widows may be their prey"
"How shall we sing the LORD's song in a strange land?" (Ps 137.4)	Luke 18.1–8, the widow who wears down a judge who "feared not God, neither regarded man"
"Pray to thy Father which is in secret" (Matt 6.6)	

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Ruth and Naomi, 391 and 109. The unnamed, and two widows, 388. The women who ran things, with the widows of Acts 6, 395. Deuteronomy 6, the household is the school, 334. Lived religion and the Salt Ceremony, 498. Faith that isn't performance, 503. Living memory, 467.

2 TIM 1.5

RUTH 1–4

2 SAM 21.8–14

MATT 5.13

PS 137.4

MATT 6.6

ISA 10.1–2

LUKE 18.1–8

TKC: DR3 · TL · DOM

Body and fear

Sixty-nine years of holding still in rooms that were assessing her. The manuscript already knows what that looks like.

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	A cane she didn't need last summer. This year she says people move faster when you carry one, and both reasons are true (**DR3**). Back straight in the widows' row, gloved hands over the handle. Three days of not speaking after the reclassification cleared (**TL**).
WHAT POLITENESS COSTS	Bell takes her hand and she looks at their joined hands before she answers. The cane shifts against the floor when he says Eden's name (**DR3**). **INTERPRETATION** Her body objects about half a second before her manners arrive, and only Eden can read it.
THE HEAT	Aurem summer "sits on your back from May through October and expects you to carry it" (**DOM**). She's carried sixty-nine of them.
THE THREE BURIALS	She's buried three people the old way and intends to be buried that way herself (**DOM**).
WHAT SHE'S AFRAID IS TRUE	**INFERENCE** Teaching a girl to keep part of herself unregistered might only be a slower loss. Miriam had the salt water and left anyway. If that's true, she's sent Eden to the Crownward with a hymn instead of armor.

WHAT HER BODY DOES THAT SHE HAS NO IDEA EDEN CAN READ

THE NIGHT SHE WAS MOST AFRAID, AND WHAT SHE DID INSTEAD OF SAYING SO

Belief arc

TKC: TL · DR3 · FR 16

YOURS

The first two stations are printed from your files, because she's already lived them. The last two are the book. The oldest person in the house is the one most likely to be asked to change her mind, and she's had the least practice.

STATION	WHAT SHE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT SHE DOES	CH.
I · Before Aurelia	Refusing the Empire's terms is survivable if you're careful. She stays Unbound and moves between Dominions rather than settle where a Binding could find her (**TL**).	Miriam, raised to refuse everything, takes the first Binding offered at twenty and believes she loves him (**TL**)	
II · After Miriam	**INFERENCE** Keep part of yourself unregistered, and teach it earlier and harder.	Eden pays ten dollars to be judged. Celeste names what it bought and clears a shelf by midnight (**DR3**).	
III · In this book			
IV · On the last page			

WHO NOTICES FIRST THAT SHE'S CHANGED, AND WHAT THEY SEE

THE SCENE WHERE THE CRACK SHOWS, AND WHO'S IN THE KITCHEN WHEN IT DOES

TKC: TL · DR3 · MEN · FR 11–17

Who she can move, and who can move her

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
EDEN	Everything she knows about faith, and the real name of the city (**TL**)	Eden's. She left anyway, and Celeste helped her go.
LEAH	Comes to the kitchen twice a week under cover of helping with Solomon (**MEN**)	Leah's husband, and the quarterly assessment
ZION · 18	Signed the form she didn't want him to sign (**DR3**). Promised Eden he'd look after her (**TL**).	The Empire's, through him. He's the man on the form now.
SOLOMON · 16	She's coaching him on how much of himself to show (**MEN**)	A Crown education officer who hasn't knocked yet
MIRIAM	A name she doesn't speak lightly (**TL**). No proof she's alive (**FR 16**).	Miriam's, by being absent
MINISTER BELL	Thirty-four years, pie and coats, and a sponsorship he wouldn't give (**DR3**)	His, formally. She has thirty-four years of receipts.
MIRIAM'S FATHER	**INFERENCE** The man from the unregistered ceremony that he survived, and "it was not an oversight" (**FR 17**)	

WHO IN THE DISTRICT OWES HER, AND WHAT SHE'S NEVER CALLED IN

WHO SHE PRAYS FOR THAT NOBODY WOULD GUESS

Her voice

TKC: DR3 · TL

Hers is the most distinct voice in the manuscript: short, dry, flat, and almost never the answer to the question asked. Lines already on the page are printed. Keep the rhythm when you add to them.

ON THE PAGE	"You need to stop bending that card. You distracting me." Without turning her head (**DR3**).
TO A MINISTER	"Morning." To a man of thirty-four years who's just said what a joy it is to see her (**DR3**).
TO THE HOUSE	"Well. The House calls whom it calls." (**DR3**)
TEASING	"You like seeing how close you can get." "To what?" "My cane." (**DR3**)
THE RECEIPT	"You paid ten dollars for the right to be judged by people who already decided what you are." (**DR3**)
GRADING	"Passing ain't the same as placing." (**DR3**)
THE LAST NIGHT	"Remember what I told you about the real name of this city." (**TL**)

INFERENCE Four words where six would do. She answers the second question, not the first, says the hard sentence flat and stops, and never raises her voice in a building the Empire owns.

LINES ONLY SHE WOULD SAY. WRITE TEN, KEEP THREE.

WORDS SHE WON'T USE, AND WHY

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

LINES ONLY SHE WOULD SAY. WRITE TEN, KEEP THREE.

The contradiction

TKC: DR3 · TL · DOM

Your files contain hers twice, and the cost is on record both times.

WHAT SHE BELIEVES AND BREAKS	**INFERENCE** You don't hand the Empire anything it hasn't already taken. She told Eden exactly what the ten dollars bought, and by midnight she'd cleared a shelf for the study materials (**DR3**). Knowing better, she helped.
WHAT IT COST, THE FIRST TIME	She raised Miriam to refuse everything, and Miriam accepted a Binding at twenty (**TL**). The Salt Ceremony didn't save her (**DOM**).
WHAT IT MAY COST NOW	She's helped the second one out the door toward the same institution in a better dress. Whatever comes after the Trials, she signed for it too.

WHY SHE HELPED ANYWAY, IN HER WORDS AND NOT YOURS

THE SCENE WHERE THE CONTRADICTION LANDS ON HER, AND THE CHAPTER

DR3 MEN DOM

FIVE PRESSURES

The authority line, Solomon's scores, Leah's timeline, the Temple and Aurem.

WHAT ISN'T ON THE LIST

Miriam, and every one of the five runs around the hole she left.

MARGINALIA

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the forms, 505. Men and labor, 507.

The machinery around her

Five systems press on a sixty-nine-year-old woman with no legal standing, and none of them asks her permission. Read this page, then turn it while it's still loud.

The authority line comes first. Every form that matters asks for an adult male. She wrote "deceased" and it came back circled (DR3). Her authority is real inside the house and gone at the counter, and the Empire will keep sending her paper that says so. Solomon's scores come next. A common boy whose scores come back exceptional gets a visit from a Crown education officer within three months, and refusing the offer routes him to the worst labor for life (MEN). Two informal notes are already filed, and she's coaching him to show less (MEN). Leah sits under the Commonwife timeline, nearly two years Bound with no pregnancy and a Vowed officer making comments (MEN). Celeste can feed her and can't protect her. The Temple she attends anyway knows her best and priced her most exactly. Thirty-four years of pie and coats bought her a seat in the widows' row and no sponsorship (DR3). And Aurem itself, the Dominion with the highest Commonwife rate, made marriage look like the highest honor available on purpose (DOM).

INTERPRETATION Staying Unbound in Aurem has never been a private choice. She's been making a public statement for fifty years.

The one good blouse

TKC: TL

WRITING

Anywhere else it would have been called an adoption. Here it took six years, because approval meant proving on paper that her daughter wasn't coming back. She put on her one good blouse, went downtown, said what she needed to say, and didn't speak for three days after it was approved. Eden was in the room when she got home. Celeste held her face in both hands and said nothing (TL).

1 · WHAT SHE SAID AT THE COUNTER. WRITE THE SENTENCE THAT ENDS A DAUGHTER ON PAPER, AND WHAT THE CLERK DID WITH HIS PEN.

2 · THE THREE DAYS. THE HOUSE KEEPS RUNNING. WHO COOKS, WHO READS HER SILENCE, AND WHAT A THIRTEEN-YEAR-OLD EDEN DECIDES IT MEANS.

3 · WHERE THIS SHOWS UP LATER, AND WHAT SHE DOES DIFFERENTLY BECAUSE OF IT

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Write her alone

Ten minutes of Celeste in that house with nobody in it. No grandchildren to be steady for, no minister to be polite to, no forms. She's performed composure for fifty years, and there's a version of her only an empty kitchen has met.

If you stall, reach for one: what she does with the cane when nobody can see · the chair she never sits in · what she cooks for herself and whether she eats it · what she says out loud to God when it's only God · the drawer nothing's come out of in fourteen years · what she does with Miriam's name · the sound of the house at nine at night · what she's still angry about from 2044.

WRITE

Anything here that surprised you is canon unless you cross it out. Date it.

Celeste and Miriam

TKC: TL · FR 3 · FR 6–9 · FR 15–18

CONTENT NOTE A daughter's disappearance and a mother's grief.

WHAT CELESTE HAS

Miriam took the first Binding offered and was unrecognizable within four years (TL). Her registration was deactivated in 2090 with no forwarding Dominion (TL). One promise to come back, then nothing, and no letter ever reached the house (FR 12, 16).

WHAT CELESTE THINKS HAPPENED TO HER DAUGHTER

WHAT HAPPENED

After Thomas left, Miriam was reassigned to another man's household (FR 0). She left her children with Celeste to protect them from that household and from the search (FR 6, 9). She went looking for her father, who was close to the Vanes, and being unreachable wasn't something she chose (FR 15, 17).

WHAT MIRIAM WOULD SAY ABOUT HER MOTHER'S TEACHING, GIVEN THE CHANCE

IF MIRIAM COMES BACK, WHO'S IN THE ROOM, AND WHAT'S COOKING

WRITING

SCENE LAB

Put pressure on the belief

Take one thing Celeste believes and build the room that tests it. Fill the short lines fast. They're scaffolding, not prose. Her beliefs are sixty years old and have never met anyone who could out-argue them, so find that person.

THE SCAFFOLD

The belief, in her words

Who can challenge it

A room she can't leave

Who else is listening, and for whom

What the other person wants

What she wants

What she says, four words or fewer

What she won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO.

DATE

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

NOTES

ANYTHING CELESTE'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH



PORTRAIT · EDEN SELAH OSEI · TWENTY-ONE · COVENANT DAUGHTER OF AUREM

TKC: TL · TR · DR3 · CR · MEN

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PART I · DOSSIER 2 · ◈

EDEN

Raised by her grandmother in the outer districts on a faith assembled at a kitchen table. Self-nominated, first in Aurem, and flagged since she was eighteen.

ON THE RECORD

Eden Selah Osei, twenty-one. Covenant Daughter of Aurem for the 39th Trial, the first Aurem candidate ever to enter by self-nomination (**TL**). Placed first in the Regional Assessment. Wins (**TR**).

STILL OPEN

The house name Celeste gave her, the four words she says to Sera, the three things Lyris tells her, and what she believes on the last page.

TKC: TL · TR · DR3 · DOM

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The file that opens before she speaks

Designation Record

REGISTRY · AUREM · 2101

CROWN ADMINISTRATIVE BUILDING · AURELIA · ASSESSED BY A VOWED OFFICER

NAME OF RECORD	*OSEI, Eden Selah*
BORN	*2083 · Aurelia*
HOUSEHOLD	*Parish, Celeste · guardian of record since 2085*
SCORE	*highest in the Dominion's recorded history*
FLAG, 2101	*"Exceptional intellect. Monitor closely."*
FLAG, 2104	*"Selected for Trial. Monitor closely."*
ENTRY	*independent submission · ten dollars · red card*

MONITOR CLOSELY

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HER
EDEN SELAH OSEI	The Ministry, on paper	A file that's already open before she speaks (TL)
COVENANT DAUGHTER OF AUREM	The Broadcast and the Boulevard boards	A Dominion of millions standing behind one name (TR)
EDEN	Celeste, at the stove	The only room where she isn't being scored
THE HOUSE NAME	Celeste, inside the house only (TL)	

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE HOUSE NAME. WRITE IT, AND WHAT CELESTE SAID WHEN SHE GAVE IT.

TKC: TL · TR · CR · MEN · FR 4 · FR 11 · RULING

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Her years against the Empire's

YEAR	AGE	HER LIFE	THE EMPIRE THAT YEAR
2083	0	Born in Aurelia, Celeste present (TL)	Crest's last years. The Trials are nineteen cycles old.
2084	1	Thomas leaves (FR 3)	
2085	2	Goes to Celeste, alone, and stays (FR 4)	Crest dies. Dorian takes the throne. The Trial is cancelled.
2090	7	Given a task the day Miriam leaves, to take Zion outside (FR 11)	
2096	13	In the room when Celeste comes home from downtown (TL)	
2100	17		Azrael "dies"
2101	18	Designation. Highest score in Aurem's history, and flagged that day (TL)	
2101–04	18–21	Studies the Anointed Court wives by name, relationship and preference (CR)	
2104	21	Six months of paperwork. Self-nominates in May. First in the Regional Assessment. (TL)	The 39th Trial

INFERENCE Six months of paperwork finished by early May means she started in late 2103, around the time Zion turned eighteen.

THE THREE YEARS SHE'D NAME IF ASKED WHEN HER LIFE CHANGED, AND WHAT SHE WAS DOING IN EACH

THE THREE YEARS SHE'D NAME IF ASKED WHEN HER LIFE CHANGED, AND WHAT SHE WAS DOING IN EACH

TKC: TL · TR · DR3 · CR

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The clerk's version and the true one

ON THE LEDGER	Covenant Daughter of Aurem, independent submission, outer districts, Sector Seven, first (TL). Selected second by the Governor-Prelate after ranking first. The woman he picked first withdrew the night before departure, for what was called a family health emergency, and it wasn't one (TR).
AT THE ASSESSMENT	Her toe rests exactly behind the gold tile that separates candidates from everyone else. Asked about it: "They let me through the door. Figured the floor came with it." A nail she'd hammered flat that morning rises through the cardboard into her stocking while the board's read, and she stays where she is. Her eyes go to the bottom of the board first, to Domestic Service, Binding and Remedial, before she looks up (DR3).
WHAT SHE STUDIES	The Anointed Court wives, by name, relationship and known preference, for three years (CR). The Arrangement, which Celeste told her about (CR). She can't study Lyris, because Lyris has spent thirty years making sure there's nothing to study (CR).
WHY SHE ENTERED	For her family, and for the girls in the outer districts who'll watch the boards and need to see her name on them (TR). Partly to be somewhere useful before a Crown education officer reaches Solomon (MEN).
OPEN QUESTION	Which track did her Designation put her on? Eligibility asks for "Unbound or elevated designation" (TR).

WHAT SHE ACTUALLY DOES ALL DAY IN AURELIA, HOURS, ROOMS AND HANDS

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

TKC: TR · TL · DR3 · DOM

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WHAT SHE BELIEVES	Celeste taught her that how you treat people who can't help you is the truest thing about you, and Eden holds it as faith more than strategy (TR). Her faith is real, and it "required more maintenance" than Maribel Vale's (DR3).
WHAT SHE ALSO BELIEVES	For women like her, the only road to the kind of power that changes things runs through a man willing to let her stand behind him while she works. Celeste taught her that, the Salt Ceremony teaches it, and the Empire confirms it (TR).
WHO TAUGHT HER	Celeste, at the kitchen table (TL). Miriam gave her a word from the Psalms and left (TL).
WHAT SHE CAN RECITE	Enough to post the highest Doctrinal Assessment score in the Trials' history, on the most complex set of questions the Vowed have built in eleven cycles (TR).
WHAT SHE'D SAY IN PUBLIC	Her Testimony, delivered without a handler: a statement of faith in women's intelligence worded so precisely in theological language that flagging it would mean flagging the theology (TR).
WHAT SHE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	The house name. The real name of the city (TL).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

Self-nomination is framed as "exceptional faith," and the process is built to exhaust anyone without backing (TR). When a candidate's intelligence becomes the story instead of her compliance, the Broadcast calls it the Eve problem and runs a narrative that "implies" and never accuses (TR). Bell prayed that God would close every door not intended for her (DR3).

HOW SHE PRAYS: THE WORDS, THE POSTURE, AND WHERE

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

HOW SHE PRAYS: THE WORDS, THE POSTURE, AND WHERE

The text

GEN 2–3

PS 46

HAB 3

ESTH 4.14

GEN 38

PROV 31.29

LUKE 1.52

JUDG 4.4

ROM 16.1–7

GEN 3.6

EDEN	The garden of Genesis 2–3. **CONTESTED** The Hebrew *'eden* sounds like "delight," and some scholars connect the name to an older word for a plain or steppe.
SELAH	Seventy-one times in the Psalms and three in Habakkuk. The timeline says it means "pause" (**TL**), the usual gloss. **CONTESTED** Nobody knows what it meant. It's probably a musical or liturgical marker.
EVE · GENESIS 3	**POSSIBLE** The Broadcast's own name for her problem (**TR**). **Where it breaks:** Eve is never asked what she wanted. Eden is asked constantly, on camera, and graded on the answer (Vol. I, 383).
ESTHER	**POSSIBLE** A young woman taken in a state search, prepared for months, who goes in unsummoned. **Where it breaks:** Esther is taken and told to hide her people. Eden filed the paperwork herself and paid ten dollars to be searched.
TAMAR · GENESIS 38	**POSSIBLE** A woman with no standing who collects evidence instead of accusing. **Where it breaks:** Tamar had a law on her side that wasn't being enforced. Eden's law is against her (Vol. I, 419).

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER IN THE TEMPLE
Esther 4.14, "for such a time as this," knowing the Empire quotes it too	Judges 4.4, Deborah judging Israel with no emergency offered as an excuse
Luke 1.52, "He hath put down the mighty from their seats"	Romans 16.1–7, Phoebe the deacon and Junia among the apostles
	Genesis 3.6, "her husband with her," standing there the whole time

Proverbs 31.29 was read over her before the scores, in King James wording (**DR3**).

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Eve, 370. Tamar, 373. Esther and the woman of worth, 386. Deborah, 376. Mary's song, 390. The two beginnings, 242. Psalms, 121. The Lord's Prayer, 415. The Covenant Trials, 542.

TKC: DR3 · TR · TL

Body and fear

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	The nail through the cardboard into her stocking, and she doesn't move. Ten of her eleven dollars, counted by a clerk who inspects both sides of every bill. She walks home in the same shoes and says nothing until Celeste finds the receipt (**DR3**).
HOW SHE ARRIVES	She looks at the city before she looks at the cameras, carries her own bag, and walks Sovereign Boulevard slower than the choreography, like a woman who means to walk it (**TR**). The Broadcast uses forty-seven seconds of it (**TR**).
WHAT FEAR DOES	Fear sends her eyes to the bottom of the board first (**DR3**). **INTERPRETATION** Her ambition is defensive before it's aspirational.
WHAT SHE'S AFRAID IS TRUE	**INFERENCE** The road through a man is the Empire's design and not a loophole in it. If that's true, using it makes her the Empire's best argument.

WHAT HER BODY DOES WHEN SHE LIES, AND WHAT IT DOES WHEN SHE'S BELIEVED

WHAT SHE'D DO IF SHE KNEW IT WAS TRUE AND HAD ONE NIGHT TO ACT

Belief arc

TKC: TR · DR3 · CR · TL

YOURS

Faith rarely dies in one scene. It gets renegotiated four or five times, and one morning she notices. Put a chapter in the last column every time, because a station without a chapter is an intention and not a plot.

STATION	WHAT SHE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT SHE DOES	CH.
I · Inherited	The truth, delivered correctly, is the most powerful thing a person can offer in a room full of performers (TR)	Bell asks about her father instead of her grades and prays a door shut (DR3)	
II · First crack	The process can be beaten by someone who reads the small print	The gap between what she does in the debates and what the scores give her for it is consistent (TR)	
III · Collapse			
IV · What replaces it			

INFERENCE The Arrangement is the first thing in the Crownward that gives her hope, because the system has a door in it nobody put on the map (CR). Decide whether that door holds.

THE LAST THING SHE LETS GO OF

WHO NOTICES SHE'S CHANGED, AND WHEN

TKC: TR · TL · CR · MEN · WR · FR 13

Names, not roles

CONTENT NOTE Endurance violence (Maren).

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
CELESTE	Everything she knows about faith (**TL**)	
SOLOMON	She entered partly to protect him, and doesn't know about the teacher notes (**MEN**)	
SERA MONTOYA	Four words in a hallway after the Forum, and an ally who's decided two clear-eyed women beat one (**TR**)	
ZARA VOSS	**INTERPRETATION** The name exchange in the middle of the book (Vol. I, 553)	
LYRIS VANE	Eleven minutes at the Anointed Evening. The third thing is a warning that's also instructions (**TR**).	Lyris's
JUDAH	Thirty minutes. "Most candidates tell me they feel called." "I know." (**TR**)	
DELIA CROSS	Votes with her in the Forum and in the Social Policy debate (**TL**)	
MAREN COLE	Knocked unconscious on Endurance Day 3 and left behind (**TR**)	
HANNAH · ABIGAIL	The House Mother who knows the camera gaps (**TL**). The advisor who reads her for a living (**TL**).	

THE ONE PERSON WHO KNOWS WHAT SHE ACTUALLY BELIEVES, AND HOW THEY FOUND OUT

Her voice

TKC: DR3 · TR · WR 6–10 · WR 33–37

ON THE PAGE	"They let me through the door. Figured the floor came with it." (**DR3**)
TO THE HEIR	Asked why she entered, she says she wants access to the kind of power that changes things, plainly, without theology, and watches what he does with it. "Most candidates tell me they feel called." "I know." (**TR**)
THE RULES	Eden narrates only what she knows, sees, hears, suspects or feels in the moment. She notices behavior before meaning, and her silence always does work (**WR 6–10**). She never "had no answer" (**WR**).
WITH JUDAH	Attention before desire. She doesn't talk to him in a watched room, and she doesn't understand him early (**WR 33–35**).

LINES ONLY EDEN WOULD SAY

THE FOUR WORDS SHE SAYS TO SERA IN THE HALLWAY

HOW SHE SPEAKS WITH NO RANK IN THE ROOM

TKC: TR · CR

WRITING

THE CONTRADICTION

CONTENT NOTE Violence during Endurance.

WHAT SHE BELIEVES AND BREAKS	**INFERENCE** How you treat people who can't help you is the truest thing about you (**TR**). On Endurance Day 3, with Delphine, she knocks Maren unconscious and leaves her in Mountain terrain (**TR**).
CONFLICT	The fates table has Delphine extracted with a head injury on Day 1 and helping on Day 3 (**TR**). One of the two has to move.
WHAT SHE WANTS AND USES	She wants to be the woman the city pauses for, and to use the pause (**CR**). The pause runs through the Empire's own machinery.

HOW SHE JUSTIFIES IT TO HERSELF

WHO PAYS FOR THE JUSTIFICATION, AND THE SCENE WHERE IT LANDS

The machinery around her

Six systems are pressing on Eden before she says a word in chapter one. You built all six, and this page holds them together so you don't stop drafting to look.

The Designation flagged her at eighteen, so she's spent three years entering every room as a file that's already open (TL). Self-nomination cost six months and ten dollars, and the Empire will read her ambition as pride the moment it stops being useful (TR, DR3). The Salt Ceremony's theology, survive by keeping part of yourself unregistered, is about to be tested at Imperial scale (DOM). Solomon's scores are coming, and she doesn't know about the notes (MEN). Leah is under the Commonwife timeline, and Eden's win is the only exit anyone in the family can see (MEN). The Broadcast holds forty percent of the score and has a name ready for a woman whose intelligence becomes the story (TR). The thing that got her to the Crownward is what they'll use to take it back.

TL TR MEN

SIX PRESSURES

The flag, the fee, the salt water, Solomon, Leah and the Eve problem.

MARGINALIA

✤ *See also:* Vol. I, scoring and the Eve problem, 572.

TKC: DR3

WRITING

What Bell took from her

She went to a man who'd eaten Celeste's sweet potato pie for thirty-four years and asked him to sponsor her. He kept her waiting while he signed Binding certificates. He didn't ask about her grades. He asked whether her father was dead, and whether her mother was properly Bound when Eden was born. He offered Leah a Home Instruction nomination and prayed that God would close every door not intended for her. Everything after, the clause, the ten dollars and the red card, happens on the other side of that room (DR3).

1 · WHAT SHE GENUINELY BELIEVED THAT MORNING ABOUT HOW MERIT, FAITH AND OPPORTUNITY FIT TOGETHER

2 · WHAT CHANGES IN HER WHILE HE ASKS ABOUT HER FATHER, AND WHAT SHE DOES WITH HER FACE

3 · WHAT SURVIVES THE MEETING ANYWAY, AND WHERE IT SHOWS UP LATER

Write her at home

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Ten minutes of Eden doing something ordinary in Celeste's house before any of it starts. No Empire, no exposition, nobody assessing her. She's been graded since she was eighteen, and there's a version of her only that kitchen has met.

If you stall: where she sits and what's wrong with that chair · what she does with her hair · what she eats when nobody's watching · the chore she hates and does anyway · what makes her petty · what makes Zion laugh · the sound of the house at nine at night.

WRITE

Anything here that surprised you is canon unless you cross it out. Date it.

TKC: DR3 · TL · DOM · FR 4

Eden and Celeste

Celeste took her at two (**FR 4**), raised her on fragments of the old world, and performed the Salt Ceremony for Miriam, who left anyway. When Eden paid the ten dollars, Celeste said she'd paid for the right to be judged by people who'd already decided what she was, and cleared a shelf for her study materials by midnight (**DR3, TL, DOM**). Both halves of that woman are true, and Eden has only ever been told one of them.

WHAT EDEN THINKS CELESTE BELIEVES ABOUT GOD, THE EMPIRE AND HER

WHAT CELESTE ACTUALLY BELIEVES, INCLUDING WHAT SHE'S NEVER SAID

THE THING EDEN HAS NEVER ASKED HER, AND THE SCENE WHERE SHE FINALLY DOES

What she already does

TKC: DR3

WRITING

A character reads as one continuous person when a gesture comes back changed. The left column is already on the page in Draft Three.

ON THE PAGE	WHAT IT ESTABLISHES
Her toe exactly behind the gold tile, and the line about the floor	She tests a limit with her body, then answers with the fewest words that work
The nail in her stocking, and she stays put	She'll absorb pain before she gives up position, and keeps the cost private
The bottom of the board first	Her ambition is defensive before it's aspirational
Ten of eleven dollars, and the same shoes home	She pays in advance, alone, and doesn't announce it
The lilies, the tripod moving two feet left, Bell watching the officials	Her intelligence lives in what she catalogs

REPEAT. WHERE THE SAME MOVE LANDS AGAIN UNCHANGED, AND THE CHAPTER.

COMPLICATE. WHERE IT COSTS MORE THAN IT DID IN AURELIA.

REVERSE. WHERE SHE DOES THE OPPOSITE, AND WHAT MADE THAT POSSIBLE.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

REVERSE. WHERE SHE DOES THE OPPOSITE, AND WHAT MADE THAT POSSIBLE.

PUT PRESSURE ON THE BELIEF

Take one thing Eden believes and build the room that tests it. A belief that never meets someone who wants something else is a theme and not a story.

THE SCAFFOLD
The belief, in her words
Who can challenge it
A room she can't leave
Who else is watching, and for whom
What the other person wants
What she wants
What she says
What she won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING EDEN'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH



PORTRAIT · MIRIAM OSEI · AS CELESTE LAST SAW HER, OR AS SHE IS NOW

TKC: TL · DOM · FR 0 · FR 3 · FR 6–9 · FR 15–18

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PART I · DOSSIER 3 · ◈

MIRIAM

She may have fully meant to come back. Celeste heard the instability under the promise. She didn't leave indifferent. She made a promise she eventually failed to keep ***(FR 8)****.*

ON THE RECORD

Miriam Osei, born 2062, Bound at twenty to Thomas Osei. Reassigned after he left. Gone from Aurelia since 2090, registration deactivated, no forwarding Dominion logged (**TL, FR 0**).

STILL OPEN

How reassignment worked, why Solomon kept the Osei name, who intercepted her letter, and what she says when she walks back in (**FR 0, FR 16**).

TKC: TL · DOM · FR 0 · FR 1

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OPEN QUESTION

THE FILE THAT STOPPED

Binding Registration

REGISTRY · AUREM · 2082

CROWN AND TEMPLE COPIES · WITNESSED BY A VOWED OFFICIANT

NAME OF RECORD	*PARISH-OSEI, Miriam (INFERENCE from the Aurem custom)*
BORN	*2062 · Aurelia*
DESIGNATION	*Commonwife, a registration status* **(FR 1)**
BOUND TO	*Osei, Thomas · service sector*
REASSIGNED	*after 2084 · household of _____* **(FR 0)**
CHILDREN	*Eden, Leah, Zion · Solomon* **(FR 0)**
2090	*deactivated · no forwarding Dominion logged*

DEACTIVATED

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HER
MIRIAM	Celeste, never lightly **(TL)**	
WHAT THE CHILDREN CALL HER	Eden, Leah, Zion and Solomon	
COMMONWIFE	The Registry	A status, and the thing that let her be moved to another man's house **(FR 0–1)**

OPEN QUESTION Does the hyphenated Binding surname apply only in Aurem, and what did Miriam's name become after reassignment (Vol. I, 525)?

Her years against the Empire's

TKC: TL · DOM · FR 0 · FR 3–9 · FR 11 · FR 15–18

YEAR	AGE	HER LIFE	SOURCE
2062	0	Born to Celeste, raised alone under Unbound designation, watching her mother work the Empire "with precision and exhaustion"	TL
2082	20	The Salt Ceremony, then her Binding to Thomas. She believes she loves him, and she does.	TL, DOM
2083	21	Eden. She gives her the Selah.	TL
2084	22	Leah. Thomas leaves for another Dominion, another woman, another life. She's reassigned to another man's household.	FR 0, FR 3
2085	23	Zion, conceived before Thomas left. Eden goes to Celeste.	FR 0, FR 4
2088	26	Solomon, by the man she was reassigned to	FR 0, FR 11
2090	28	Leaves all four with Celeste and goes alone, to look for her father	FR 6–7, FR 17
2094	32	One letter, intercepted before it reaches Celeste	FR 16
		Finds her father, Crownward-resident and close to the Vanes	FR 7, FR 17
		The arrangement that kept her unreachable ends, and she comes back. **OPEN QUESTION** In this book or book two?	FR 18

SUPERSEDED The timeline calls 2084 a disappearance that Celeste "always believed otherwise" about. Thomas left voluntarily, and the record was accurate (**FR 3**).

THE YEAR IN HER FATHER'S HOUSEHOLD SHE'D NEVER DESCRIBE TO HER CHILDREN

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE YEAR IN HER FATHER'S HOUSEHOLD SHE'D NEVER DESCRIBE TO HER CHILDREN

The clerk's version and the true one

CONTENT NOTE Abandonment and coerced reassignment.

ON THE LEDGER	Commonwife registration quietly deactivated in 2090, no forwarding Dominion logged (**TL**). Within four years of her Binding she was "unrecognizable to her own mother" (**TL**).
IN 2084	Thomas left voluntarily, and she was reassigned to another man's household (**FR 0**, **FR 3**). **OPEN QUESTION** Who decided it, and what was her status while it happened (Vol. I, 527)?
WHAT SHE PROTECTED THEM FROM	The household she'd been reassigned to, and the instability of dragging four children on a search. She hadn't found her father yet, so she couldn't have named him as the threat (**FR 9**).
UNREACHABLE	Being unreachable wasn't selective. No version existed where she was hidden from her father and available to her children (**FR 15**).
HER FATHER'S HOUSE	He'd been Crownward-resident and close to the Vanes the whole time, and surviving an unregistered ceremony wasn't an oversight. He was useful to somebody, and her children would be too (**FR 17**).

WHAT HER DAYS WERE LIKE IN THE REASSIGNED HOUSEHOLD, AND THE MOMENT SHE DECIDED TO GO

TKC: TL · DOM · FR 8 · FR 18

VOL. I · 509 · 513 · 527

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	Celeste, who refused every term the Empire offered and raised her to do the same (TL). The Salt Ceremony the night before her Binding: what to hold, what to hide, what not to hand over (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVED AT TWENTY	She loved Thomas, and she did (TL). INFERENCE That love could be a private thing inside a public registration.
WHAT SHE GAVE AWAY	*Selah*, from the Psalms, to her first daughter (TL). INFERENCE She knew the Psalms well enough to choose from them.
WHAT SHE BELIEVES NOW	OPEN QUESTION The files give her conviction and no expectation of being believed when she returns (FR 18), and nothing about God.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

A Commonwife is expected to bear children on the Covenant timeline (MEN), and an abandoned one can be moved to another household (FR 0). POSSIBLE The Temple cites Psalm 68.6, "God setteth the solitary in families," as the warrant for reassignment, and stops before the rest of the verse, "he bringeth out those which are bound with chains." For a mother who leaves, it has Titus 2.4–5, "to love their children... keepers at home."

WHAT MIRIAM WOULD SAY TO GOD IF SHE BELIEVED HE WAS LISTENING, AND WHAT SHE'D SAY IF SHE DIDN'T

The text

HER NAME	Miriam the prophet, the first woman the Torah calls one (Exod 15.20). Mariam in Greek, so every Mary in the New Testament (Vol. I, 388).
MIRIAM AT THE RIVER · EXODUS 2	**POSSIBLE** If the unnamed sister at the river is Miriam, as tradition holds, she watches from a distance as her brother is placed in the reeds, then arranges for their own mother to nurse him. **Where it breaks:** The biblical Miriam stays near the child she placed. This one placed hers and went out of reach.
NUMBERS 12	**POSSIBLE** Struck and put outside the camp for seven days, and the camp doesn't move until she's brought back. **Where it breaks:** Whether anyone in the Empire waits for this one is the question (Vol. I, 388).
NAOMI · RUTH 1.20–21	**POSSIBLE** "I went out full, and the LORD hath brought me home again empty." Call me Mara. **Where it breaks:** Naomi comes home to people who recognize her. Miriam comes home to four children who've each kept a different version of the day she left (**FR 11**).

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Exodus 15.21, "Sing ye to the LORD," the song her name carries	Micah 6.4, where God names Miriam with Moses and Aaron as the three he sent
Ruth 1.21, coming home empty	Numbers 20.1–2, her death and the next line, "there was no water"
	Isaiah 49.15, "Can a woman forget her sucking child... yet will I not forget thee"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Miriam, 375. Numbers, Miriam and Aaron, 152. The sea, the song and Miriam, 282. Exodus, six women, 272. Ruth and Naomi, 391 and 109. Commonwives and reassignment, 512.

EXOD 2.1–10

EXOD 15.20–21

NUM 12

NUM 20.1–2

MIC 6.4

RUTH 1.20–21

PS 68.6

ISA 49.15

TKC: TL · FR 8–9 · FR 18

Body and fear

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	Unrecognizable to her own mother within four years of her Binding (**TL**). Four births in five years (**TL, FR 0**).
WHAT SHE WAS AFRAID OF	The reassigned household, and dragging four children through a search (**FR 9**). Whether she was also protecting them from herself stays open for her later development (**FR 9**).
HOW SHE COMES BACK	With conviction and no expectation of being believed (**FR 18**).

WHAT FOURTEEN YEARS HAVE DONE TO HER BODY, HER HANDS AND HER VOICE

WHAT SHE'S AFRAID IS TRUE ABOUT WHAT SHE DID

Belief arc

TKC: TL · FR 3 · FR 6–9 · FR 17–18

YOURS

STATION	WHAT SHE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT SHE DOES	CH.
I · At twenty	She loves Thomas, and that's enough to live inside a Binding (TL)	He leaves voluntarily, and she's reassigned (FR 0, FR 3)	
II · After Thomas	She has to protect the children from the house she's in (FR 9)	She leaves all four with Celeste and goes looking for her father (FR 6–7)	
III · Her father's house		The arrangement that kept her unreachable ends (FR 18)	
IV · The return			

WHAT SHE BELIEVED ABOUT HER FATHER BEFORE SHE FOUND HIM, AND AFTER

WHO NOTICES SHE'S CHANGED WHEN SHE WALKS BACK IN, AND WHAT THEY SEE FIRST

TKC: TL · FR 0 · FR 3 · FR 11–18

Who she can move, and who can move her

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
CELESTE	The Salt Ceremony, and a promise Celeste heard the instability under (**DOM, FR 8**)	
THOMAS	A Binding she believed in, and a man who left for another life (**TL, FR 3**)	
THE MAN SHE WAS REASSIGNED TO	Solomon's father. How it worked and what it meant to her are deferred (**FR 0**).	
HER FATHER	Crownward-resident, close to the Vanes. He knows there are children but not how many or their names, and learned about Eden the day the Trial went public (**FR 17–18**).	His
EDEN	Given a task to get her out of the room (**FR 13**)	
LEAH	Watched her pack, and defends her to the others (**FR 11, 14**)	
WHOEVER STOPPED THE LETTER	2094, intercepted before it reached Celeste (**FR 16**)	

Whether each child forgives her isn't decided, and they may land differently (**FR 6**).

WHO INTERCEPTED THE LETTER, AND WHAT IT SAID

Her voice

TKC: FR 18

WRITING

Nothing of Miriam's is on the page yet. Her voice is the one you'll build from nothing, and the reader will hear it through four children who each remember it differently.

WHAT SHE SOUNDED LIKE AT TWENTY, IN CELESTE'S KITCHEN, THE NIGHT OF THE SALT CEREMONY

WHAT SHE SOUNDS LIKE AT FORTY-TWO, SAYING SHE'S COME BACK

THE WORDS SHE WON'T USE FOR THE MAN SHE WAS REASSIGNED TO

LINES ONLY SHE WOULD SAY

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

LINES ONLY SHE WOULD SAY

The contradiction

TKC: FR 6–9 · FR 15

WRITING

WHAT SHE BELIEVES AND BREAKS	**INFERENCE** She left to protect them, and the leaving was the harm (**FR 8–9**).
WHAT IT COST	A year of "she's coming back," then nothing said and nothing put in its place (**FR 12**). Leah's anger, and Leah's loyalty (**FR 14**).
WHAT THE FILES LEAVE OPEN	Whether she was also protecting them from herself (**FR 9**).

HOW SHE JUSTIFIES IT TO HERSELF, AT FORTY-TWO

THE SCENE WHERE IT LANDS ON HER, AND WHO SAYS IT TO HER FACE

FR 0 | FR 15–18

BOOK TWO

Her father is the only person watching the Trial who understands what he's looking at (FR 18).

MARGINALIA

The machinery around her

The Empire never had to remove Miriam. It only had to file her. A Commonwife is a registration status (FR 1), and a status can be moved. When her husband left, the system that had approved her Binding reassigned her to another man's household (FR 0, FR 3).

There's also the registration itself, deactivated without a forwarding Dominion (TL), so on paper she simply stops. Her father's household sits in the Crownward, close to the Vanes, where a man who survived an unregistered ceremony is useful to somebody (FR 17). Someone stopped her one letter (FR 16). And her return is triggered by something she doesn't control: the arrangement that kept her unreachable ended (FR 18). INTERPRETATION Every piece of her story is somebody else's paperwork, which is why her return has to be the first thing she does on her own authority.

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, Commonwives and reassignment, 527.

The day she left, from her side

TKC: FR 8 · FR 11–13

WRITING

CONTENT NOTE A mother leaving her children.

Leah watched her pack. Eden was told to take Zion outside. Solomon was two (**FR 11**). She said she was coming back, and she may have meant it (**FR 8, FR 12**).

1 · WHAT SHE PACKED, AND WHAT SHE LEFT ON PURPOSE

2 · WHAT SHE SAID TO EDEN WHEN SHE GAVE HER THE TASK, AND WHAT SHE COULDN'T SAY

3 · THE LAST THING SHE SAW OF THE HOUSE

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Write her in her father's house

Ten minutes of Miriam on an ordinary day in her father's household, years after 2090. Nobody explains anything. Somebody's watching, and she knows it.

If you stall: what she's allowed to touch · the window she stands at · what she does on her children's birthdays · what she calls her father to his face · what she writes and doesn't send · the sound of the Crownward at nine at night.

WRITE

Miriam and Leah

TKC: FR 11 · FR 14 · MEN

Leah remembers a decision more than a disappearance, which is why she's the angriest and why she defends Miriam to the others (FR 14). Leah is now a Commonwife herself, under the timeline her mother lived under (MEN).

WHAT MIRIAM THINKS LEAH SAW WHILE SHE PACKED

WHAT LEAH ACTUALLY SAW, AND WHAT SHE'S TOLD HERSELF SINCE

THE FIRST CONVERSATION BETWEEN THEM WHEN MIRIAM COMES BACK

WRITING

SCENE LAB

Put pressure on the belief

THE SCAFFOLD
The belief, in her words
Who can challenge it
A room she can't leave
Who else is listening, and for whom
What the other person wants
What she wants
What she says
What she won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING MIRIAM'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

TKC: TL · MEN · DR3 · FR 2–3

VOL. I · 507

PORTRAIT · THOMAS OSEI · AS HE WAS IN 2082

PART I · DOSSIER 4 · ◈ · SHORT

THOMAS

*Sometimes the paperwork is correct and a man simply leaves (**FR 3**).*

ON THE RECORD

Thomas Osei, a common laborer in Aurelia's service sector. Bound to Miriam in 2082. Father of Eden, Leah and Zion (**FR 2**). Left in 2084, voluntarily, for another Dominion, another woman, another life (**FR 3**).

RULED OUT

He wasn't removed, imprisoned or secretly killed. The Empire's record that he relocated was accurate, and it left out his reasons (**FR 3**).

The record and the man

TKC: TL · MEN · DR3 · FR 3

VOL. I · 505 · 507

Relocation Authorization

CROWN · LABOR ALLOCATION · 2084

MOVEMENT BETWEEN DOMINIONS REQUIRES CROWN AUTHORIZATION

NAME	*OSEI, Thomas · common designation*
ASSIGNMENT	*Aurelia · service sector, maintenance and infrastructure* **(MEN)**
HOUSEHOLD OF RECORD	*Commonwife Miriam · three children*
DESTINATION	_____ *Dominion*
REASON GIVEN	*work*

RELOCATED

WHAT THE RECORD SAYS	He relocated to another Dominion for work (**TL**). It's accurate (**FR 3**).
WHAT IT LEAVES OUT	Another woman and another life (**FR 3**).
INFERENCE	Moving between Dominions needs Crown authorization, "technically available and practically difficult" (**MEN**). Somebody approved a common man leaving a Commonwife and three children, and the approval is on file.
THE FAMILY'S VERSION	Celeste wrote "deceased" on a form's authority line (**DR3**). Bell asked Eden whether her father was dead (**DR3**). **INTERPRETATION** Celeste's word is a verdict, not a fact.

SUPERSEDED "Thomas Osei Disappears" and "Celeste has always believed otherwise" (**TL**). Every page framing 2084 as an Empire disappearance is out (FR, sweep 1).

JOHN 11.16

JOHN 14.5

JOHN 20.24–29

1 TIM 5.8

VOL. I · 415 · 417 · 507

Faith and scripture

WHAT HE BELIEVED	**OPEN QUESTION** Nothing in the files. He married a woman raised to refuse everything, which says something about one of them.
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A MAN LIKE HIM	Common men are told they're free, and the control sits in housing and work (**MEN**). **POSSIBLE** The Temple preaches 1 Timothy 5.8 to common men, that a man who doesn't provide for his own house "hath denied the faith." The Crown still signed his relocation.
HIS NAME	Thomas, one of the twelve, called Didymus, "the twin" (John 11.16). He's the one who says "Let us also go, that we may die with him" (11.16), and "we know not whither thou goest" (14.5).
WHERE IT BREAKS	The apostle doubts and comes back to the room, and the story ends with him there (John 20.24–29). Thomas Osei left the room and stayed gone. His son Zion works in the same category of labor and doesn't know it (**MEN**).

HE'D QUOTE	NOBODY EVER READ HIM
	1 Timothy 5.8, on providing for his own house
	Malachi 2.14, "the wife of thy youth, against whom thou hast dealt treacherously"

Volume One: the men of the New Testament, 402. The names in the cast, 404. Men, labor and the economy, 492.

Who he left

TKC: TL · FR 0 · FR 2–3 · FR 13 · MEN

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
MIRIAM	A Binding she believed in, and a man she did love (TL)
EDEN	One year old when he left (TL). Carries his name.
LEAH	Born the year he left (INFERENCE)
ZION	Conceived before he left, born after, with no memory of him (FR 0). Works in his category of labor without knowing it (MEN).
THE OTHER WOMAN	Another Dominion, another life (FR 3)

DECIDED No expansion of Thomas's later life this pass (FR 3). The page below is for when you want one.

WHAT HE'D SAY IF ONE OF HIS CHILDREN FOUND HIM

WRITING

Write the morning he left

Ten minutes, from his side or Miriam's. The paperwork's already approved.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO.

DATE



PORTRAIT · LEAH OSEI · TWENTY · COMMONWIFE

TKC: MEN · TL · DR3 · FR 11 · FR 14 · RULING

VOL. I · 523 · 527

PART I · DOSSIER 5 · ◈

LEAH

*She believes in Eden completely. She has always believed in Eden completely. She just needs Eden to come home (**MEN**).*

ON THE RECORD

Leah Osei, twenty, Eden's younger sister. A Commonwife for almost two years, with no pregnancy, under the eye of the Vowed officer who runs the quarterly household assessment (**MEN**). She sat for an assessment (DECIDED).

STILL OPEN

Her husband's name, her Binding name, what Home Instruction is, and what she does when the Broadcast turns on her sister.

TKC: MEN · DR3 · DOM · RULING

VOL. I · 523 · 525 · 527

THE QUARTERLY FILE

CONTENT NOTE Pressure to conceive, and a household assessed on it.

Household Assessment

TEMPLE · AUREM · QUARTERLY

COMMONWIFE HOUSEHOLD · CONDUCTED BY THE ASSIGNED VOWED OFFICER

COMMONWIFE	*OSEI, Leah · Bound c. 2102*
HUSBAND	*common man · service sector · _____*
COVENANT TIMELINE	*two years · no conception recorded*
OFFICER'S REMARK	*informal · not yet filed* **(MEN)**
HUSBAND'S REMARK	*the same, less carefully* **(MEN)**
ASSESSMENT, AT EIGHTEEN	*sat · Home Instruction offered the following year* **(DR3)**

UNDER REVIEW

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HER
LEAH OSEI	The Registry, before her Binding	
HER BINDING NAME	The Registry now (Vol. I, 525)	

CONFLICT The timeline has her already "living under Temple review." Men in the Empire has the officer making informal comments and no formal note yet. **INFERENCE** The review is coming, and it hasn't been filed.

Her years against the Empire's

TKC: MEN · TL · FR 5 · FR 11 · FR 14 · RULING

YEAR	AGE	HER LIFE	SOURCE
2084	0	Born, the year Thomas leaves	INFERENCE, FR 3
2090	6	Watches her mother pack. Comes to Celeste's house with Zion and Solomon.	FR 5, FR 11
2090–91	6–7	"She's coming back," for about a year	FR 12
2102	18	Sits for an assessment, Aurem's at eighteen. Bound as a Commonwife to a man in the service sector.	DECIDED, MEN, INFERENCE
2104	20	Two years without a pregnancy. Twice a week at Celeste's kitchen table. Watches Eden on the boards every evening.	MEN

SUPERSEDED "Eden's older sister" (**TL**). **DECIDED** Leah is younger than Eden.

THE DAY OF HER BINDING, AND WHETHER ANYONE PERFORMED THE SALT CEREMONY FOR HER

TKC: MEN · DR3

VOL. I · 523 · 527 · 529

The clerk's version and the true one

ON THE LEDGER	A Commonwife, two years Bound, with the child quota pressure starting (MEN).
HER HUSBAND	A common man in Aurelia's service sector, "not cruel, not kind, simply present," who got a wife because the system said he was eligible and she was available. He expects what the Empire told him he could expect (MEN).
HER TWO DAYS	She comes to Celeste's twice a week under cover of helping with Solomon. She does help, and it's also the only two days she can breathe. She and Zion sit at the table and don't talk about what they can't talk about (MEN).
THE EVENINGS	She watches Eden's score move on the kitchen screen. When the Broadcast narrative shifts in Phase Three, something in her that's been quiet for two years goes very still and then very loud, and she doesn't let anyone in the house see (MEN).
HOME INSTRUCTION	At her assessment Bell offered to nominate her for Home Instruction the following year, as a consolation (DR3). OPEN QUESTION What is it?

WHAT HER OWN HOUSE LOOKS LIKE, AND WHAT SHE DOES THERE ON THE OTHER FIVE DAYS

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

TKC: MEN · DR3 · FR 14

VOL. I · 509 · 527

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	She believes in Eden completely (MEN). INFERENCE Her faith is in a person before it's in a doctrine.
WHO TAUGHT HER	Celeste, from the age of six. Before that, Miriam, and Leah remembers her mother's leaving as a decision (FR 14).
WHAT SHE DEFENDS	Miriam, to the others (FR 14). INTERPRETATION She's the angriest and the most loyal, and those come from the same place.
WHAT SHE HAS NO WORDS FOR	Being unready, because the Empire hasn't built a way to say it (MEN).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

A Commonwife who doesn't conceive on the Covenant timeline is a household problem with a quarterly visit (MEN). POSSIBLE The Temple preaches "be fruitful, and multiply" (Gen 1.28) and 1 Timothy 2.15, "she shall be saved in childbearing," and reads Michal's "no child unto the day of her death" (2 Sam 6.23) as a sentence passed on a woman who despised her husband.

WHAT SHE PRAYS FOR, AND WHETHER SHE WANTS IT ANSWERED

GEN 29–30

GEN 29.32

GEN 30.1

1 SAM 1

ISA 54.1

ISA 56.3–5

LUKE 11.27–28

PS 113.9

The text

HER NAME	Leah, Jacob's first wife, given to him by trickery, "tender eyed," and unloved. She bears six sons and a daughter, and names her first son saying "now therefore my husband will love me" (Gen 29.32).
WHERE IT BREAKS	The biblical Leah is the fertile wife. Leah Osei carries the name of the woman with children and lives the story of the sister without them. Rachel says "Give me children, or else I die" (Gen 30.1).
HANNAH · 1 SAMUEL 1	POSSIBLE Provoked for years, praying with her lips moving and no sound, and taken for drunk by the priest. **Where it breaks:** Hannah's husband asks "am not I better to thee than ten sons?" Leah's husband makes the officer's comment, less carefully (MEN).

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER IN THE TEMPLE
Genesis 29.32, if she ever let herself say it	Isaiah 54.1, "Sing, O barren, thou that didst not bear"
	Isaiah 56.4–5, promised to eunuchs who'd have no children: "a name better than of sons and of daughters"
	Luke 11.27–28, "Blessed is the womb that bare thee... Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it"

The Temple likes Psalm 113.9, "He maketh the barren woman to keep house, and to be a joyful mother of children."

> VOLUME ONE
>
> Genesis, the women, 252. Hannah, Abigail and Michal, 380. The Binding, 510. Commonwives and the Covenant timeline, 512. Being sorted, and Leah's assessment, 508.

Body and fear

TKC: MEN · DOM

CONTENT NOTE Reproductive pressure.

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	Two years watched for a pregnancy (**MEN**). Two days a week she can breathe (**MEN**).
WHAT SHE DOES WITH IT	She doesn't let anyone in Celeste's house see what the Broadcast does to her (**MEN**).
WHAT SHE'S AFRAID WILL HAPPEN	**INFERENCE** A formal note, then Temple review, then whatever's past it (Vol. I, 530).

WHAT SHE'S AFRAID IS TRUE, AS OPPOSED TO WHAT SHE FEARS WILL HAPPEN

WHAT HER BODY DOES AT THE KITCHEN TABLE THAT ZION HAS LEARNED TO READ

TKC: MEN · FR 14

YOURS

Belief arc

STATION	WHAT SHE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT SHE DOES	CH.
I · At six	Her mother decided to go (FR 14)		
II · Bound	INFERENCE The Binding is survivable if she can still get to the kitchen	The quota pressure starts (MEN)	
III · Phase Three	Eden will come home	The Broadcast's narrative turns on Eden (MEN)	
IV · On the last page			

WHAT SHE DOES ON THE NIGHT THE NARRATIVE SHIFTS, AFTER SHE LEAVES CELESTE'S HOUSE

WHO SHE TELLS, IF ANYONE

Names, not roles

TKC: MEN · DR3 · FR 11 · FR 14

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
EDEN	Complete belief (MEN)	
ZION	The table, and everything they don't say at it (MEN)	
CELESTE	The only place she still feels like herself (MEN)	
HER HUSBAND	What the Empire told him to expect (MEN)	His, and the officer's
THE VOWED OFFICER	A quarterly visit and an informal comment (MEN)	Hers
MIRIAM	Watched her pack. Defends her. (FR 11, 14)	
BELL	A consolation nomination (DR3)	

HER HUSBAND'S NAME, HIS WORK, AND ONE THING HE DOES THAT SURPRISES HER

TKC: MEN · FR 14

WRITING

Voice and contradiction

THE CONTRADICTION	INFERENCE She's the angriest at Miriam and the one who defends her (FR 14). She's furious about a decision and lives inside one she didn't make.
WHAT IT COSTS	_

LINES ONLY LEAH WOULD SAY

WHAT SHE SAYS TO MIRIAM'S DEFENSE WHEN ZION GOES QUIET

The machinery around her

Leah lives inside the system the Trials sit on top of. A Commonwife is a registration status (FR 1), assessed quarterly in Aurem by a Vowed officer who notices when two years pass without a pregnancy (MEN). Her husband was given a wife and told what to expect, and the Empire built no way for her to say she isn't ready (MEN).

Above her, Aurem itself made marriage look like the highest honor a woman can get, on purpose (DOM). Behind her is a mother who lived the same registration and was moved to another man's house when her husband left (FR 0). In front of her, every evening at seven, is her sister's score (TR).

MEN | DOM | FR 0–1

THE CLOCK

Two years and counting. What happens after Temple review is still yours to decide (Vol. I, 530).

MARGINALIA

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, Commonwives, 527.

TKC: MEN

Leah and Zion

They sit at Celeste's table and don't talk about the things they can't talk about, and the not-talking is its own communication (MEN). He misses her in a way he has no words for and carries it as anger (MEN).

WHAT LEAH ISN'T SAYING

WHAT ZION ISN'T SAYING

THE ONE EVENING IT BREAKS, AND WHAT GETS SAID

PUT PRESSURE ON THE BELIEF

THE SCAFFOLD
The belief, in her words
Who can challenge it
A room she can't leave
Who else is watching, and for whom
What the other person wants
What she wants
What she says
What she won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING LEAH'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH



TKC: MEN · TL · DR3 · FR 0 · FR 13 · RULING

VOL. I · 507

PART I · DOSSIER 6 · ◈ · SHORT

Zion

*He's waiting for Eden to come back and tell him what she found. He doesn't know exactly what he's waiting for. He knows he's waiting (**MEN**).*

ON THE RECORD

Zion Osei, eighteen (DECIDED). Common designation, labor track, Aurelia assignment, marriage eligible (**MEN**). Works maintenance and infrastructure. Lives in Celeste's house, signs its forms, and looks after Solomon (**MEN, DR3**).

STILL OPEN

What the men told him at his Speaking, who he's expected to marry by twenty-one, and whether he ever mentions the yard.

TKC: MEN · DR3 · TL · FR 0 · FR 13 · RULING

VOL. I · 505 · 507

The record and the man

Covenant Declaration

CROWN OFFICE · AURELIA

REGISTERED AT EIGHTEEN · COMMON DESIGNATION

NAME	*OSEI, Zion*
BORN	*2085 (INFERENCE) · Thomas's son (**FR 2**)*
TRACK	*labor · Aurelia assignment*
MARRIAGE	*eligible*
DESIGNATION SCORES	*strong, not exceptional · not flagged*
HOUSEHOLD AUTHORITY	*Parish household, from his eighteenth year*

DECLARED

THE WORK	Aurelia's service sector, maintenance and infrastructure, the same general category Thomas worked in. He doesn't know that, and nobody's told him (**MEN**).
THE HOUSE	Unmarried common men without independent housing have nowhere else to go (**MEN**). Past twenty-two it's the labor dormitory (**MEN**).
THE FORM	When Solomon's form came back asking for the next adult male, Zion signed. Celeste hadn't wanted him to (**DR3**).
THE YARD	He remembers being outside the day Miriam left and has never mentioned it (**FR 13**).
THE BLESSING	His scores were strong but not exceptional, so no Crown education officer came for him. It's the only thing about his Designation Celeste counts as an uncomplicated blessing (**MEN**).

DECIDED Zion is eighteen (**Ruling**). **SUPERSEDED** Nineteen (**MEN**). **CONFLICT** Men in the Empire puts his Speaking "two years ago," while Eden "was already watching the trials" and away from Aurelia. At eighteen his Speaking was in 2103, and Eden was home.

Faith and scripture

PS 137.1

ISA 62.1

ZECH 9.9

2 THESS 3.10

VOL. I · 417 · 507 · 513

WHAT HE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** The files give his work, his house and his waiting, and nothing about God. **INFERENCE** He was raised at the same table as Eden.
WHO TAUGHT HIM	Celeste. And the men of the outer district, the night before his Declaration, each saying one true thing about being a man in Aurelia. No father, no Thomas, no Osei man at all. Celeste sat outside the room and wept, because it shouldn't have been her place and there she was again (MEN).
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A MAN LIKE HIM	Service as freedom. The Empire's trick is making common men feel like the system's beneficiaries while using them to enforce it (MEN). **POSSIBLE** He hears 2 Thessalonians 3.10, "if any would not work, neither should he eat," at every labor service.
HIS NAME	Zion is a place before it's a person: Jerusalem's hill, and the city addressed as "daughter of Zion" (Zech 9.9). "By the rivers of Babylon, there we sat down, yea, we wept, when we remembered Zion" (Ps 137.1).
WHERE IT BREAKS	"For Zion's sake will I not hold my peace" (Isa 62.1). Everyone in scripture speaks for Zion. This Zion doesn't speak, and carries what he misses as anger that comes out sideways (MEN).

Volume One: the names in the cast, 404. Men, labor and the economy, 492. The Speaking, in lived religion, 498.

ONE TRUE THING A MAN TOLD HIM AT HIS SPEAKING

TKC: MEN · TL · DR3 · FR 13

Who he's looking after

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
EDEN	He promised her he'd look after Celeste (**TL**). He's waiting for her to come back (**MEN**).
CELESTE	He signed the form she didn't want signed (**DR3**)
LEAH	Missed, with no words for it. The table and what they don't say at it (**MEN**).
SOLOMON	He takes care of him (**MEN**)
THOMAS	A man he has no memory of (**FR 0**), in the same line of work

WHAT MAKES ZION LAUGH

LINES ONLY ZION WOULD SAY

Write the night of the Speaking

WRITING

Ten minutes. The men are in the room, Zion can't speak, and Celeste is on the other side of the door.

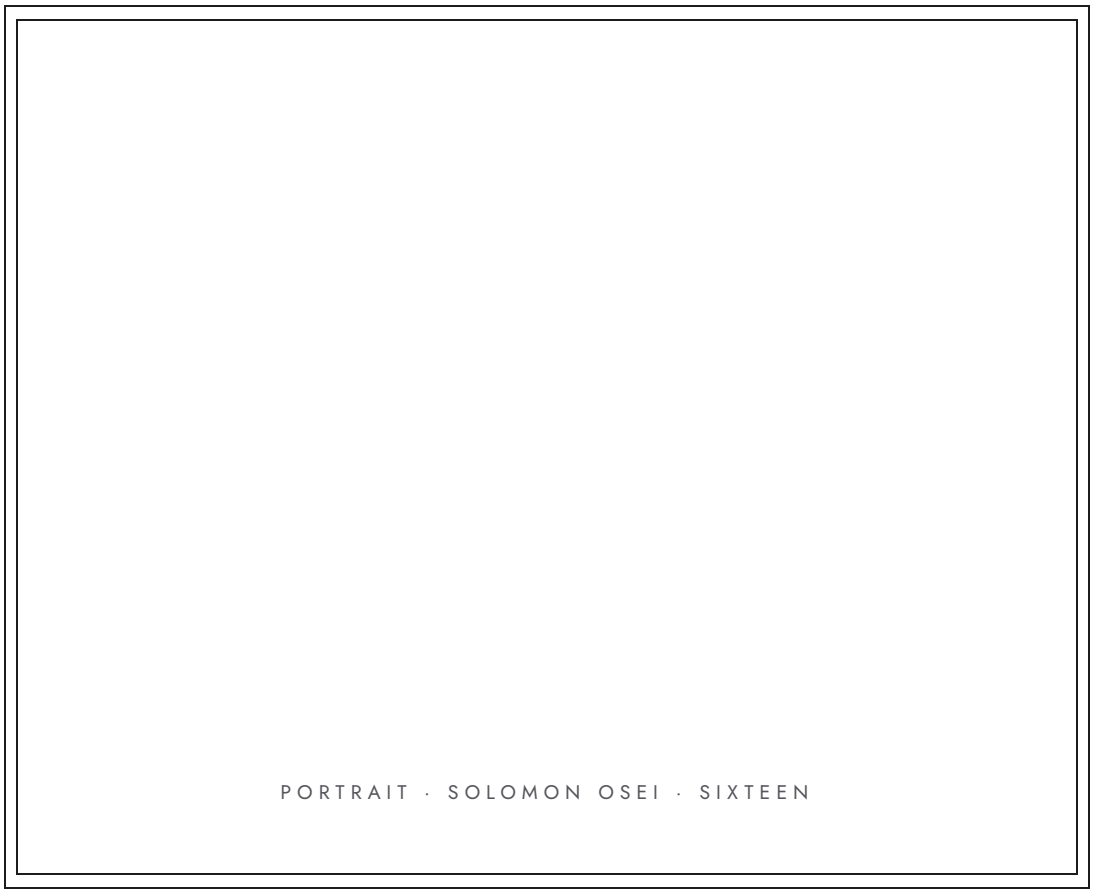
WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

TKC: MEN · TL · FR 0 · FR 11

VOL. I · 507



PART I · DOSSIER 7 · ◈ · SHORT

Solomon

*He's doing exactly what Eden feared he would: excelling in Imperial school in the way that gets boys flagged (**MEN**).*

ON THE RECORD

Solomon Osei, sixteen. Designation in two years. Extraordinary theological reasoning, governance aptitude in the top percentile of his cohort, and two informal teacher notes already with the Crown education office (**MEN**). He prays over Eden before she leaves (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

How he kept the Osei name, what he knows about his father, and what he does when the officer knocks (**FR 0**).

The Record and the Boy

TKC: MEN · FR 0 · FR 11 · RULING

VOL. I · 507 · 523

Informal Note

CROWN EDUCATION OFFICE · AURELIA

FILED BY A TEACHER · NOT AN OFFICIAL FLAG

STUDENT	*OSEI, Solomon · sixteen*
THEOLOGICAL REASONING	*extraordinary*
GOVERNANCE APTITUDE	*top percentile of cohort*
NOTES ON FILE	*two*
BECOMES A FLAG	*at seventeen, when the pre-Designation assessment begins*

NOTED

HIS FATHER	The man Miriam was reassigned to after Thomas left (FR 0). He was two in 2090 (FR 11). OPEN QUESTION Why did he keep the Osei name?
THE COACHING	Celeste is teaching him exactly how much of himself to show in which rooms, the way Red Earth mothers coach their sons. He understands what she's teaching. He's sixteen, and sometimes he forgets to hide it, and they have the conversation again (MEN).
THE DOOR THAT OPENS ONCE	A Crown education officer comes within three months of exceptional scores, with a scholarship to the Imperial Education Track. Declining routes a boy to the worst labor for life. Accepting makes him Crown-adjacent for life (MEN).
WHAT EDEN DOESN'T KNOW	The notes. She finds out in book two, and it's the moment she understands winning wasn't the end of anything (MEN).

SUPERSEDED Thirteen (TL). DECIDED Sixteen.

2 SAM 12.24–25

1 KGS 3.9

1 KGS 5.13

1 KGS 12.4

DAN 1.3–8

1 SAM 3.10

VOL. I · 136 · 413 · 507

Faith and scripture

WHAT HE BELIEVES	He prays over his sister before she leaves (TL). INFERENCE A boy whose theological reasoning is extraordinary has been arguing with the Book of Covenant in his head for years.
WHO TAUGHT HIM	Celeste, and the Imperial school, which is grading him for it (MEN).
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A BOY LIKE HIM	The Track is offered as opportunity and honor (MEN). POSSIBLE The officer quotes 1 Samuel 3.10, the boy in the temple who answers "thy servant heareth."
HIS NAME	Solomon, born to David and Bathsheba after the household broke, and named Jedidiah, "beloved of the LORD," by Nathan (2 Sam 12.24–25). Offered anything, he asks for "an understanding heart" (1 Kgs 3.9).
WHERE IT BREAKS	The biblical Solomon built with conscripted labor, and the north revolted over his "grievous" yoke (1 Kgs 5.13, 12.4). Solomon Osei is the boy the Crown wants to conscript.
DANIEL · DANIEL 1	POSSIBLE The king orders young men "skilful in all wisdom" brought to the palace and trained for three years. It reads like the Imperial Education Track, in a story set in the sixth century BCE. **Where it breaks:** Daniel "purposed in his heart that he would not defile himself with the portion of the king's meat" (1.8). Solomon hasn't been asked yet.

Volume One: Ezekiel and Daniel, 132. Kingmakers, prophets and priests, with Solomon, 400. Men, labor and the economy, 492.

THE PRAYER HE PRAYS OVER EDEN, WORD FOR WORD

Who's protecting him

TKC: MEN · TL · DR3 · FR 0

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
CELESTE	The coaching, again and again (**MEN**)
EDEN	She entered the Trials partly for him, and doesn't know about the notes (**MEN**)
ZION	Looks after him, and signed his form (**MEN, DR3**)
HIS FATHER	
HIS TEACHERS	Two notes (**MEN**)

THE THING HE SAYS IN CLASS THAT HE SHOULDN'T HAVE

LINES ONLY SOLOMON WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write the knock

Ten minutes. The pre-Designation assessment is a year away, and somebody from the Crown education office is at the door early.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

Working Questions for the Household

YOURS

OPEN QUESTIONS

BACK MATTER LOG

1 · WHO NAMED LEAH, ZION AND SOLOMON, AND DID CELESTE APPROVE OF THE NAMES?

2 · WHAT DOES THE HOUSE LOOK LIKE? DRAW THE FLOOR PLAN, AND MARK WHERE EACH PERSON SLEEPS.

3 · WHAT DOES THE HOUSEHOLD LIVE ON, WEEK TO WEEK, AND WHO EARNS IT?

4 · WHICH NEIGHBORS WERE AT ZION'S SPEAKING, AND WHICH WOMEN WOULD COME FOR CELESTE'S TELLING?

5 · WHAT DOES EACH CHILD CALL MIRIAM WHEN THEY TALK ABOUT HER, AND WHAT DO THEY CALL HER WHEN CELESTE CAN HEAR?

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

5 · WHAT DOES EACH CHILD CALL MIRIAM WHEN THEY TALK ABOUT HER, AND WHAT DO THEY CALL HER WHEN CELESTE CAN HEAR?

II

PART TWO · ✦

House Aurem

A townhouse on Covenant Row, four professionals who've done this before, and the minister back home who wouldn't sign.

i · The House and the people in it	116
Hannah	119
Naomi	136
Mirielle	148
Gavin	153
Abigail	158
Senior Minister Bell	164
The Aurem officials	171
Working questions for House Aurem	173

TL | CR | FR 26–34

THE HOUSE'S YEAR

One Covenant Daughter. Aurem has produced fifteen Anointed Wives in thirty-eight Trials, more than any other Dominion, so an Aurem House is expected to win (DOM).

MARGINALIA

The House and the people in it

House Aurem is one of twelve townhouses on Covenant Row, five minutes' walk from Sovereign Boulevard, wired in every common area and garden and left unwatched in the bedrooms (CR). A House hosts one Covenant Daughter per Trial, and its staff serve across many (FR 26). Eden's are the House Mother, the House Coordinator, the stylist and the Debate and Protocol Advisor (TL).

They're professionals, and each has watched girls lose. Hannah has done six Trials and has twelve girls across her career, none of them hers (TL, FR 26). Gavin has dressed girls who were smarter and richer and better placed than Eden (TL). Abigail reads candidates for a living (TL). What they want from Eden is mostly what the Empire wants from her, until it isn't, and the dossiers track where each one's loyalty actually sits. Senior Minister Bell is the odd one out. He's in Aurelia, not the Crownward, and his part of the story is over before Eden boards the train. He's here because Eden carries what he did with her into every room the House puts her in (DR3).

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, arrival and the Covenant Houses, 567.

House Aurem, drawn

TKC: CR · TR · TL

VOL. I · 567 · 499

WHERE IT IS	Covenant Row, parallel to Sovereign Boulevard on the Sovereign Side, under five minutes' walk from the Boulevard (**CR**).
WHAT'S WATCHED	Every common area, entrance and garden. The bedrooms aren't, by calculation and not decency, because unwatched bedrooms keep candidates manageable (**CR**).
WHO KNOWS THE GAPS	Hannah knows the back staircases and the camera gaps, and always has (**TL**).

HOUSE AUREM · FLOOR PLAN · MARK THE CAMERAS, THE BACK STAIRS AND THE ONE PLACE THEY AREN'T

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE ROOM IN THE HOUSE WHERE EACH OF THE FOUR STAFF GOES TO BE ALONE



PORTRAIT · HANNAH · HOUSE MOTHER OF HOUSE AUREM

TKC: TL · FR 26–34

VOL. I · 393 · 561 · 567

PART II · DOSSIER 8 · ✦

HANNAH

*Six Trials. Twelve girls. None of them hers (**TL**). She doesn't let herself feel what she can't act on, so she's built a very precise system for acting on everything that matters.*

ON THE RECORD

House Mother of House Aurem. Formerly Vowed (**FR 30**). Twelve girls across her career, six through Aurem Trials and six through earlier posts (**FR 26**). Her daughter Naomi has one year left in Vowed education (**TL**). Knows the back staircases and the camera gaps (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

Her surname, her age, what Judah has "always known" about her (**TL**), and the year she's never said out loud (**FR 30**).

TKC: TL · FR 26 · FR 30–32 · FR 34

VOL. I · 501 · 529

The Registry card

Staff Record

TRIALS COMMISSION · HOUSE AUREM

COVENANT ROW · SOVEREIGN SIDE · CROWNWARD

NAME OF RECORD	*HANNAH*_____
POST	*House Mother · six Aurem Trials (**TL**)*
CAREER	*twelve Covenant Daughters, several Houses and posts (**FR 26**)*
FORMER DESIGNATION	*Vowed (**FR 30**)*
HOUSEHOLD	*her own · daughter Naomi eligible through it (**FR 31–32**)*
NAOMI'S FATHER	*elite ladder, below Crown level · living · not in the household (**FR 31**)*
2085	_____

HOUSE MOTHER

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HER
HANNAH	The House, the girls	
HOUSE MOTHER	The Commission, the Broadcast	
MOTHER	Naomi	

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

HER SURNAME, AND WHY NOBODY IN THE FILES USES IT

TKC: TL · FR 26 · FR 30–31 · FR 34 · FR 39

VOL. I · 561

Her years against the Empire's

YEAR	HER LIFE	SOURCE
c. 2060–67	Born. **INFERENCE** A Covenant Daughter in 2085 was between eighteen and twenty-five.	
2085	**INFERENCE** One of the twelve in the cancelled cohort. Assembled, prepared, measured against the others, then sent home with her designation intact and no placement.	FR 34, Vol. I, 561
	Vowed	FR 30
	A Binding on the elite ladder, below Crown level. Naomi born.	FR 31
	Naomi's father leaves the household. Why stays open.	FR 31
	Six earlier assignments, six girls	FR 26
	Six Aurem Trials, six girls	TL, FR 26
2104	The 39th. Eden. Naomi has a year left in Vowed education.	TL

OPEN QUESTION In what order did the 2085 cohort, the Vowed years and the Binding come? A woman leaves Vowed service through marriage (Vol. I, 501).

THE YEAR SHE'S NEVER SAID OUT LOUD, AS SHE'D TELL IT IF SHE EVER DID

The clerk's version and the true one

TKC: TL · TR · CR · FR 26–29

VOL. I · 567 · 573

ON THE LEDGER	House Mother. She travels to the Crownward with her Covenant Daughter and two Appointed Officers (**TR**), and she's staff across many Trials, never the House's owner (**FR 26**).
IN FACT	She knows the back staircases and the camera gaps, and always has (**TL**). She doesn't let herself feel things she can't act on, and has built a precise system for acting on everything that matters (**TL**).
WHAT A CAREER COSTS	FR 26 makes her twelve a career count, which "ages her in the work." Every one of the twelve was married down the ladder or went to the heir (**FR 19, 25**).
WHAT SHE CAN DO FOR NAOMI	Hannah can submit Naomi's name, and she isn't the only one who can. Naomi can self-nominate once she's eligible, the way Eden did. Hannah's power is influence and not legal control (**FR 27**).
WHAT DECIDES IT	If Eden wins, Hannah enters Naomi, because winning proves the ladder can be climbed. If Eden dies or is publicly rejected, Hannah gets her out, and the only exit is a designation lower than the Trials reach (**FR 29**).

WHAT HAPPENED TO EACH OF HER TWELVE GIRLS. NAME THE ONES YOU CAN.

TKC: TL · FR 30 · CR

VOL. I · 501 · 509 · 518

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	The Temple, as a Vowed woman (**FR 30**). The Crownward's Vowed are trained to perform devotion under close observation, and to hold what they know in memory instead of on paper (**CR**).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**INFERENCE** Act on everything that matters, and feel nothing you can't act on (**TL**). **OPEN QUESTION** Whether she believes in God, the Temple, or only in the system she's built.
WHAT SHE CAN RECITE	**INFERENCE** Everything a Vowed woman is formed in, and everything a House Mother says on camera.
WHAT SHE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	**INFERENCE** What she knows about the camera gaps, and whatever she does with them.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

A House Mother serves the House, and the House "always judges fairly" (**DR3**). **POSSIBLE** The Temple preaches 1 Samuel 1.28, "I have lent him to the LORD," at every House Mother's commissioning, so handing over a girl who isn't hers becomes the highest kind of motherhood. It never preaches what Hannah does with her own.

WHAT SHE PRAYS, IF SHE PRAYS, THE NIGHT BEFORE A DECLARATION

The text

1 SAM 1–2

1 SAM 1.15

1 SAM 1.28

1 SAM 2.4–8

ESTH 2.8–9, 15

JER 38.7–13

HER NAME	Hannah, the mother of Samuel, who prays at Shiloh with no sound and is taken for drunk, vows her son to the sanctuary, and brings him a little robe every year. Her song is the model for Mary's (Vol. I, 393).
WHERE IT BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** The story runs in reverse. Biblical Hannah gives the son she prayed for. This Hannah gives other women's daughters every year and is deciding whether to give her own (FR 29, Vol. I, 393).
HEGAI · ESTHER 2	**POSSIBLE** The keeper of the women in the king's house, who prefers Esther, gives her what she needs, and whose advice she follows: she "required nothing but what Hegai... appointed" (2.15). **Where it breaks:** Hegai's job ends at the king's door. Hannah's girls are hers to place, to lose, and to watch married down.
EBED-MELECH · JEREMIAH 38	**POSSIBLE** A palace servant who gets the king's permission and pulls a prophet out of a cistern with ropes and rags (Vol. I, 419). **Where it breaks:** Ebed-melech acts once, in the open. Hannah's whole method is the camera gaps.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
1 Samuel 1.15, "I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit," if she ever said it aloud	1 Samuel 2.4–8, the bows of the mighty broken and the poor raised from the dust
	Esther 2.15, where the girl wins by taking the keeper's advice

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Hannah, Abigail and Michal, 393. Echoes, labeled, 419. Esther, 399. The Temple and the Vowed, 501. The Trials' history and the 2085 cohort, 561.

TKC: TL · FR 23–25 · FR 29

Body and fear

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	**INFERENCE** A woman who never lets herself feel what she can't act on has a body that's learned to wait (**TL**).
WHAT SHE'S AFRAID WILL HAPPEN	Eden dies or is publicly rejected, and Naomi has to be taken out of reach of the Trials (**FR 29**). A candidate's death costs the Trial nothing, and her status simply goes back to her family (**FR 23–24**).
WHAT SHE'S AFRAID IS TRUE	–

WHAT HER BODY DOES WHEN THE EVENING RECKONING COMES UP AND EDEN'S NAME HAS MOVED

THE NIGHT SHE WAS MOST AFRAID IN SIX TRIALS, AND WHAT SHE DID WITH HER HANDS

Belief arc

TKC: FR 29–30 · FR 34

YOURS

STATION	WHAT SHE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT SHE DOES	CH.
I · 2085	INFERENCE The Trials are a ladder, and she's on it	The Trial is cancelled mid-cycle and the twelve go home with no placements (FR 34, FR 39)	
II · House Mother	Act on everything that matters (TL)		
III · Eden		Eden wins, or dies, or is rejected (FR 29)	
IV · Naomi			

WHO NOTICES SHE'S CHANGED, AND WHAT SHE DOES TO HIDE IT

TKC: TL · FR 27–34

Who she can move, and who can move her

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
NAOMI	Influence, not legal control, over whether she enters (**FR 27**)	
EDEN	The proof, either way, of whether the ladder can be climbed (**FR 29**)	
NAOMI'S FATHER	Elite ladder, below Crown level, living, gone from the household (**FR 31**)	
JUDAH	He knows about Hannah, and has always known (**TL**)	
THE 2085 COHORT	Eleven women who were measured against her, scattered through their Dominions. A network that doesn't wake before book two (**FR 34**).	
MIRIELLE · GAVIN · ABIGAIL	Her staff, or her colleagues. Decide which.	

POSSIBLE Four people know Azrael is alive, Judah, Lyris and two others (**TL**). Judah "has always known" about Hannah. One of the two others could be her.

WHAT JUDAH KNOWS ABOUT HER

Voice and contradiction

TKC: TL · FR 29

WRITING

THE CONTRADICTION	**INFERENCE** She delivers other women's daughters to the ladder every year and plans to keep her own off it unless the ladder proves it can be climbed (**FR 29**).
WHAT IT COSTS	—

LINES ONLY HANNAH WOULD SAY

HOW SHE SPEAKS TO THE CAMERAS, AND HOW SHE SPEAKS IN THE GAPS

TL | FR 27–34

THE EXIT

A designation lower than the Trials reach. It saves Naomi from the ladder by taking her off it.

MARGINALIA

The machinery around her

Hannah works inside the Trials as staff, which means the machinery runs through her hands every day. She knows where it's blind, the back staircases and the camera gaps (TL), and she's built her life on acting only where she can.

The rules around her daughter are fixed. Eligibility isn't entry, anyone can submit a name, and Naomi can submit her own (FR 27). A child's status comes through household registration, so Naomi is eligible through Hannah's household and standing, whatever her father's place (FR 31–32). The only door out of the Trials' reach is a lower designation (FR 29). Underneath all of it is 2085, the cohort that was assembled and measured and then sent home when Crest died and the Trial was cancelled (FR 34, FR 39). INFERENCE Hannah was one of the twelve. She's never said it out loud, and Naomi doesn't know (FR 30).

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the designations, 521.

The Trial that didn't happen

TKC: FR 34 · FR 39

INFERENCE

WRITING

INFERENCE In 2085 Hannah was one of twelve young women assembled, prepared and measured against each other, and then Crest died mid-cycle, Dorian's accession forced a transition, and the Trial was cancelled. The twelve went home with their designations intact and no placements (**FR 34**, **FR 39**).

1 · WHERE SHE WAS WHEN SHE HEARD, AND WHO TOLD HER

2 · WHAT SHE LEARNED ABOUT THE OTHER ELEVEN IN THOSE WEEKS

3 · WHAT SHE DECIDED ON THE WAY HOME, AND WHEN SHE FIRST ACTED ON IT

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Write her on the back stairs

Ten minutes of Hannah at two in the morning, walking House Aurem when no one's awake. No girl to manage, no camera on her.

If you stall: which stair creaks · what she checks first · what she carries · the room she doesn't go into · what she says to herself about Eden · what she'd write to Naomi if letters were safe.

WRITE

Hannah and Naomi

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 29–30

Naomi knows her mother was Vowed and is now House Mother. The cancelled cohort is what Hannah has never said out loud (**FR 30**).

WHAT HANNAH WANTS FOR NAOMI, AND WON'T SAY

WHAT NAOMI WANTS, AND HASN'T TOLD HER MOTHER

THE CONVERSATION AFTER THE DECLARATION, WHICHEVER WAY IT GOES

WRITING

SCENE LAB

Put pressure on the belief

THE SCAFFOLD
The belief, in her words
Who can challenge it
A room she can't leave
Who else is watching, and for whom
What the other person wants
What she wants
What she says
What she won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING HANNAH'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 29–33

VOL. I · 391 · 501

PORTRAIT · NAOMI · HANNAH'S DAUGHTER · VOWED EDUCATION, FINAL YEAR

PART II · DOSSIER 9 · ✦

Naomi

*Her whole future turns on a girl she's never met. If Eden wins, her mother enters her in the Trials. If Eden dies or is publicly rejected, her mother gets her out (**FR 29**).*

ON THE RECORD

Hannah's daughter, one year from the end of the Vowed education program (**TL**). Eligible for the Trials through her mother's household and standing (**FR 31–32**). She keeps the name Naomi (**FR 33**).

STILL OPEN

Her age, where she studies, what she wants, and whether she'd enter if nobody asked her.

The Registry card

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 31–33

VOL. I · 501 · 529 · 563

Vowed Education Record

TEMPLE · _____

FINAL YEAR · ONE YEAR REMAINING (**TL**)

NAME OF RECORD	*NAOMI*_____
HOUSEHOLD	*Hannah's · eligibility through it (**FR 31–32**)*
FATHER	*elite ladder, below Crown level · living · not in the household (**FR 31**)*
COVENANT REGISTRY	*eligible once of age · not entered (**FR 27**)*
ENTRY	*by her mother's submission, or her own (**FR 27**)*

ELIGIBLE

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HER
NAOMI	Her mother	
	Her Vowed instructors	

The Prelate was renamed so Hannah's daughter could keep this name. "Nomi" was rejected as too close (**FR 33**).

HOW OLD SHE IS, AND HOW LONG UNTIL SHE'S ELIGIBLE

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 29–32

VOL. I · 501 · 523

The clerk's version and the true one

ON THE LEDGER	A Vowed education student in her final year, eligible through her mother's household (**TL, FR 31–32**).
WHAT SHE KNOWS	Her mother was Vowed and is now House Mother. She doesn't know about 2085 (**FR 30**).
WHAT'S BEING DECIDED FOR HER	Whether she enters. Hannah can submit her name and isn't the only one who can, and Naomi can self-nominate once she's eligible, the way Eden did (**FR 27**).
WHAT DECIDES IT	Eden. A win means Hannah enters her. A death or a public rejection means Hannah gets her out through a designation lower than the Trials reach (**FR 29**).
HER FATHER	Still living, on the elite ladder below Crown level, no longer in Hannah's household. Why he left stays open (**FR 31**).

WHAT A DAY IN VOWED EDUCATION LOOKS LIKE, HOUR BY HOUR

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

TKC: TL · CR · FR 30

VOL. I · 501 · 509

WHO TEACHES HER	The Vowed education program (**TL**). The Crownward's Vowed are formed for intelligence, theological precision, and perfect devotion under close observation (**CR**).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** The files are silent. **INFERENCE** She's being taught the Temple's faith by the people who'll later assess girls like her.
WHAT SHE DOESN'T KNOW	The cohort her mother was part of (**FR 30**), so her picture of the Trials is the Broadcast's.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A GIRL LIKE HER

POSSIBLE A Vowed student is the Temple's own, formed to serve and to observe. If she enters the Trials, she enters as the daughter of a House Mother and a former Vowed woman, already fluent in what the Settling is watching for.

WHAT SHE BELIEVES ABOUT GOD THAT HER INSTRUCTORS WOULD MARK CORRECT, AND WHAT THEY WOULDN'T

RUTH 1.20–21

1 SAM 2.18–19

1 SAM 3

NUM 27.1–7

The Text

HER NAME	Naomi, Ruth's mother-in-law, whose name means "pleasant." Coming home widowed and childless she says, "Call me not Naomi, call me Mara," bitter (Ruth 1.20).
WHERE IT BREAKS	The biblical Naomi is old and plans a younger woman's future. This Naomi is young, and her future is being planned (Vol. I, 391).
SAMUEL · 1 SAMUEL 2–3	**POSSIBLE** The son of a woman named Hannah, raised in the sanctuary, ministering "before the LORD, being a child," with a little coat his mother brings every year (2.18–19). **Where it breaks:** Samuel is called by name at night, and the old priest teaches him to answer. Nobody's told Naomi there's anything to answer.
THE DAUGHTERS OF ZELOPHEHAD · NUMBERS 27	**POSSIBLE** Five sisters who bring their own petition and win it: "The daughters of Zelophehad speak right" (27.7). **Where it breaks:** Self-nomination is open to Naomi (**FR 27**). Whether she'd use it is the question.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
	Ruth 1.20, the bitterness inside her own name
	Numbers 27.7, a petition that wins

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Ruth and Naomi, 391. Hannah, 393. Numbers, two petitions, 159. The Temple and the Vowed, 501. Eligibility and nomination, 563.

Body and fear

TKC: FR 29

WRITING

WHAT THE VOWED HAVE TRAINED HER BODY TO DO IN A WATCHED ROOM

WHAT SHE'S AFRAID WILL HAPPEN, AND WHAT SHE'S AFRAID IS TRUE

TKC: FR 27 · FR 29–30

YOURS

Belief arc

STATION	WHAT SHE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT SHE DOES	CH.
I · Vowed education			
II · Watching Eden			
III · After the Declaration		Her mother's decision either way (**FR 29**)	
IV · Book two			

WHETHER SHE EVER FINDS OUT ABOUT 2085, AND FROM WHOM

Names, not roles

TKC: TL · FR 27 · FR 29–31

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
HANNAH		Influence, not legal control (**FR 27**)
HER FATHER		
EDEN	A stranger whose result decides her life (**FR 29**)	
HER INSTRUCTORS		

WHO SHE'D TELL FIRST IF SHE DECIDED TO ENTER HERSELF

WRITING

Voice and contradiction

LINES ONLY NAOMI WOULD SAY

THE THING SHE BELIEVES AND ALSO BREAKS

WHAT IT COSTS, AND THE SCENE WHERE IT LANDS

Write her watching the Broadcast

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Ten minutes of Naomi on an ordinary evening at seven, watching the Evening Reckoning wherever the Vowed students watch it. Eden's name is on the screen.

WRITE

WRITING

SCENE LAB

Put pressure on the belief

THE SCAFFOLD
The belief, in her words
Who can challenge it
A room she can't leave
Who else is watching, and for whom
What the other person wants
What she wants
What she says
What she won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

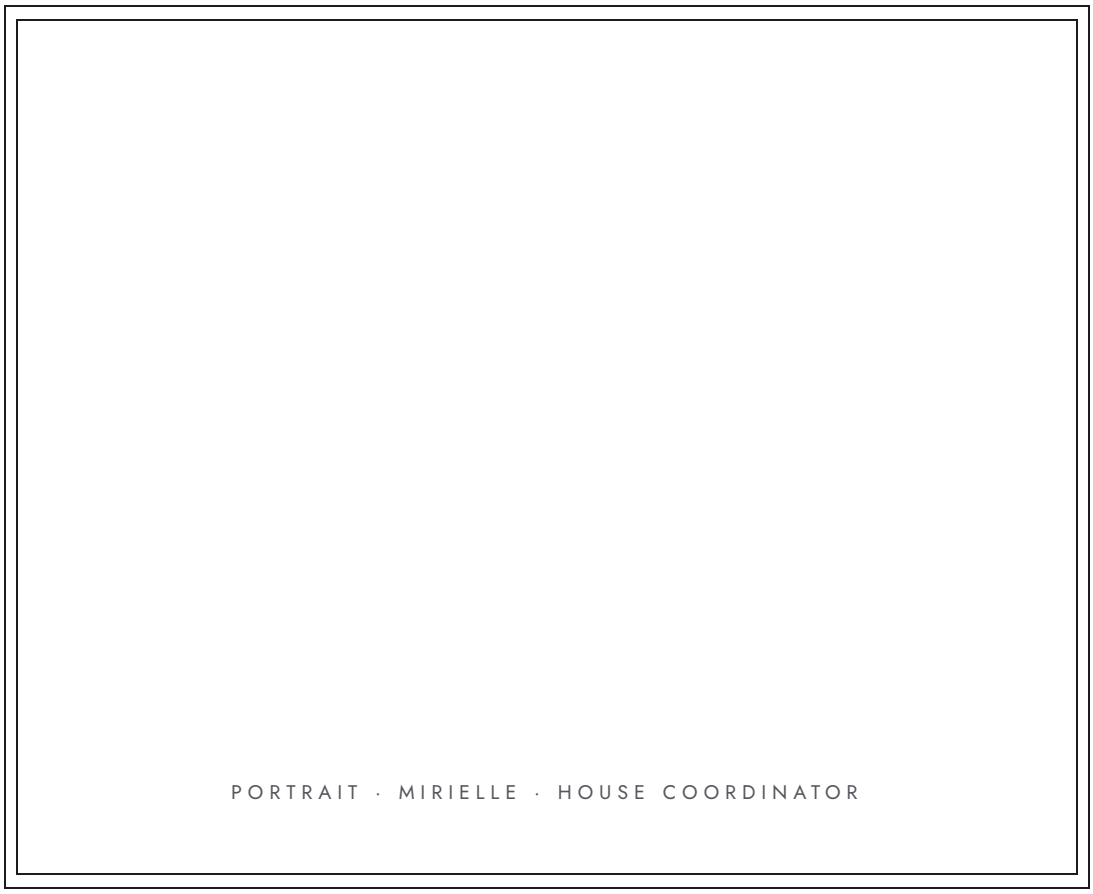
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NOTES

ANYTHING NAOMI'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

TKC: TL · CR · FR 26

VOL. I · 567



PART II · DOSSIER 10 · ✦ · SHORT

MIRIELLE

*She runs the House with the efficiency of someone who's decided not to waste time on things that won't help (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

House Coordinator of House Aurem. She hands Eden a shawl before Temple and says nothing else. She cries when Eden's name comes up first on the Sovereign Boulevard boards (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

How long she's served the House, where she's from, and who she cried for the last time a name came up first.

The record and the woman

TKC: TL · CR · FR 26

Staff Record

TRIALS COMMISSION · HOUSE AUREM

NAME	*MIRIELLE*_____
POST	*House Coordinator*
TRIALS SERVED	_____
DESIGNATION	_____

STAFF

WHAT SHE DOES	Runs the House (TL). INFERENCE Schedules, staff, the kitchen, the hours the cameras see and the ones they don't.
THE SHAWL	Before Temple she hands Eden a shawl and says nothing else (TL). INTERPRETATION The whole of her care is in the object.
THE BOARDS	When Eden's name comes up first, she cries (TL).

WHERE SHE'S FROM, AND HOW SHE CAME TO THE CROWNWARD

2 KGS 2.13–14

RUTH 3.9

EZEK 16.8

VOL. I · 391 · 413 · 513

Faith and scripture

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** The files give her efficiency and two gestures. **INFERENCE** A woman who cries at a girl's name on a board believes something about what the board means.
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER	**POSSIBLE** Service without credit is the Crownward's highest female virtue, the Arrangement without the marriage (Vol. I, 527).
HER NAME	*Mirielle* has no biblical source. It's a French name, related to Provençal *Mireille*, usually taken from a word meaning "to admire." To an English ear it sits close to Miriam, Eden's mother's name. Whether Eden hears that is yours.
A GARMENT ECHO	**POSSIBLE** The mantle Elijah leaves for Elisha (2 Kgs 2.13–14), and Ruth asking Boaz to spread his cloak over her (Ruth 3.9). A cloth handed over in silence is old scripture's way of saying someone's taken responsibility for you. **Where it breaks:** Mirielle says nothing, and nobody's taking an oath.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER

Volume One: Ruth, 391. Kingmakers, prophets and priests, with Elijah, 413.

WHAT SHE SAYS TO GOD, OR TO NO ONE, THE NIGHT EDEN PLACES FIRST

Who she runs the House for

TKC: TL

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
EDEN	A shawl, and tears at the boards (TL)
HANNAH	
GAVIN · ABIGAIL	
THE HOUSE STAFF BELOW HER	

LINES ONLY MIRIELLE WOULD SAY, AS FEW AS POSSIBLE

WRITING

Write the shawl

Ten minutes. The morning before Temple, the hallway, the shawl, and everything she doesn't say.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

PORTRAIT · GAVIN · STYLIST, HOUSE AUREM

PART II · DOSSIER 11 · ✦ · SHORT

Gavin

*He's never dressed anyone who understood that the dress isn't for her. He puts the bobby pin in every time. Every single time (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Stylist for House Aurem. Fourteen years, six Trials. He's dressed girls who were smarter, richer and better positioned than Eden (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

Who the dress is for, what the bobby pin holds, and which of his girls he still thinks about.

TKC: TL · MEN · FR 26

VOL. I · 507

The Record and the Man

Staff Record

TRIALS COMMISSION · HOUSE AUREM

NAME	*GAVIN*_____
POST	*Stylist · fourteen years · six Trials (**TL**)*
DESIGNATION	_____ *(MEN, by class)*
HOUSEHOLD	_____

STAFF

WHAT HE'S DONE	Fourteen years, six Trials, and girls smarter, richer and better placed than Eden (**TL**).
WHAT EDEN UNDERSTANDS	The dress isn't for her (**TL**). **INFERENCE** It's for the Broadcast, the Anointed Court and the screens, and she knows it.
THE BOBBY PIN	Every time (**TL**). **OPEN QUESTION** Where it goes, what it holds, and whether it's ever been more than a pin.
OPEN QUESTION	Which class of man is he, and whose approval did his marriage need, if he's married (Vol. I, 507)?

THE FIRST GIRL HE DRESSED FOR A TRIAL, AND WHAT HAPPENED TO HER

Faith and scripture

EXOD 28.2

EXOD 31.1–5

ESTH 2.12

MATT 6.28–29

VOL. I · 298 · 399

WHAT HE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** Nothing on file. **INFERENCE** Fourteen years of making girls look chosen has taught him something about what the Empire means by chosen.
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A MAN LIKE HIM	**POSSIBLE** A craftsman serving the House is honored as a steward of beauty, and never asked what he's dressing girls for.
HIS NAME	*Gavin* has no biblical source. It's a Scottish and Welsh name, from the knight Gawain.
THE PRIEST'S GARMENTS · EXODUS 28	**POSSIBLE** Aaron's garments are made "for glory and for beauty" (28.2), and Bezalel is filled with the spirit of God "in wisdom... and in all manner of workmanship" (31.3). **Where it breaks:** Those clothes dress a priest for God. Gavin's dress a girl for a camera.
ESTHER'S YEAR · ESTHER 2.12	**POSSIBLE** Twelve months of preparation, six with oil of myrrh and six with sweet odours. **Where it breaks:** The king's women had no say in it. Eden knows exactly what the dress is for.

HE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HIM
	Matthew 6.28–29, the lilies of the field, "even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these"

Volume One: Esther, 399. The calf, the purge and the face, with the priest's garments, 298.

WHAT HE THINKS GOD MAKES OF HIS WORK

TKC: TL

Who he dresses

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
EDEN	The dress, and the pin, every time (**TL**)
HANNAH · MIRIELLE · ABIGAIL	
THE OTHER HOUSES' STYLISTS	

LINES ONLY GAVIN WOULD SAY

Write the pin

WRITING

Ten minutes. Eden in the chair before the Anointed Evening, Gavin behind her, and the bobby pin.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

TKC: TL · WR 15 · WR 30

VOL. I · 393

PORTRAIT · ABIGAIL · DEBATE AND PROTOCOL ADVISOR · IN AMBER

PART II · DOSSIER 12 · ✦ · SHORT

ABIGAIL

*Pressure in a pretty dress. She doesn't need to threaten. A look, a small correction, a hand at the elbow or one soft line is enough (**WR 30**).*

ON THE RECORD

Debate and Protocol Advisor for House Aurem. She wears amber to the Theology debate, reads Eden the way professionals read what they've spent years learning, and called Serenity's question about Celeste almost to the word (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

Who Serenity is, what the question was, and why Abigail could see it coming.

The record and the woman

TKC: TL · TR · WR 30

VOL. I · 570

Staff Record

TRIALS COMMISSION · HOUSE AUREM

NAME	*ABIGAIL* _____
POST	*Debate and Protocol Advisor*
TRIALS SERVED	_____
DESIGNATION	_____

STAFF

WHAT SHE DOES	Prepares Eden for the Civic Debates, where the topic comes an hour before and the Broadcast edits the result (TR), and for the protocol of every watched room (TL).
HOW SHE READS	The way professionals read what they've spent years learning to read (TL).
THE AMBER	She wears it to the Theology debate (TL). OPEN QUESTION Is it a signal, and to whom?
SERENITY'S QUESTION	She called it, about Celeste, almost to the word (TL). OPEN QUESTION Who is Serenity? An interviewer, a Court wife, another candidate's advisor?

THE QUESTION SERENITY ASKED, AND THE ANSWER ABIGAIL DRILLED INTO EDEN

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE QUESTION SERENITY ASKED, AND THE ANSWER ABIGAIL DRILLED INTO EDEN

Faith and scripture

1 SAM 25

1 SAM 25.24–31

VOL. I · 393 · 417

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** Nothing on file. **INFERENCE** A woman who reads people for a living believes in what works in a room.
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER	**POSSIBLE** The Temple holds up the biblical Abigail as the model wife who calms an angry man with gifts and humility, and drops the part where she acts without telling her husband.
HER NAME	Abigail, Nabal's wife, who loads donkeys with food, rides out without telling her husband, kneels, takes the blame on herself, and talks an armed David out of a massacre he'd regret as king (1 Sam 25). The Talmud counts her among seven women prophets (Vol. I, 393).
WHERE IT BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** The biblical Abigail persuades a powerful man on her knees, once, on a road. This one teaches a girl how to do it on camera, every week, for a House.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
1 Samuel 25.24, "Upon me, my lord, upon me let this iniquity be"	1 Samuel 25.19, "But she told not her husband Nabal"

Volume One: Hannah, Abigail and Michal, 393. The names in the cast, 417.

WHAT ABIGAIL SAYS TO EDEN THAT THE BIBLICAL ABIGAIL SAID TO DAVID

TKC: TL · WR 15 · WR 30

Her voice

THE RULE	She needs her own rhythm, apart from the Empire's brochure voice (**WR 15**). She never over-threatens (**WR 30**).
ON THE PAGE	A look, a small correction, a hand at the elbow, one soft line (**WR 30**).

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
EDEN	A professional read, and a prediction that came true (**TL**)
SERENITY	
HANNAH	

LINES ONLY ABIGAIL WOULD SAY, EACH UNDER TEN WORDS

Write the hour before the Theology debate

WRITING

Ten minutes. The topic's just come in, Abigail is in amber, and there's an hour.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

TKC: DR3

VOL. I · 501 · 509 · 565

PORTRAIT · SENIOR MINISTER BELL · THE AURELIA TEMPLE

PART II · DOSSIER 13 · ✦ · SHORT

BELL

*He prayed that God would close every door not intended for her (**DR3**).*

ON THE RECORD

Senior Minister of the Aurelia Temple. He signs Binding certificates, sponsors Assessment candidates, and has known Celeste thirty-four years. He wouldn't sponsor Eden (**DR3**).

STILL OPEN

His first name, his wife, his own children, and whether he ever regrets the prayer.

The record and the man

TKC: DR3 · TL

VOL. I · 501 · 523

Binding Certificate

TEMPLE OF AURELIA

SIGNED BENEATH EACH HUSBAND'S NAME

OFFICIATING	*Senior Minister Bell*
BRIDE	_____
HUSBAND	_____
WITNESS	*a Vowed officiant*

BOUND

HIS OFFICE	Signs Binding certificates beneath each husband's name and sponsors Assessment candidates (**DR3**).
CELESTE	Thirty-four years. Her sweet potato pie at harvest suppers, and a call every winter when the Temple needs coats repaired. He greets her with both hands and calls her Mother Parish. She answers "Morning" and he keeps smiling (**DR3**).
EDEN	He kept her waiting while he signed certificates. He asked whether her father was dead and whether her mother was properly Bound when she was born, not about her grades. He offered Leah Home Instruction and prayed every door shut that wasn't intended for her (**DR3**).
THE ASSESSMENT	He speaks before the scores about "divine order, talent as stewardship, and elevation as burden," reads Proverbs 31.29 from the Book of Covenant, and closes, "May every daughter receive with grace the portion appointed to her" (**DR3**).

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHY HE WOULDN'T SPONSOR HER, IN HIS OWN WORDS, TO HIS WIFE THAT NIGHT

Faith and scripture

WHAT HE BELIEVES	"The House always judges fairly" (DR3). INFERENCE He believes in the Temple's order sincerely, and it's never cost him anything.
WHAT HE PREACHES	Divine order, talent as stewardship, elevation as burden (DR3).
HIS NAME	*Bell* has no biblical source. INTERPRETATION A bell calls people in and tells them what time it is.
ELI · 1 SAMUEL 1–2	POSSIBLE The priest at Shiloh who watches a praying woman's lips move and decides she's drunk. His sons abuse the office, and he rebukes them and does nothing (1 Sam 2.12–17, 22–25). **Where it breaks:** Eli corrects himself when Hannah answers him. Bell never asked Eden a question he didn't already have an answer for.
AMAZIAH · AMOS 7	POSSIBLE The priest of Bethel who tells a prophet to go home, because "it is the king's chapel, and it is the king's court" (7.13). **Where it breaks:** Amos answers him to his face. Eden went home and found the clause.

HE QUOTES	NEVER PREACHED FROM HIS PULPIT
Proverbs 31.29, "Many daughters have done virtuously, but thou excellest them all" (DR3)	Revelation 3.8, "I have set before thee an open door, and no man can shut it"
	Amos 7.14–15, a herdsman God sent anyway

Volume One: Hannah and Eli's misreading, 393. The Twelve, with Amos, 138. What the Temple teaches, 509.

THE PRAYER, WORD FOR WORD, AS HE SAID IT OVER EDEN

1 SAM 1.12–16

1 SAM 2.12–17

AMOS 7.10–13

REV 3.7–8

PROV 31.29

VOL. I · 393 · 138 · 509

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE PRAYER, WORD FOR WORD, AS HE SAID IT OVER EDEN

His voice

TKC: DR3

ON THE PAGE	"What a joy to see you." "The House always judges fairly." "May every daughter receive with grace the portion appointed to her." (**DR3**)

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
CELESTE	Thirty-four years of pie and coats, both hands, "Mother Parish" (**DR3**)
EDEN	A sponsorship he wouldn't give (**DR3**)
LEAH	A consolation, Home Instruction the following year (**DR3**)
THE OFFICIALS	Where his attention goes during the Assessment, instead of to Eden (**DR3**)

WHAT HE SAYS ABOUT EDEN AT THE HARVEST SUPPER AFTER SHE PLACES FIRST

WRITING

Write the sponsorship, from his side

Ten minutes. Eden is in the chair by his desk. He has certificates to sign and he signs them first.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO.

DATE

The Aurem officials

TKC: TR · TL · DR3 · MEN · DOM

VOL. I · 565 · 503 · 523

People with an office and no dossier yet. Each one moves Eden's file, and most of them don't have names. Give one a page in the notes when they start to matter.

OFFICE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	NAME
THE GOVERNOR-PRELATE OF AUREM	Chose Eden second although she ranked first. In practice a Governor-Prelate takes whoever the Crown has quietly signaled it prefers (**TR**).	
HIS FIRST CHOICE	Withdrew the night before departure. Officially a family health emergency. It wasn't, and who arranged it is a question Eden will eventually answer (**TR**).	
THE DESIGNATION OFFICER	The Vowed officer who assessed Eden at eighteen and filed the flag that day, "Exceptional intellect. Monitor closely," later updated to "Selected for Trial" (**TL**).	
THE FEE CLERK	Counted Eden's ten dollars and inspected both sides of every bill (**DR3**)	
LEAH'S HOUSEHOLD OFFICER	Runs the quarterly Commonwife assessment. Has made an informal comment and filed nothing yet (**MEN**).	
THE CROWN EDUCATION OFFICER	Hasn't knocked yet. Will, within three months of Solomon's scores (**MEN**).	
MARIBEL VALE	A girl at Eden's Assessment, whose faith needed less maintenance than Eden's (**DR3**)	

OPEN QUESTION Corinne Vale of Meridian and Maribel Vale of Aurem share a surname (**TR, DR3**). Related, or a coincidence to fix?

TKC: TR · TL

VOL. I · 570 · 501

In the Crownward

OFFICE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	NAME
THE THEOLOGICAL INTERVIEW OFFICER	A senior Vowed officer with twenty years of the work. She pursues Eden for two hours and files a report three pages longer than any other, ending "I cannot determine which. I am not certain the distinction matters as much as it should" (**TR**).	
EDEN'S VOWED HANDLER	Assigned for the Testimony. Eden declines her in writing three days before (**TR**).	
THE TWO APPOINTED OFFICERS	Travel with Eden and Hannah from Aurelia (**TR**)	
THE CROWN ADVISOR AT THE PAIRING	Tries to resist when Judah sends the officials out (**TR**)	
SERENITY	Asked a question about Celeste that Abigail predicted almost word for word (**TL**)	

THE OFFICIAL WHO MATTERS MOST THAT I HAVEN'T NAMED YET

Working Questions for House Aurem

YOURS

OPEN QUESTIONS

BACK MATTER LOG

1 · WHO ON THE HOUSE STAFF REPORTS TO WHOM OUTSIDE THE HOUSE? DOES ANYONE REPORT TO THE PRELATE, THE BROADCAST OR THE CROWN?

2 · WHAT DOES EACH OF THE FOUR WANT FOR EDEN, AND WHAT DO THEY WANT FOR THEMSELVES?

3 · WHAT HAPPENS TO HOUSE STAFF WHEN THEIR GIRL LOSES, OR DIES?

4 · HAS HANNAH EVER USED A CAMERA GAP FOR A GIRL BEFORE EDEN, AND WHAT DID IT COST?

5 · WHAT DOES THE HOUSE EAT, WHO COOKS IT, AND DOES ANY OF IT TASTE LIKE AURELIA?

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

5 · WHAT DOES THE HOUSE EAT, WHO COOKS IT, AND DOES ANY OF IT TASTE LIKE AURELIA?

III

PART THREE · ⌖

The Covenant Daughters

Twelve women, one from each Dominion. One goes to the heir, two never come home, and the rest are married down the elite ladder.

i · The twelve, and what happens to them	176
I · Eden Selah Osei, through the Trial	179
II · Delphine Fontenot	181
III · Maren Cole	189
IV · Corinne Vale	197
V · Calla Merritt	205
VI · Nadia Orin	213
VII · Ruth Gideon	221
VIII · Delia Cross	229
IX · Vivienne Hale	237
X · Petra Solano	245
XI · Zara Voss	252
XII · Sera Montoya	260

TR | DOM | FR 19–25

EDEN

Her full dossier is in Part I. Her path through the Trial is on the pages after the fates.

MARGINALIA

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the Covenant Daughters of the 39th, 575.

Eleven more people

Every one of these women was raised somewhere specific, sorted by a Designation built for her Dominion, nominated by someone with a reason, and sent to the Crownward carrying more than the Broadcast will ever show. The Writing Rules ask for their own rhythms, so Eden, Ruth, Zara, Delphine, Petra and Abigail don't all sound like Imperial brochures (WR 15). These dossiers are where you find the rhythms.

Each dossier runs the same way. The portrait and the Registry card come first, then her Dominion, a faith and scripture spread, her path through the three phases, Eden and her, and a working page. The phase page prints what the files already give, beat by beat, and leaves the rest ruled. Under the Final Rulings, all thirty-nine Trials place Anointed Wives. One goes to the heir and the other eleven are married down the elite ladder as designated, and nobody goes home unassigned (FR 19). A candidate who dies has her status returned to her family, with no compensation and no punishment (FR 24). Rejection follows a woman "not in the record, in the room" (FR 25).

The twelve and their fates

TKC: TR · FR 19 · FR 24

CONFLICT

CONTENT NOTE Two deaths, one of them a killing. Injury and violence during Endurance.

DAUGHTER	DOMINION · AGE	ROLE	FATE (TR)
EDEN SELAH OSEI	Aurem · 21	Protagonist	Wins. The Anointed Wife of the 39th Trial.
DELPHINE FONTENOT	Gulf · 22	Genuine friend	Medically extracted during Endurance, a head injury on Day 1
MAREN COLE	Ardenne · 23	Knows too much	Knocked unconscious on Endurance Day 3 by Eden and Delphine, and left behind
CORINNE VALE	Meridian · 22	Malicious architect	Completes Endurance. Placement by composite score.
CALLA MERRITT	Vane · 21	The Broadcast's favorite	Dies on Endurance Day 2, pushed into the river by Corinne
NADIA ORIN	Irongate · 20	Heartbreakingly good	Withdraws before the Social Policy debate
RUTH GIDEON	Heartland · 22	True believer	Sent home before Endurance, Judah's trade to keep Sera
DELIA CROSS	Red Earth · 24	Grudge against Aurem	Reaches the final checkpoint, doesn't advance, becomes a Lady in Waiting
VIVIENNE HALE	Lone · 23	Wildcard observer	Ankle fails on a Day 1 slope. Extracted at the first checkpoint.
PETRA SOLANO	Mountain · 22	Came looking for love	Dies before Phase Two. A "sudden medical event." It isn't.
ZARA VOSS	Sable · 21	Underestimated	Reaches the final checkpoint and advances
SERA MONTOYA	Pacific · 24	The ally	Nearly removed before Endurance. Survives, reaches the final checkpoint, advances.

TKC: TR · FR 19

CONFLICT

OPEN QUESTION

WHERE THE FILES DISAGREE

CONFLICT · MAREN	The profile says she's eliminated before the Social Policy debate. The fates table has her in Endurance on Day 3 (TR).
CONFLICT · VIVIENNE	The profile says she's eliminated before the Social Policy debate. The fates table has her ankle failing on Endurance Day 1 (TR).
CONFLICT · DELPHINE AND MAREN	Delphine is extracted on Day 1 and helps knock Maren unconscious on Day 3 (TR). One of the two days has to move.
CONFLICT · THE FINAL CHECKPOINT	Zara is "one of the four women standing at the final checkpoint." Eden, Sera and Delia reach it too, and Corinne completes Endurance (TR). The count comes to five.
OPEN QUESTION · LADIES IN WAITING	The third- and fourth-place Endurance finishers (TR). Delia is one. Who's the other?
OPEN QUESTION · GOING HOME	The profiles send Maren, Nadia and Vivienne home. Under FR 19 nobody goes home unassigned. INFERENCE They go home with an elite-ladder assignment, and the wedding comes later.

HOW I'M RESOLVING EACH ONE

Eden, through the Trial

TKC: TR · CR · TL

VOL. I · 569 · 570 · EDEN'S DOSSIER, PART I

Her full dossier is in Part I. This is her path, beat by beat, as the files give it.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
Arrival · day five	She looks at the city before the cameras, carries her own bag, and walks slower than the choreography. Forty-seven seconds, the most discussed arrival in a decade (**TR**).	
The Settling	Sera meets her on the first day and makes a decision that afternoon (**TR**).	
Doctrinal Assessment	The most complex questions in eleven cycles, three written by the Prelate herself. Finishes forty minutes early, reconsiders two answers, changes one, correctly. The highest score in the Trial's history (**TR**).	
Theological Interview	Two hours. A report three pages longer than anyone's: aligned, or clear-eyed, and the officer can't tell which (**TR**).	
Public Testimony	Declines her handler in writing. A statement of faith in women's intelligence, defensible line by line and incendiary as a whole. Lyris looks at her hands, then at Judah, who's been watching Eden for six minutes. She moves from fourth to first (**TR**).	

The files call the Prelate "Prelate Naomi." Under FR 33 she's renamed, working name Aurelia (POSSIBLE).

THE THREE QUESTIONS THE PRELATE WROTE FOR EDEN HERSELF

TKC: TR · CR

VOL. I · 569 · 573 · 525

Eden, Through the Trial, continued

CONTENT NOTE Violence during Endurance.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
The Dominion Forum	Moving the room within twenty minutes, by asking what the group actually has to decide. Four words to Sera in the hallway after (TR).	
The Civic Debates	She argues for the room and for the editor at once, so the Broadcast can't reshape her and can only deprioritize her (TR).	
The Anointed Evening	Eleven minutes with Lyris, three things off the record, the third a warning that's also instructions (TR)	
The Pairing	Judah sends the officials out and checks her for a wire. "Most candidates tell me they feel called." "I know." (TR)	
Endurance	Mountain terrain. On Day 3, with Delphine, she knocks Maren unconscious and leaves her (TR).	
The Declaration	She wins (TR). **OPEN QUESTION** The Crownward file calls it "the moment Eden will have planned for and the moment that will be taken from her" (CR). What's taken?	
Covenant Week	Seven days, a residence on the Palace grounds, her score replaced by The Chosen, and the Anointing on the sixth day (CR)	

THE BEAT THE FILES DON'T HAVE YET THAT THE BOOK NEEDS MOST

PORTRAIT · DELPHINE FONTENOT · TWENTY-TWO · GULF DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER II · ⌖

DELPHINE

*Warm in a way that's genuine and dangerous, and the Empire's scoring system has never known what to do with it (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Delphine Fontenot of Port Seraphine, twenty-two. First in Gulf's Regional Assessment. The genuine friend (**TR**).

HER FATE

Medically extracted during Endurance after a head injury on Day 1 (**TR**). Married down the elite ladder as designated (**FR 19**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 538 · 513 · 514

Port Seraphine

Covenant Registry

GULF DOMINION · PORT SERAPHINE

CANDIDATE	*FONTENOT, Delphine · twenty-two*
NOMINATED BY	*a colleague of her father's at the Temple* (**TR**)
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*first*
MOTHER	*Vowed, then a Bonded Wife, by choice* (**TR**)

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER MOTHER	A Vowed woman who chose love over status and became a Bonded Wife. Delphine watched every shift, which rooms her mother could enter, whose attention she held, what she could say, and carries a quiet fury for her that Port Seraphine taught her to wear as warmth (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	The most culturally intact in the Empire. Music survived here, standing in plain sight, because "cultural pilgrimage" pays too well to stop it. Girls walk the Procession at fourteen, and every year the crowd turns it into a second line (**DOM**).
IN THE TRIALS	Gulf candidates have historically been penalized for warmth, which Crown advisors read as performance. A Gulf woman who knows the gap between what she shows and what she keeps is one of the most dangerous women in the room (**DOM**).
HOW SHE MOVES	Rhythmically. She laughs sincerely, and she disarms people who've spent careers learning not to be disarmed. The Crownward will try to correct her, and it won't succeed (**TR**). She works a room and opens doors through conversation (**WR 29**).

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

HER FATHER'S WORK AT THE TEMPLE, AND WHAT HE THINKS OF HER ENTERING

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 538 · 513 · 518

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	A Vowed mother and a Temple father (TR), in a city where the Vowed "have learned to look away from certain things" (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	INFERENCE Joy can be a form of survival. The Last Free Night tells a bride the truth "in the one language the Empire has never learned how to police properly" (DOM).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	Music at Bindings, against three ordinances. The Procession and its counter-rhythm. Three-day funerals with a second line to the grave, and then the Quiet (DOM).
WHAT SHE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	INFERENCE Anywhere but Gulf, most of what she grew up doing in church.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

Warmth reads as performance unless it comes from someone the Crown already trusts (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple sets 1 Peter 3.4, "the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit," against everything Port Seraphine taught her.

THE HYMN SHE HUMS WHEN SHE FORGETS THE CAMERAS

The text

HER NAME	*Delphine* has no biblical source. It's French, from the Greek for Delphi, the oracle's town.
MIRIAM'S TIMBREL · EXODUS 15.20	**POSSIBLE** The women follow Miriam "with timbrels and with dances." **Where it breaks:** Miriam sings at the sea in front of everyone. Gulf's music survives as an exception the Empire won't admit exists (**DOM**).
DAVID DANCING · 2 SAMUEL 6	**POSSIBLE** A king dances before the ark with all his might, and his wife watches from a window and despises him. **Where it breaks:** Nobody in the Crownward is going to dance, and Delphine knows exactly who's watching from the windows.
LYDIA · ACTS 16.14–15	**POSSIBLE** A woman whose household opens and who "constrained us" to stay. Hospitality as a form of power (Vol. I, 408).

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER IN THE TEMPLE
Ecclesiastes 3.4, "a time to mourn, and a time to dance"	Psalm 149.3, "Let them praise his name in the dance"
	Psalm 150.4, "Praise him with the timbrel and dance"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Gulf, 538. Lived religion, 513 and 514. Miriam, 388. David, 412. The women who ran things, 408.

EXOD 15.20

2 SAM 6.14–16

PS 149.3

PS 150.4

ECCL 3.4

ACTS 16.14–15

1 PET 3.4

TKC: TR · DOM

CONFLICT

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE A head injury during Endurance.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival	Gulf candidates arrive fluent in being watched (**DOM**)	
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown		
Endurance · Day 1	A head injury, and medical extraction (**TR**)	
Endurance · Day 3	With Eden, knocks Maren unconscious (**TR**)	
After	Married down as designated (**FR 19**)	

CONFLICT Extracted on Day 1, and with Eden on Day 3 (**TR**). Decide which day moves.

THE MOMENT THE CROWNWARD TRIES TO CORRECT HER, AND WHAT SHE DOES WITH IT

Eden and Delphine

TKC: TR · WR 29

THE FILES	The genuine friend (**TR**). Her social skill shows physically and isn't explained (**WR 29**).

THE FIRST THING DELPHINE DOES THAT MAKES EDEN TRUST HER

WHAT EDEN THINKS OF HER THE NIGHT SHE'S EXTRACTED

LINES ONLY DELPHINE WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her working a room

Ten minutes. A reception room in the Crownward, Delphine in the middle of it, and three people who've decided not to like her.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · MAREN COLE · TWENTY-THREE · DOMINION OF ARDENNE

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 540

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER III · ⌖

MAREN

*She's carrying knowledge she doesn't fully understand, and she came looking for the context that makes it make sense (**TR**).*

ON THE RECORD

Maren Cole of Ashford, twenty-three. Self-nominated, four months of paperwork, second in Ardenne's Regional Assessment (**TR**).

HER FATE

Knocked unconscious on Endurance Day 3 by Eden and Delphine, and left behind in Mountain terrain (**TR**). **CONFLICT** Her profile has her eliminated before the Social Policy debate.

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 540 · 514

Ashford and the Hollows

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF ARDENNE · ASHFORD

CANDIDATE	*COLE, Maren · twenty-three*
NOMINATED BY	*herself · four months of paperwork (**TR**)*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*second*
FATHER	*Crown officer, Ashford*
MOTHER	*from the mountain communities · came to Ashford at eighteen (**TR**)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

TWO WORLDS	One official, one quiet. She learned early that the difference between them mattered and could be dangerous (**TR**).
WHAT SHE CARRIES	Ashford sits close to classified operations in the outer territory. She absorbed the Empire's mountain work in fragments, not through access (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	Ashford is the city the Empire keeps as proof Ardenne is pacified, and everything past the tree line says otherwise. The Ungoverned have their deepest roots in the hollows, where the mountain people call them something closer to saints (**DOM**).
IN THE TRIALS	Ardenne rarely sends a Covenant Daughter. When it does she's usually from Ashford, more Imperial than the hollows, and quiet about the gap (**DOM**).

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE FRAGMENT SHE HEARD AS A GIRL THAT SHE'S BEEN TRYING TO UNDERSTAND EVER SINCE

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 540 · 514

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	An Ashford father in Crown service and a mother from the hollows (TR). INFERENCE Two catechisms, one recited and one never written down.
WHAT HER MOTHER'S PEOPLE PRACTICE	Marriage as a community declaration and a broom jumped. The First Winter Work, a real job in the community's survival at thirteen or fourteen. The Sitting, so the dead don't leave alone (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION Which of the two catechisms she reaches for when she's frightened.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

Ashford's devotion is loud because watched people perform loyalty where it can be seen (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple teaches Ardenne girls Romans 13.1, "Let every soul be subject unto the higher powers," and calls the women in the hollows criminals.

WHAT HER MOTHER TOLD HER ABOUT THE HOLLOWS, AND WHAT SHE LEFT OUT

The text

HER NAME	*Maren* has no biblical source. It's a Scandinavian form of Marina, "of the sea."
THE SERVANT GIRL · 2 KINGS 5	**POSSIBLE** A captive girl from Israel tells her mistress the general could be healed by the prophet in Samaria. She knows something the powerful household doesn't. **Where it breaks:** Her knowledge sends a general to be healed. Maren's gets her left on a mountain.
ELISHA'S SERVANT · 2 KINGS 6	**POSSIBLE** Surrounded, the servant sees only the enemy, until his eyes are opened and "the mountain was full of horses and chariots of fire" (6.17). **Where it breaks:** What's hidden in Maren's mountains belongs to the Empire.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Psalm 121.1, "I will lift up mine eyes unto the hills, from whence cometh my help"	2 Kings 6.17, the mountain full of what you can't see

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Ardenne, 540. Lived religion, 514. Mountain, and the classified work, 551. Passages put to work, with Romans 13, 454.

2 KGS 5.2–3

2 KGS 6.15–17

PS 121.1

ROM 13.1

TKC: TR

CONFLICT

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE Violence during Endurance.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival		
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown	Eliminated before the Social Policy debate (TR, profile)	
Endurance · Day 3	Knocked unconscious by Eden and Delphine, and left behind in Mountain terrain (TR, fates)	
After	What she does on her way out with what she learned is "not recorded" (**TR**)	

CONFLICT Eliminated in Phase Two, or in Endurance on Day 3 (**TR**). One has to go.

WHAT SHE LEARNS IN THE CROWNWARD THAT FINALLY MAKES THE FRAGMENTS MAKE SENSE

Eden and Maren

TKC: TR

THE FILES	Eden and Delphine leave her unconscious on the mountain (**TR**).

WHY EDEN DOES IT, AND WHETHER MAREN EVER KNOWS

WHAT MAREN KNOWS THAT EDEN NEEDS

LINES ONLY MAREN WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her waking up

Ten minutes. Mountain terrain, Day 3, and no one in sight.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · CORINNE VALE · TWENTY-TWO · DOMINION OF MERIDIAN

TKC: TR · TL · DOM

VOL. I · 542

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER IV · ⌖

Corinne

*Precision as a weapon, compliance as strategy, and the most dangerous woman in every room she's ever entered (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Corinne Vale of Blessed Shore, twenty-two. First in Meridian's Regional Assessment, and the most connected Covenant Daughter in the Trials' history (**TR**).

HER FATE

Completes Endurance, placed by composite score (**TR**). She pushes Calla Merritt into the river on Day 2, and no camera sees it (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 542 · 514

Blessed Shore

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF MERIDIAN · BLESSED SHORE

CANDIDATE	*VALE, Corinne · twenty-two*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*first*
THE CROWNWARD	*Quarterly Audiences attended · the Court wives known · three visits to the Crown Palace (**TR**)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

WHAT SHE IS	The machinery of the Trials "in the way that a key embodies the lock it was made for" (**TR**).
WHY SHE'S DANGEROUS	Her ruthlessness comes from conviction. She believes she's the right choice, so she treats a threat as an obstacle to what's right, which makes her more dangerous than a girl who only likes winning (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	Blessed Shore holds the Covenant Court's secondary chambers. Its administrators trust process, its Stewardwives read Binding contracts in Reading Circles, and a Meridian woman who decides to move is almost impossible to stop because she's read every rule and knows where the gaps are (**DOM**).
OPEN QUESTION	She shares a surname with Maribel Vale of Aurem (**DR3**). Related?

HER FAMILY, AND WHAT HER MOTHER TAUGHT HER ABOUT CONTRACTS

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

HER FAMILY, AND WHAT HER MOTHER TAUGHT HER ABOUT CONTRACTS

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 542 · 509

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	She's the right choice, and so whatever she does is right (TR).
WHO TAUGHT HER	INFERENCE Blessed Shore, where Designation tests "relational compliance" over three days and preparing daughters for high-stakes assessment is what families do (DOM).
WHAT SHE CAN RECITE	INFERENCE All of it, and the clauses.
WHAT SHE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	Murder, if a camera had seen it (TR).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

INTERPRETATION Nothing against her. She's what the Trials reward, built for it from birth (TR). POSSIBLE Her Temple holds her up as Proverbs 31 in person.

THE VERSE SHE TELLS HERSELF ON THE BANK OF THE RIVER

The Text

GEN 4.8–10

GEN 25.29–34

1 KGS 21

PHIL 3.6

ROM 8.31

1 COR 1.12

CONTENT NOTE Murder.

HER NAME	*Corinne* is from the Greek *Korinna*, "maiden," and has no biblical source. **INTERPRETATION** It sounds like Corinth, the church Paul wrote to about its factions, each one saying "I am of Paul" or "I of Apollos" (1 Cor 1.12).
CAIN · GENESIS 4	**POSSIBLE** The first killing, in a field, with no one there to see it. "The voice of thy brother's blood crieth unto me from the ground" (4.10). **Where it breaks:** God asks Cain where his brother is. Nobody asks Corinne, because no camera was there.
JACOB'S STEW · GENESIS 25	**POSSIBLE** A birthright bought with a bowl of food from a hungry brother. Corinne uses food as a weapon (**TR**).
JEZEBEL'S LETTERS · 1 KINGS 21	**POSSIBLE** A man killed by correct procedure, through letters and sealed witnesses. Corinne builds a parallel intelligence operation from the Trial's own surveillance (**TR**). **Where it breaks:** Jezebel's crime has a prophet waiting at the vineyard.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Romans 8.31, "If God be for us, who can be against us?"	Genesis 4.10, the blood crying from the ground
	Philippians 3.6, Paul's zeal described as the thing he had to lose

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Meridian, 542. Genesis, the primeval history, 254. Jezebel, 397. Ruth and the other foreign women, 391.

TKC: TR

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE Murder, and a trap set for another candidate.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
The Tea Party	The tension with Calla begins here and runs through every shared event (**TR**)	
Throughout	Food as a weapon. A parallel intelligence operation among the Covenant Houses, built from the surveillance (**TR**).	
Before Endurance	Sets the trap that nearly removes Sera (**TR**)	
Endurance · Day 2	Pushes Calla into the river. No camera. One person sees it and can't look away fast enough (**TR**).	
After	Completes Endurance, placed by composite (**TR**). Married down as designated (**FR 19**).	

WHO SEES HER AT THE RIVER, AND WHAT SHE DOES ABOUT IT

Eden and Corinne

TKC: TR · TL

THE FILES	Two women raised for opposite reasons to understand exactly how the Trials work. Corinne was built for the lock (**TR**). Eden read the small print (**TR, DR3**).

THE FIRST TIME EDEN SEES WHAT CORINNE IS

WHAT CORINNE THINKS EDEN IS

LINES ONLY CORINNE WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write the Tea Party

Ten minutes. The first shared event, Corinne and Calla, and something on a plate.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · CALLA MERRITT · TWENTY-ONE · DOMINION OF VANE

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER V · ⌖

CALLA

*Legacy, carried lightly and warmly until it isn't (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Calla Merritt of Saint Meridian, twenty-one. A Broadcast family, and the Broadcast's favorite, because she's what it's decided the Trials should produce without any manipulation required (**TR**). Her surname is Merritt (**Ruling**).

HER FATE

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

Pushed into the river by Corinne on Endurance Day 2 (**TR**). Her status goes back to her family, with no compensation and no punishment (**FR 24**).

TKC: TR · TL · DOM · RULING

VOL. I · 544 · 561

Saint Meridian

Covenant Registry DOMINION OF VANE · SAINT MERIDIAN

CANDIDATE	*MERRITT, Calla · twenty-one*
FATHER	*Broadcast, a mid-level editor (**TR**)*
MOTHER	*a former Covenant Daughter (**TR**)*
PREPARED SINCE	*childhood (**TR**)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

WHAT SHE KNOWS	Broadcast cues, camera patterns, the kind of attention that reads as grace on a screen. Her talent is real, and the performance has become her identity (**TR**).
HER MOTHER	A former Covenant Daughter who withdrew in Phase Three of an earlier Trial (**TR**). The timeline says the 32nd (**TL**).
HER DOMINION	The legacy Dominion. Some families have sent daughters to three Trials running, and high-scoring girls are prepared for candidacy from the time they can read (**DOM**). The Broadcast Assessment at sixteen makes exceptional girls minor public figures overnight (**DOM**).
CONFLICT	The 32nd Trial was in 2097, when Calla was fourteen, and a Covenant Daughter can't already be a mother. INFERENCE Her mother's Trial was earlier, and the "32nd" belongs to someone or something else.

WHICH TRIAL HER MOTHER WAS IN, AND WHY SHE WITHDREW

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH TRIAL HER MOTHER WAS IN, AND WHY SHE WITHDREW

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 544 · 515

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	A mother who withdrew and a father who edits (TR). INFERENCE She learned faith as something performed well.
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION Whether anything under the performance is hers.
HER DOMINION'S UNDERGROUND	Ghost Marriages outside registration, and the Ghost Declaration, where a boy says what he actually intends before saying what's required (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

INTERPRETATION That she's the Trials working as designed. The Broadcast doesn't have to manipulate her, because she already is what it wants (TR).

THE ONE MOMENT IN THE CROWNWARD WHERE SHE ISN'T PERFORMING, AND WHO SEES IT

The text

SONG 2.2

MATT 6.28–29

GEN 4.8

JUDG 11.37–40

PS 69.2

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

HER NAME	The calla lily, from the Greek *kallos*, beauty. It has no biblical source. **INTERPRETATION** *Merritt* sounds like merit, and she was raised to earn it.
THE LILY · SONG 2.2	**POSSIBLE** "As the lily among thorns, so is my love among the daughters." **Where it breaks:** The lily in the Song is loved. Calla is watched.
ABEL · GENESIS 4	**POSSIBLE** Killed in a field by a rival, out of sight. **Where it breaks:** Abel's blood cries from the ground. The Empire's paperwork returns Calla's status to her family and moves on (**FR 24**).
JEPHTHAH'S DAUGHTER · JUDGES 11	**POSSIBLE** A daughter who dies for what her father's world required, and whom the daughters of Israel lamented four days a year. **Where it breaks:** Nobody in the Empire is going to lament Calla on a calendar.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Matthew 6.28, "Consider the lilies of the field"	Psalm 69.2, "I am come into deep waters, where the floods overflow me"

VOLUME ONE

Vane, 544. The unnamed, with Jephthah's daughter, 401. The Trials' history, 561. The Declaration, and a candidate's death, 573.

TKC: TR · FR 23–24

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE Her death by drowning.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Early	Warm, the legacy carried lightly, rooms settling around her (**TR**)	
The Tea Party	The tension with Corinne begins (**TR**)	
Throughout	The Broadcast's favorite (**TR**)	
Endurance · Day 2	The water's moving fast. Corinne pushes her in. One person sees it and can't look away fast enough (**TR**).	
After	Her status goes back to her family. A candidate's death doesn't downgrade the Trial (**FR 23–24**).	

HOW THE BROADCAST REPORTS HER DEATH, AND WHAT HER FATHER, THE EDITOR, DOES WITH THE FOOTAGE

Eden and Calla

TKC: TR

WHAT EDEN ENVIES IN HER, AND WHAT EDEN PITIES

THE LAST THING CALLA SAYS TO ANYONE

LINES ONLY CALLA WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her mother watching

Ten minutes. Saint Meridian, the Broadcast on, a former Covenant Daughter watching her own daughter on the screens.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

PORTRAIT · NADIA ORIN · TWENTY · DOMINION OF IRONGATE

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER VI · ⌖

NADIA

*The Trial identifies her as eliminated. The people who know her would use a different word (**TR**).*

ON THE RECORD

Nadia Orin of Iron Benediction, twenty. The most working-class Covenant Daughter in the Trials' history, a fact the Broadcast can't decide how to handle (**TR**).

HER FATE

Withdraws before the Social Policy debate, and the circumstances aren't made public. She goes home and does something meaningful with what she learned (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 545 · 515

Iron Benediction

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF IRONGATE · IRON BENEDICTION

CANDIDATE	*ORIN, Nadia · twenty*
NOMINATED BY	*a Vowed officer (**TR**)*
MOTHER	*Commonwife*
FATHER	*factory worker*
DISTRICT	*labor*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER PARENTS	They genuinely love each other, which isn't small in a system that treats love as a function, and Nadia understands both truths (**TR**).
HER NOMINATION	A Vowed officer saw something in her that the labor district's schools weren't built to recognize (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	The most class-divided in the Empire. The labor-district women run a mutual aid network so invisible the Vowed have never mapped it, and they call it the Kitchen. Blues and jazz went underground in 2053 (**DOM**).
IN THE TRIALS	Irongate almost always sends administrative daughters, because selection rewards polish. When a labor-district girl gets through, she adapts in real time instead of applying a prepared answer (**DOM**).

THE VOWED OFFICER WHO NOMINATED HER, AND WHAT THAT OFFICER SAW

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE VOWED OFFICER WHO NOMINATED HER, AND WHAT THAT OFFICER SAW

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 545 · 515 · 518

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	She chooses kindness knowingly. She believes in the Empire's ideals even understanding their corruption (TR).
WHO TAUGHT HER	Two parents who love each other, and the Kitchen (TR, DOM). The Placement at fourteen, a community's assessment of what she's suited for and what it needs (DOM).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	Mutual aid that the Vowed have never mapped (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

POSSIBLE The labor districts hear "if any would not work, neither should he eat" (2 Thess 3.10) and "Servants, be obedient to them that are your masters" (Eph 6.5). Nadia hears them and believes the ideal underneath anyway.

THE IDEAL SHE BELIEVES IN, STATED THE WAY SHE'D SAY IT

The text

ACTS 9.36–39

MARK 12.41–44

MIC 6.8

JAS 5.4

2 THESS 3.10

EPH 6.5

HER NAME	*Nadia* has no biblical source. It's from the Slavic word for hope.
TABITHA · ACTS 9	**POSSIBLE** The only woman the New Testament calls a disciple in the feminine, whose widows hold up the garments she made when she dies (Vol. I, 408). The Kitchen is Tabitha's widows with a name. **Where it breaks:** Tabitha is raised and goes back to the work. Nadia's work starts when she goes home.
THE WIDOW'S TWO MITES · MARK 12	**POSSIBLE** She gives "all that she had," and Jesus says she gave more than the rich. **Where it breaks:** The widow's gift is unseen by everyone but him. Nadia's withdrawal is unseen by the public on purpose (**TR**).

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Micah 6.8, "to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with thy God"	James 5.4, the hire of the labourers "kept back by fraud, crieth"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Irongate, 545. Lived religion, 515. The women who ran things, with Tabitha, 408. Passages put to work, 454.

TKC: TR · TL

Through the Trial

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival	The Broadcast can't decide how to handle her (**TR**)	
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown	Withdraws before the Social Policy debate. The circumstances aren't stated (**TR, TL**).	
After	Home to Iron Benediction, to do something meaningful with what she learned (**TR**). Married down as designated (**FR 19**).	

WHY SHE WITHDRAWS, AND WHO KNOWS THE REAL REASON

Eden and Nadia

TKC: TR

WHAT TWO GIRLS FROM LABOR HOUSEHOLDS RECOGNIZE IN EACH OTHER

WHAT NADIA SAYS WHEN SHE LEAVES

LINES ONLY NADIA WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her coming home

Ten minutes. Iron Benediction, the labor district, the Kitchen, and everyone who watched her on the screens.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

PORTRAIT · RUTH GIDEON · TWENTY-TWO · HEARTLAND DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER VII · ⌖

RUTH

*Genuine faith as credential and liability at once. She says "see you soon" like it's a promise, and means it (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Ruth Gideon of Providence Cross, twenty-two. First in Heartland's Regional Assessment. The true believer, sincere without being foolish (**TR, WR 26**).

HER FATE

Sent home before Endurance, as the price Judah pays to keep Sera in the Trials. She goes home believing she wasn't enough. She was more than enough (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 547 · 515

Providence Cross

Covenant Registry

HEARTLAND DOMINION · PROVIDENCE CROSS

CANDIDATE	*GIDEON, Ruth · twenty-two*
NOMINATED BY	*her grandmother (TR)*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*first*
FATHER	*a Temple deacon*
MOTHER	*teaches theology*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER FAMILY	Her grandmother attended the first Covenant Trial in 2065 and nominated Ruth, believing she exemplified the Trials' stated purpose. She may have misunderstood what the actual purpose is (TR).
HER FAITH	She grew up believing in the Trials and the divine order they stand for, genuinely, without the doubt most candidates carry with it. She's more theologically sophisticated than she lets on (TR).
HER DOMINION	The Heartland didn't need conquering. People sing the hymns because they mean them, and real believers have opinions about what faithfulness requires. Heartland women questioning the Commonwife designation call it theological inquiry, and mean it (DOM).

WHAT HER GRANDMOTHER REMEMBERS OF THE FIRST TRIAL, IN 2065

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT HER GRANDMOTHER REMEMBERS OF THE FIRST TRIAL, IN 2065

TKC: TR · DOM · WR 26

VOL. I · 547 · 515 · 518

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	The Trials and the divine order are real and good (TR). Her faith is real, and her curiosity is careful in public (WR 26).
WHO TAUGHT HER	A deacon father, a mother who teaches theology, and a grandmother who was there in 2065 (TR). The First Covenant at thirteen, scripture memorized and a gift to the Temple, the moment her track was set in public (DOM).
WHAT SHE GIVES EDEN	The clearest look Eden gets at faith from the inside, an uncomfortable gift (TR).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The Anointing, hair washed and braided the night before a Binding, each woman speaking a private word over the bride. Planting something after a burial (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

A girl who believes is more useful to the Empire than a girl who performs belief (DOM). The most dangerous Heartland candidates learned to make their questions sound like prayers (DOM).

THE QUESTION SHE'S BEEN ASKING SINCE CHILDHOOD, WORDED AS A PRAYER

The text

RUTH 1.16–17

JUDG 6.36–40

JUDG 8.22–23

1 SAM 8.11–18

HER NAMES	Ruth, the Moabite who binds herself to her mother-in-law with the most famous vow in scripture (Vol. I, 391). Gideon, who tests God with a fleece twice and later refuses a crown: "the LORD shall rule over you" (Judg 8.23).
WHERE RUTH BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** Ruth's vow binds her to a person and a people, and they keep faith with her. Ruth Gideon's loyalty to the Empire is repaid by being traded away (**TR**).
WHERE GIDEON BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** Gideon asks God for proof, and gets it. Ruth asks the Empire nothing and believes.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Ruth 1.16, "whither thou goest, I will go"	Judges 8.23, a judge refusing to found a dynasty
	1 Samuel 8.11–18, what a king will take

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Ruth, 391 and 113. Kingmakers, with Gideon, 413. Heartland, 547. Faith that isn't performance, 518.

TKC: TR · TL

Through the Trial

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Phase One · the Temple	Exceptional, as in every phase she takes part in (TR)	
Phase Two · the Crown	Exceptional (TR)	
Before Endurance	Sent home. Judah trades her to keep Sera. She doesn't know (TR).	
Leaving	"See you soon," like a promise (TL)	
After	Believes she wasn't enough (TR). Married down as designated (FR 19).	

HOW SHE'S TOLD, BY WHOM, AND WHAT SHE SAYS

Eden and Ruth

TKC: TR · TL · WR 26

THE RULE	Ruth believes the Empire more than Eden does, and that doesn't make her foolish (**WR 26**).

THE CONVERSATION WHERE RUTH SHOWS EDEN FAITH FROM THE INSIDE

WHAT EDEN OWES HER, AND WHETHER SHE EVER PAYS IT

LINES ONLY RUTH WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her train home

Ten minutes. Ruth on the transport back to Providence Cross, praying for the women still there.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · DELIA CROSS · TWENTY-FOUR · DOMINION OF RED EARTH

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER VIII · ⌖

DELIA

*Perfectly prepared, perfectly composed, absolutely unreadable. She's been deciding something for months before she nods (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Delia Cross of Canaan's Gate, twenty-four. Second in Red Earth's Regional Assessment, selected over the first-ranked girl because of concerns about that girl's family history (**TR**).

HER FATE

Reaches the final checkpoint and doesn't advance. Becomes a Lady in Waiting, and what she does with the position is the most significant thing she does in the Crownward (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 548 · 516

Canaan's Gate

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF RED EARTH · CANAAN'S GATE

CANDIDATE	*CROSS, Delia · twenty-four*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*second · selected over the first (**TR**)*
MOTHER	*Stewardwife*
FATHER	*Crown officer · transferred from Aurem when she was six (**TR**)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

THE TRANSFER	A Crown efficiency initiative moved her family from the Empire's showcase Dominion to its policy testing ground. She's known since she was six what it means that Aurem is celebrated and Red Earth is proof (**TR**).
WHAT SHE CARRIES	The anger of a girl told all her life that the place she left was better than the place that raised her. Polished and composed in public, angrier and more frightened in private (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	Red Earth piloted the Commonwife quota in 2058, and its women have lived under the full version longest. Under the performance runs a language of small signals refined over decades. Its candidates are the best in the Empire at performing compliance while thinking something else, and the council places them mid-pack until it realizes "middle was a choice, not a ceiling" (**DOM**).

WHAT SHE REMEMBERS OF AUREM FROM BEFORE SHE WAS SIX

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT SHE REMEMBERS OF AUREM FROM BEFORE SHE WAS SIX

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 548 · 516

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	A Stewardwife mother, and Red Earth, where the morning after a Binding mothers take daughters aside for the Second Covenant, what the first one means and what a daughter may keep for herself (DOM).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The small signals, a way of folding hands, a phrase that means something other than what it says (DOM). Women sitting with the dead in shifts, and burial at midday so the body knows the sun's warmth (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION The files give her anger and her shift, and not her God.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

Red Earth is the most visibly religious Dominion, with scripture on every building and the Vowed embedded as "pastoral care" (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple preaches Philippians 2.14, "Do all things without murmurings," to the women who invented a language for murmuring.

THE SMALL SIGNAL SHE USES MOST, AND WHAT IT MEANS

The text

LUKE 15.25–32

ESTH 4.4

ESTH 4.16

PHIL 2.14

HER NAME	*Delia* has no biblical source. It's Greek, "from Delos," a title of Artemis. **INTERPRETATION** *Cross* is the heaviest surname in the cast, and nobody says so.
THE ELDER BROTHER · LUKE 15	**POSSIBLE** The son who stayed and served, furious when the father kills the fatted calf for the one who left. "Lo, these many years do I serve thee... and yet thou never gavest me a kid" (15.29). **Where it breaks:** The father goes out to him and says "all that I have is thine" (15.31). The Empire never goes out to Red Earth.
ESTHER'S MAIDENS · ESTHER 4	**POSSIBLE** The young women who serve the queen, tell her what's happening outside, and fast with her when it matters (4.4, 4.16). **Where it breaks:** Delia ends up serving the Aurem girl. Whether she fasts with her is the book.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Luke 15.29, if she ever said it aloud	Luke 15.31, "Son, thou art ever with me"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Red Earth, 548. Lived religion, 516. Esther, 399. Commonwives and the quota, 527.

TKC: TR · TL

Through the Trial

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Phase One · the Temple		
The Dominion Forum	Votes with Eden (**TL**)	
Social Policy debate	Votes with Eden (**TL**)	
Endurance	Her alignment has shifted in a direction she didn't expect. She makes a choice she'll have to live with and reaches the final checkpoint (**TR**).	
After	Doesn't advance. Lady in Waiting (**TR**).	

THE CHOICE SHE MAKES IN ENDURANCE

Eden and Delia

TKC: TR · TL

THE FILES	A grudge against Aurem (TR), and two votes with Eden anyway (TL).

WHAT DELIA DECIDED OVER THOSE MONTHS, AND WHEN SHE NODDED

WHAT SHE DOES AS A LADY IN WAITING THAT MATTERS MOST

LINES ONLY DELIA WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write the Forum vote

Ten minutes. The scenario room, no leader, Eden moving the room, and Delia deciding.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

PORTRAIT · VIVIENNE HALE · TWENTY-THREE · LONE DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER IX · ⌖

VIVIENNE

*Curious rather than ambitious, engaged without being revealing, and noncommittal in a way that reads as easy and is actually a skill (**TR**).*

ON THE RECORD

Vivienne Hale of Covenant Basin, twenty-three. Self-nominated on impulse after two years of thinking about it. Third in Lone's Regional Assessment (**TR**).

HER FATE

Her ankle fails on a Day 1 slope in Endurance, and she's extracted at the first checkpoint (**TR**). She goes home knowing more about how the Crownward works than anyone there will know what to do with (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 550 · 516

Covenant Basin

Covenant Registry

LONE DOMINION · COVENANT BASIN

CANDIDATE	*HALE, Vivienne · twenty-three*
NOMINATED BY	*herself (**TR**)*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*third*
SELECTED BECAUSE	*clean and interesting, and to avoid a nepotism story about the first-ranked girl (**TR**)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER FAMILY	Pragmatic and quietly independent. Her father works in resource extraction. Her mother runs the household and treats Imperial loyalty as a practical arrangement rather than a conviction (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	Texas negotiated its surrender and kept the attitude. Lone performs loyalty loudly and then does what it was going to do anyway, and its outer-territory women have an autonomy that would get them flagged in Aurem (**DOM**).
IN THE TRIALS	If a Lone girl is selected she goes, the Dominion supports her adequately, and nobody gets emotional about the outcome. Lone directness: do the thing, see what happens (**DOM**).

WHAT SHE WAS THINKING ABOUT FOR TWO YEARS BEFORE SHE FILED

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT SHE WAS THINKING ABOUT FOR TWO YEARS BEFORE SHE FILED

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 550 · 516

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	A mother for whom loyalty is a practical arrangement (TR). The First Ride, a long distance navigated alone while the community waits. The Giving, something of a grandmother's handed to a bride (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION Curiosity is the only creed on file (TR).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	Burial with boots on, ready for wherever the dead go next (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

POSSIBLE Lone gets Proverbs 31.27, "She looketh well to the ways of her household," and the Governor-Prelate never checks whether anyone listened (DOM).

WHAT SHE WAS GIVEN AT THE GIVING, OR WILL BE

The text

HER NAME	*Vivienne* has no biblical source. It's from the Latin *vivus*, "alive."
THE QUEEN OF SHEBA · 1 KINGS 10	**POSSIBLE** She comes from far away to see for herself, asks hard questions, and says "the half was not told me" (10.7). **Where it breaks:** Sheba goes home with gifts and a story she's free to tell. Vivienne goes home with information nobody in Covenant Basin can use (TR).
THE SPIES · NUMBERS 13	**POSSIBLE** Twelve men sent to look at a land and come back with a report. **Where it breaks:** Their report is public, and argued over. Vivienne's report is hers.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
1 Kings 10.7, "the half was not told me"	Joshua 2, a woman who reads the whole war correctly from her window

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Lone, 550. Lived religion, 516. Rahab, 391. Numbers, the count and the camp, 155.

1 KGS 10.1–7

MATT 12.42

NUM 13.25–33

JOSH 2

TKC: TR

CONFLICT

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE An injury during Endurance.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown	Eliminated before the Social Policy debate (TR, profile)	
Endurance · Day 1	Her ankle fails on a slope. Extracted at the first checkpoint (TR, fates).	
After	Home to Covenant Basin with more than anyone there can use (**TR**). Married down as designated (**FR 19**).	

CONFLICT Phase Two, or Endurance Day 1 (**TR**). One has to go.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING SHE LEARNED, AND WHO SHE TELLS

Eden and Vivienne

TKC: TR

WHAT VIVIENNE NOTICES ABOUT EDEN THAT NOBODY ELSE DOES

LINES ONLY VIVIENNE WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her report

Ten minutes. Vivienne back in Covenant Basin, telling one person what the Crownward actually is.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · PETRA SOLANO · TWENTY-TWO · MOUNTAIN DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER X · ⌖

PETRA

*She came looking for something. She found it (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Petra Solano of Crestfall, twenty-two. Nominated by a Vowed officer and approved by the Crown (**TR**). She matters by doing less (**WR 28**).

HER FATE

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

Dies before Phase Two. The Empire calls it a sudden medical event, and it isn't (**TR**). Her death costs the Trial nothing, and her status goes back to her family (**FR 23–24**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 551 · 517

Crestfall

Covenant Registry

MOUNTAIN DOMINION · CRESTFALL

CANDIDATE	*SOLANO, Petra · twenty-two*
NOMINATED BY	*a Vowed officer (**TR**)*
APPROVED BY	*the Crown (**TR**)*
STATED PURPOSE	*the Trials*
ACTUAL PURPOSE	_____

COVENANT DAUGHTER

THE BOY NEXT DOOR	She grew up beside a family whose youngest son she loved, the way children who grow up together do. The family relocated where she couldn't follow, and she kept looking, the way you look for something you believe can still be found (**TR**).
WHY SHE ENTERED	To get into the Crownward, where the records and archives are. The boy disappeared into Mountain terrain four years ago, and the official record doesn't hold his name (**TR**).
WHY SHE WAS CHOSEN	**POSSIBLE** Someone in the Crown's advisory structure suspected she was looking for something and wanted her looking where they could intercept it. If so, the control failed (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	Crestfall is the face and the mountains are the truth. Girls chosen at Designation for classified Vowed service disappear from public life (**DOM**).

THE BOY'S NAME, AS SHE KNEW IT

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

TKC: TR · DOM · WR 28

VOL. I · 551 · 517

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**INFERENCE** That what's lost can still be found if you keep looking (**TR**).
WHO TAUGHT HER	Crestfall, where discipline mattered before the Empire made it doctrine. Families take their sons above the city the night before assessment and show them the mountains, which were there before the Empire and will be there after (**MEN**).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The Witness Walk. The name spoken once, directly to the mountain, which Crestfall trusts more than God or the Temple, and then the long walk down where the grief happens (**DOM**).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

POSSIBLE The Temple reads the Song of Songs only as an allegory of Christ and the church, which is an old and real tradition, so the Song's woman searching the streets for the one she loves is never read as a woman.

WHAT SHE SAYS TO THE MOUNTAIN, AND WHOSE NAME

MATT 16.18

SONG 3.1–4

SONG 5.6–7

SONG 8.6

THE TEXT

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

HER NAME	Greek *petra*, "rock," the word behind "upon this rock I will build my church" (Matt 16.18, Vol. I, 417).
THE WOMAN SEARCHING · SONG 3	**POSSIBLE** "I will rise now, and go about the city... I will seek him whom my soul loveth" (3.2). She finds him and won't let him go. **Where it breaks:** Petra goes about the city and finds the archive instead.
THE WATCHMEN · SONG 5.7	**POSSIBLE** The second time she searches, "the watchmen that went about the city found me, they smote me, they wounded me." **Where it breaks:** The Song keeps going after the watchmen. Petra's story doesn't.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Song 3.2, "I will seek him whom my soul loveth"	Song 5.7, the watchmen
	Song 8.6, "love is strong as death"

VOLUME ONE

Mountain, 551. Lived religion, 517. The three arguments, with the Song of Songs, 127. The ledger and the Dissent, 492.

Through the Trial

TKC: TR · FR 23–24 · FR 41–42

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival	Mountain candidates carry the alertness of someone raised knowing what she doesn't know might be classified (**DOM**)	
Phase One	The east wing archive holds things that are not about Azrael and are about Azrael at the same time. What she finds there is why she's dead (**TR**).	
Before Phase Two	Dies. "A sudden medical event," the Empire's phrase for Azrael too (**TR**, **TL**).	
After	Her status goes back to her family. The Trial loses nothing (**FR 23–24**).	

OPEN QUESTION How does a Covenant Daughter get into the east wing archive, which Azrael reached only through a Crown advisory access period (**FR 41**)?

WHAT SHE FINDS, AND WHO KNOWS SHE FOUND IT

TKC: TR · WR 28

Eden and Petra

THE RULE	Her stillness, her watching, her refusal to react or perform can be stronger than dialogue. Don't overexplain her (**WR 28**).

THE ONE THING PETRA DOES THAT EDEN DOESN'T UNDERSTAND UNTIL AFTER

WHO THE BOY IS, AND HOW HE'S TIED TO AZRAEL

Write the archive

WRITING

Ten minutes. The east wing, a drawer, and Petra reading something about a boy whose name isn't in it.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

TKC: TR · TL · DOM · WR 27

VOL. I · 553



PORTRAIT · ZARA VOSS · TWENTY-ONE · DOMINION OF SABLE

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER XI · ⌖

ZARA

*Two Sable women are worth five from anywhere else. Her real name is Tazaleh, and the Empire doesn't have it (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Zara Voss of Sable Reach, twenty-one. Nominated by her mother. Excelled in Sable's Regional Assessment. Underestimated on arrival, and she doesn't stay underestimated (**TR**).

HER FATE

One of the women standing at the final checkpoint, and she advances to final consideration (**TR**).

Sable Reach and the desert

TKC: TR · TL · DOM

VOL. I · 553 · 517

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF SABLE · SABLE REACH

CANDIDATE	*VOSS, Zara · twenty-one*
NOMINATED BY	*her mother (TR)*
MOTHER	*Unbound · raised her alone*
FATHER	*unnamed (TR)*
DESERT NAME	*not on file*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER GRANDMOTHER	Her real name is one the desert knows and the Empire doesn't. She raised Zara with the Sable education: the land, the plants, and the patience of someone who reads an environment that kills you if you misread it (TR).
HER FATHER	Unnamed, the way the desert is unnamed. It exists, it shaped everything, and it doesn't need documentation (TR).
HER DOMINION	The Empire sees the desert and sees geography to manage. Sable women see a teacher (TR). The Empire renamed the cities and not the land, and the scoring process has no rubric for silence as calculation (DOM).
IN THE TRIALS	The Trial has had three cycles to learn what two Sable women are worth, and hasn't adjusted. Zara's been counting on that (TR).

WHAT HER GRANDMOTHER TAUGHT HER FIRST

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT HER GRANDMOTHER TAUGHT HER FIRST

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

TKC: TR · TL · DOM

VOL. I · 553 · 517

WHO TAUGHT HER	Her grandmother and the desert (TR). The Finding, a girl left at a family site from sunset to sunrise, and what she brings back becomes her adult name in the community (DOM).
WHAT SHE CARRIES	Two names, as Sable women do, one the Empire knows and one that lives in the house where it can't reach (TR). Hers is Tazaleh (TL).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The Desert Walk before a Binding. The dead given back to the desert, the name said once into a fire that nobody puts out (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

The Empire doesn't know desert names exist (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple teaches that the name the Registry holds is the name God knows.

WHAT SHE BROUGHT BACK FROM THE FINDING, AND HOW IT BECAME TAZALEH

GEN 38.27–30

MATT 1.3

GEN 16.13

ISA 35.1

REV 2.17

DEUT 8.2

The text

HER NAME	*Zara* is the King James spelling of Zerah, Tamar's twin (Matt 1.3, Gen 38.30, Vol. I, 417). At the birth his hand comes out first and the midwife ties a scarlet thread on it, "This came out first." His brother breaks out ahead of him (Gen 38.28–30).
WHERE IT BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** Zerah is marked first and born second, and the royal line runs through his brother. Zara is marked last and doesn't stay there.
HAGAR · GENESIS 16	**POSSIBLE** A woman alone in the desert who names God, "Thou God seest me" (16.13). **Where it breaks:** Hagar is found in the desert. Zara was raised to be at home in it.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Isaiah 35.1, "the desert shall rejoice, and blossom as the rose"	Revelation 2.17, a white stone with "a new name written, which no man knoweth saving he that receiveth it"
Genesis 16.13, "Thou God seest me"	Genesis 38, which the Temple doesn't teach (Vol. I, 386)

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Sable, 553. Lived religion, 517. Tamar and the twins, 386. Hagar, 384. The names in the cast, 417.

Through the Trial

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival	Underestimated (TR)	
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown		
The middle of the book	The name exchange with Eden (Vol. I, 553)	
Endurance	Standing at the final checkpoint (TR)	
After	Advances to final consideration (TR)	

WHAT SHE DOES IN ENDURANCE THAT NONE OF THE OTHERS COULD

TKC: TR · TL · WR 27

Eden and Zara

THE RULE	She can say the quiet thing, and she still knows where she is. She isn't there to explain the scene's politics (**WR 27**).
THE EXCHANGE	**INTERPRETATION** Sable's two-name custom and Celeste's house name for Eden are the same instinct in two Dominions (Vol. I, 553).

THE NIGHT THEY TRADE NAMES. WHO OFFERS FIRST, AND WHAT EACH NAME COSTS TO SAY.

LINES ONLY ZARA WOULD SAY

Write her at the final checkpoint

Ten minutes. Mountain terrain, the end of Day 3, and Zara reading the land the way the desert taught her.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

TKC: TR · TL · DOM

VOL. I · 555

PORTRAIT · SERA MONTOYA · TWENTY-FOUR · PACIFIC DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER XII · ⌖

SERA

*"Monitor closely" is on her record before she arrives. She has to outscore everyone by enough that the judgment becomes impossible to sustain, and she does (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Sera Montoya of Westhold, twenty-four. She entered not to win but to find the person she'd been waiting for (**TR**).

HER FATE

Nearly removed before Endurance. Survives, reaches the final checkpoint, and is one of three who advance. Her flag is updated after the Trial, and the new notation isn't public (**TR**).

WESTHOLD

COVENANT REGISTRY

PACIFIC DOMINION · WESTHOLD

CANDIDATE	*MONTOYA, Sera · twenty-four*
CLASS	*Westhold's administrative class (**TR**)*
FLAG	*Monitor closely · on file before arrival*
REVIEW	*every Pacific score reviewed at Crownward level (**DOM**)*

MONITOR CLOSELY

HER GRANDMOTHER	At the last protest before the Partition Agreement ended Pacific's resistance in 2041. She tells it as a caution and not a hero's story, because knowing when and how is the difference between impact and loss (**TR**).
HOW SHE WATCHES	One eye on the Empire's architecture and the other on the gap between what it claims and what it does. Her patience is the patience of someone waiting for the moment worth acting on (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	More cameras per block than anywhere, a Governor-Prelate Dorian appointed himself, and mothers who teach daughters how to pass the Designation without revealing themselves. Pacific candidates arrive trained to be watched, and the ones who last learn to watch back (**DOM**).

THE PROTEST, AS HER GRANDMOTHER TELLS IT

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE PROTEST, AS HER GRANDMOTHER TELLS IT

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 555 · 517

WHO TAUGHT HER	Her grandmother, and Westhold, where the dead are buried facing west, toward the ocean and the direction of the secession (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	INFERENCE That two people who see clearly are more dangerous than one (TR).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The Real Binding, a private ceremony with the promises a couple actually means. Facing West, the dawn ceremony where a boy turns back toward the city (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

Pacific girls are reviewed for inherited resistance, for any sign the secession story survived in the children (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple preaches Romans 13.2 in Westhold more than anywhere, "whosoever therefore resisteth the power, resisteth the ordinance of God."

WHAT SHE'D PROMISE AT A REAL BINDING, IF SHE EVER HAD ONE

GEN 46.17

NUM 26.46

1 SAM 18.1–3

1 SAM 20

ECCL 3.7

JUDG 9.8–15

ROM 13.2

The text

HER NAME	Serah, daughter of Asher, one of the few daughters named in the genealogies (Gen 46.17, Num 26.46). In later Jewish tradition she lives for centuries, is the one who tells Jacob that Joseph is alive, and shows Moses where Joseph's bones are buried. She's a keeper of memory. She shares the name with Sera Callum, the first Anointed Wife (Vol. I, 417).
JONATHAN · 1 SAMUEL 18	**POSSIBLE** A man who looks at a rival and chooses alliance instead, "the soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David." **Where it breaks:** Jonathan's choice costs him a throne. Sera's survival costs Ruth hers, and Sera may never know (**TR**).

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Ecclesiastes 3.7, "a time to keep silence, and a time to speak"	Judges 9.8–15, the bramble that takes the crown the olive, the fig and the vine refused

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Pacific, 555. Living memory, with her grandmother, 482. Echoes, labeled, with Jotham's fable, 419. David and Jonathan, 412.

Through the Trial

TKC: TR

CONFLICT

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
The Settling	Meets Eden on the first day and makes a decision that afternoon (TR)	
The Dominion Forum	Watches Eden for forty minutes and moves from competing to working beside her. Eden notices at once. Four words in the hallway after (TR).	
Before Endurance	Corinne's trap, and Sera walks into it because she sees too clearly to stay quiet. Judah trades Ruth to keep her (TR).	
Endurance	Reaches the final checkpoint (TR)	
After	Advances. The flag is updated, privately (TR).	

CONFLICT Two decision points, one on the Settling's first day and one forty minutes into the Forum (TR). Both can stand if the first is about Eden and the second about the room.

WHAT CORINNE'S TRAP IS

TKC: TR

Eden and Sera

THE FILES	Short of a friend for now. She's someone else who sees the room clearly and has decided two people who see clearly are more dangerous than one (TR).

THE FOUR WORDS

WHAT SERA WAS WAITING FOR, AND HOW SHE KNEW IT WAS EDEN

LINES ONLY SERA WOULD SAY

Write the hallway

WRITING

Ten minutes. The Forum's over, the corridor outside, a camera somewhere, and four words.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING THIS SPREAD STARTED AND DID NOT FINISH

IV

PART FOUR · ✣

The House of Vane

A family that keeps documents instead of grandmothers' stories, and the most dangerous papers in the Crownward.

i · The family and its paper	270
Dorian Vane	274
Lyris Vane	293
Judah Elijah Vane	310
Azrael Vane	328
The Prelate	343
Working questions for the House of Vane	349

CR | TL | FR 35–44

AGES IN 2104

Dorian 59 (**Ruling**). Lyris 58. Azrael 27. Judah 25. The Prelate 67 (**CR, TL**).

MARGINALIA

The family and its paper

The Temple teaches that God chose Elias Vane to restore the nation and that his bloodline carries the anointing forward. In the Crownward that isn't a metaphor. It shapes every interaction the family has with everyone else (**CR**). The House of Vane is the only household in the book where theology is the family business.

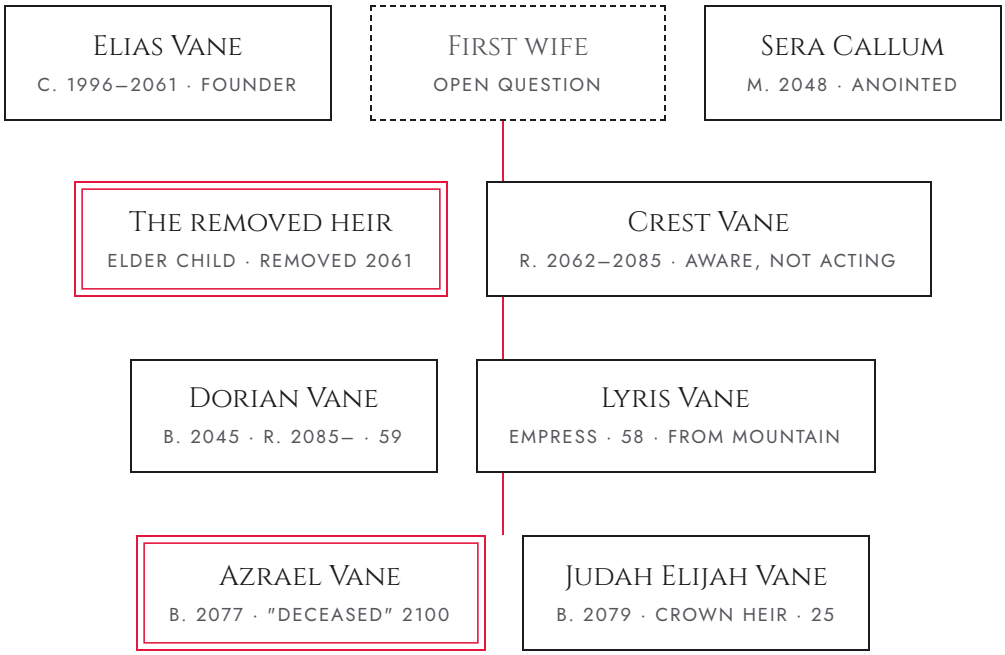
The Final Rulings rebuilt this family. Dorian's parent was Elias's elder child and the rightful successor, removed in 2061 when Dorian was a child. Crest, the younger sibling, took the throne by survivorship and knew the shape of what he sat on (**FR 35–37, 39**). Dorian was spared because a child's claim can be supervised (**FR 38**). The ledger Azrael found named Elias, and Dorian has known that since 2061 (**FR 44**). Everyone in this part performs for the Broadcast, and the dossiers keep asking what each of them does in the rooms it can't film: the Study, the side rooms at the Anointed Evening, the Binding Night, the Sovereign Garden behind its gates (**CR**).

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the family tree, 491. The Crown, 497.

The family tree

TKC: TL · FR 35–39 · CR · WR · RULING

VOL. I · 491



The removed heir is Dorian's parent, and Crest is Dorian's uncle (**FR 35**). **SUPERSEDED** Crest as Dorian's father (**CR**). **SUPERSEDED** Dorian at sixty-one (**CR**). **DECIDED** Fifty-nine (**Ruling**).

THE REMOVED HEIR'S NAME, AND HOW THE OFFICIAL HISTORY SPELLS IT, IF IT DOES

TKC: TL · FR 40–44

VOL. I · 492 · 511

The documents, in order

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS TO THE PAPER	SOURCE
2061	The ledger names Elias. Dorian, a child, learns it, and it's the only thing he's ever been certain of.	FR 44
2062–85	Crest preserves the documents, the one thing he did. Neither destroyed nor used, left where the east wing archive would someday be inventoried.	FR 40
2085–98	Unmoved for thirteen years, because nobody was looking	FR 41
2098	Azrael, twenty-one, finds the ledger legitimately during a Crown advisory access period, and brings it to his father	TL, FR 41
2098	Dorian tells him to put it back. A document Azrael has read and returned is one Dorian controls, and destroying it would have told Azrael it mattered.	TL, FR 43
2098–2100	Azrael looks for the Covenant of Dissent, written in the same hand the same year. He doesn't find it. What he finds is enough.	TL
2100	The week Azrael is declared dead, the ledger and the Dissent both vanish. Dorian took them.	TL, FR 42

CONFLICT The timeline says Azrael doesn't put the ledger back, and also that it vanishes from the east wing archive in 2100 (**TL**). **INFERENCE** Somewhere between the two he returned it, or Dorian took it from somewhere else.

WHERE DORIAN KEEPS THEM NOW

Four people

TKC: TL · TR

OPEN QUESTION

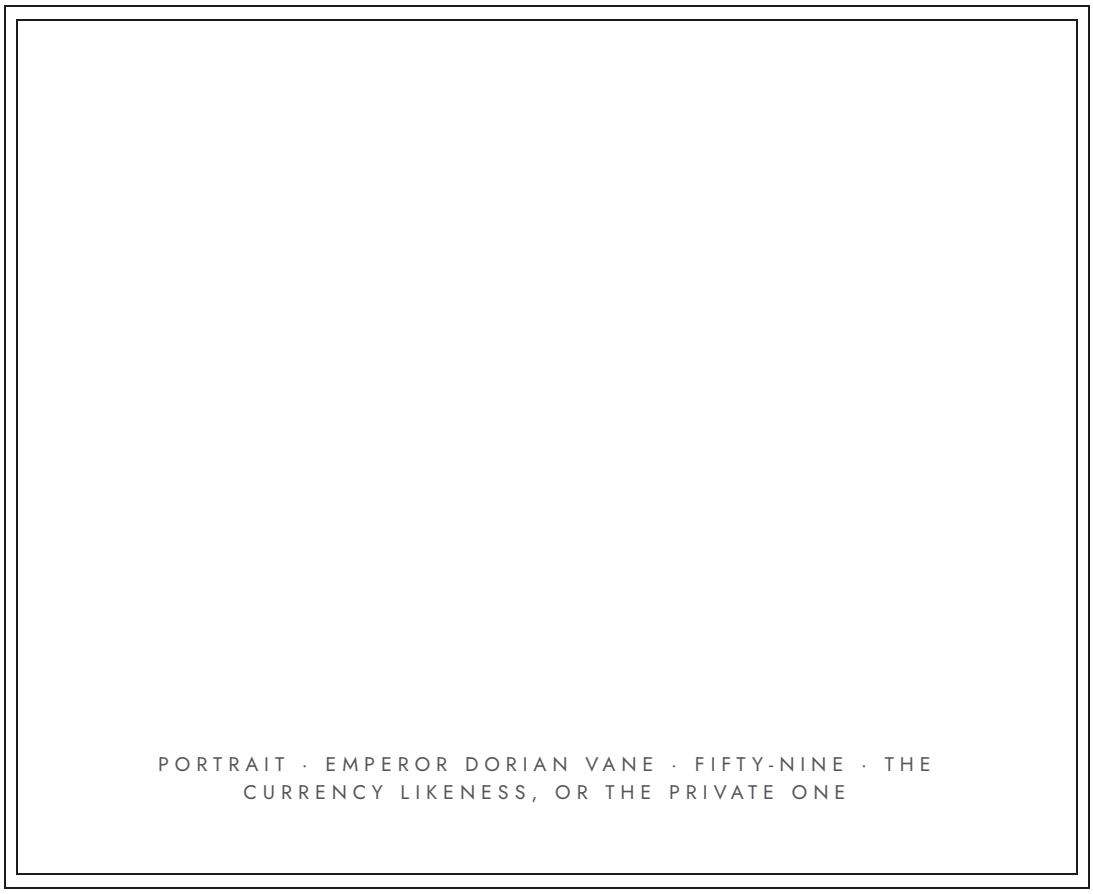
Azrael has been in Mountain Dominion under another name for four years, in a community whose patriarch owes the Vane family a debt that predates the Trials Commission by a decade. Four people know he's alive: Judah, Lyris, and two others (TL).

WHO	HOW THEY KNOW	WHAT IT COSTS THEM
JUDAH		
LYRIS		

OPEN QUESTION · DORIAN	Does he know? He removed the documents the week Azrael was declared dead (FR 42), and the files don't say who arranged the "medical event."
POSSIBLE · THE PATRIARCH	One of the two others, since the debt is to the family (TL).
POSSIBLE · HANNAH	Judah "has always known" about her (TL).
OPEN QUESTION · PETRA	The boy next door disappeared into Mountain terrain four years ago, the same year (TR). Who is he to Azrael?

TKC: TL · CR · WR 31 · FR 35–44 · RULING

VOL. I · 489 · 497



PORTRAIT · EMPEROR DORIAN VANE · FIFTY-NINE · THE CURRENCY LIKENESS, OR THE PRIVATE ONE

PART IV · DOSSIER 25 · ✣

DORIAN

*He understands that people need to love the machine, or they'll eventually dismantle it (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Dorian Vane, fifty-nine, third Emperor since 2085 (**TL, Ruling**). The son of Elias's removed elder child, raised in the house of the uncle who took his parent's place (**FR 35, 38**). Charming in public, cold in private, and the gap between the two is where he makes his real decisions (**CR**).

STILL OPEN

Whether he knows Azrael is alive, what he says to Judah on the Binding Night, and where the documents are now.

The Imperial record

TKC: TL · CR · FR 35–39 · RULING

VOL. I · 497 · 489

Imperial Record

HOUSE OF VANE · III

AS THE TEMPLE AND THE BROADCAST HOLD IT

NAME	*DORIAN VANE · third Emperor*
BORN	*2045 (INFERENCE from his age at accession)*
PARENT	*_____ · "removed" 2061 (**FR 35–36**)*
RAISED IN	*the house of his uncle, Emperor Crest (**FR 38**)*
ACCESSION	*2085, at forty, by survivorship (**FR 39**)*
ANOINTED WIFE	*Lyris*
SONS	*Azrael (b. 2077, "deceased" 2100) · Judah (b. 2079), Crown Heir*

EMPEROR

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HIM
HIS IMPERIAL MAJESTY	The Empire	
THE EMPEROR	The Broadcast	
FATHER	Judah	
	Lyris	

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT HIS PARENT CALLED HIM, BEFORE 2061

His years against the Empire's

YEAR	AGE	HIS LIFE	SOURCE
2045	0	Born, son of Elias's elder child	INFERENCE, FR 35
2061	16	Elias dies. His parent, the rightful successor, is removed. He learns the ledger names Elias.	FR 35–36, FR 44
2062	17	His uncle Crest takes the throne and raises him inside the house	TL, FR 38
c. 2074	c. 29	Lyris, from Mountain. Thirty years of marriage by 2104.	CR, WR, INFERENCE
2077	32	Azrael born	TL
2079	34	Judah born	TL
2085	40	Crest dies mid-cycle. He takes the throne. The Trial is cancelled.	TL, FR 39
2085–	40–	Brings back the spectacle. The Trials become the most-watched event in the calendar.	TL
2098	53	Azrael brings him the ledger. "Put it back."	TL, FR 43
2100	55	Azrael declared dead. He removes the ledger and the Dissent that week.	TL, FR 42
2102	57	Judah turns twenty-three, and the pressure to marry begins	CR
2104	59	The 39th Trial, his most valuable Broadcast property	TL

CONFLICT The ruling has him "a child" in 2061 (**FR 36**), and his birth year makes him about sixteen. Both hold if he was a minor.

THE DAY IN 2061, FROM INSIDE THE HOUSE

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE DAY IN 2061, FROM INSIDE THE HOUSE

The public version and the private one

TKC: TL · CR · DOM · MEN · FR 37–38

VOL. I · 497 · 500

IN PUBLIC	Handsome where Crest was cold, and everything about him is performance. Under him the Broadcast became genuinely sophisticated (TL). He holds the Quarterly Audiences where everyone watches the seating chart before they watch him (CR).
IN PRIVATE	Cold. The gap between his public and private selves is where his real decisions happen (CR).
ON JUDAH	He's pressed Judah to choose an Anointed Wife since Judah turned twenty-three. He calls it duty, and it's also control, because an unmarried heir's loyalties are still unwritten (CR). The Trials exist partly to make Judah's choice feel like honor instead of pressure (MEN).
ON HIS UNCLE	Crest was aware and didn't act. He neither arranged the removal nor prevented it, and he spent twenty-four years on a throne he knew the shape of (FR 37). Dorian was spared because a child's claim is a claim you can supervise (FR 38).
HIS APPOINTMENTS	Pacific's Governor-Prelate, who performs warmth while administering iron (DOM).

WHAT HE'S LIKE AT A PRIVATE DINNER WITH LYRIS WHEN NO ONE'S SERVING

TKC: CR · TL · FR 44

VOL. I · 509 · 511 · 497

What he believes

WHAT HE BELIEVES	INFERENCE In the machine, and in being loved by the people who live inside it (TL). OPEN QUESTION In God?
WHAT HE KNOWS	The ledger names Elias. He's known since 2061, and it's the only thing he's ever been certain of (FR 44).
WHO TAUGHT HIM	Elias's house, then Crest's. INFERENCE Two teachers, one who believed and one who administered (Vol. I, 497).
WHAT HE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	INFERENCE Nothing. He's the one who decides who is.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A MAN LIKE HIM

The Vane bloodline carries divine sanction. God chose Elias, and the anointing passes to his descendants (CR). INTERPRETATION The Temple's doctrine of the bloodline makes Dorian sacred, and his own knowledge of 2061 makes him the one man in the Empire who can't believe it.

WHAT HE SAYS WHEN HE PRAYS IN PUBLIC, AND WHETHER HE EVER PRAYS IN PRIVATE

The text

2 SAM 9.7–13

DAN 3.4–6

JER 36.21–23

2 SAM 7.16

DEUT 17.18–20

2 SAM 12.7

HIS NAME	*Dorian* has no biblical source. It's Greek, from the Dorians. **INTERPRETATION** To most English readers it's Wilde's Dorian Gray, the beautiful man whose portrait ages in his place.
MEPHIBOSHETH · 2 SAMUEL 9	**POSSIBLE** The grandson of the fallen king, brought to David's court to "eat bread at my table continually." Kindness, and supervision. **Where it breaks:** Mephibosheth never takes the throne. The supervised child became the Emperor (**FR 38**).
THE GOLDEN IMAGE · DANIEL 3	**POSSIBLE** "At what time ye hear the sound of the cornet... ye fall down and worship." A king who governs by spectacle and music. **Where it breaks:** Nebuchadnezzar has a furnace for the ones who won't bow. Dorian's method is to make them love it (**TL**).
JEHOIAKIM · JEREMIAH 36	**POSSIBLE** A king who cuts a prophet's scroll with a penknife, column by column, and burns it. **Where it breaks:** Jehoiakim destroys the document in front of his court. Dorian says put it back, and takes it later (**FR 42–43**).

HE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HIM
2 Samuel 7.16, "thine house and thy kingdom shall be established for ever"	Deuteronomy 17.20, "that his heart be not lifted up above his brethren"
	2 Samuel 12.7, "Thou art the man"

VOLUME ONE

David, 412. Kingmakers, with Nathan, 413. The law of the king, 349. Ezekiel and Daniel, 136. Jeremiah, 134. The removed heir and Dorian, 489.

TKC: CR · TL

Body and fear

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	Handsome. Performance in everything (TL). INFERENCE A body trained to be filmed since 2085, and watched since 2061.
WHAT HE'S AFRAID WILL HAPPEN	INFERENCE An heir whose loyalties stay unwritten (CR). A Judah with genuine questions about the Empire, which the Empire can't survive (CR).

WHAT HE'S AFRAID IS TRUE

WHAT HIS FACE DOES WHEN HE'S ALONE WITH THE LEDGER

Belief arc

TKC: TL · FR 38 · FR 42–44

YOURS

STATION	WHAT HE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT HE DOES	CH.
I · 2061	The ledger names Elias (FR 44)	His parent is removed and he's kept (FR 38)	
II · 2085	People need to love the machine (TL)		
III · 2098–2100	Control the document by letting it be read and returned (FR 43)	His son goes looking for the Dissent (TL). He takes both documents (FR 42).	
IV · The 39th			

WHAT HE SAYS TO JUDAH ON THE BINDING NIGHT, THE CHARGE NO ONE OUTSIDE THE ROOM HEARS (CR)

TKC: TL · CR · DOM · FR 37–44

Who he can move, and who can move him

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
LYRIS	Thirty years, and a network she runs that he may only half see (**CR**)	
JUDAH	Two years of pressure to choose a wife (**CR**)	
AZRAEL	"Put it back" (**TL**)	
CREST	The uncle who raised him on a throne he knew the shape of (**FR 37**)	
THE REMOVED HEIR	His parent (**FR 35**)	
THE PRELATE	Has served three Emperors (**CR**)	
THE MOUNTAIN PATRIARCH	A debt to the family older than the Trials Commission (**TL**)	

THE ONE PERSON WHO CAN STILL SURPRISE HIM

His voice

TKC: WR 31 · CR

THE RULE	He can sound ceremonial, elevated, controlled and Imperial. Keep his line, "My son is not with us tonight," and Judah remaining "in service before covenant." The narration around him stays clear (**WR 31**).
IN PRIVATE	Cold (**CR**). Nothing on the page yet.

THE CEREMONIAL VERSION OF A SENTENCE, AND THE PRIVATE VERSION OF THE SAME SENTENCE

LINES ONLY DORIAN WOULD SAY

TKC: FR 43–44 · CR

THE CONTRADICTION

WHAT HE BELIEVES AND BREAKS	**INFERENCE** He rules as God's anointed, through a bloodline the Temple calls sacred (**CR**), and he's the one man who knows what the ledger says about the man it started with (**FR 44**).
WHAT IT COSTS	A son "deceased," and a document he can never destroy without telling someone it mattered (**TL, FR 43**).

HOW HE JUSTIFIES IT TO HIMSELF

THE SCENE WHERE IT LANDS ON HIM, AND WHO'S IN THE ROOM

The machinery around him

Dorian built most of the machinery the other dossiers describe. The Broadcast became sophisticated under him, and the Trials became its most valuable property (TL). It holds forty percent of the Covenant Score through narrative priority decisions nobody discloses (TR).

What presses on him is older. He sits on the throne by survivorship, the son of an heir removed in 2061 (FR 35, 39). The ledger in his keeping names Elias (FR 44). His heir is twenty-five, unmarried, and keeps a room on the Administrative Side his father doesn't know about (CR). His elder son is officially dead, and the paperwork was quiet (TL).

INTERPRETATION A man who governs by being loved has to keep the people closest to him from looking at the paper.

TL | CR | FR 35–44

THE CALENDAR

Quarterly Audiences, the Temple calendar, Trial season, and the Binding Night (CR).

MARGINALIA

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the Crown and the House of Vane, 497.

TKC: TL · FR 43

WRITING

PUT IT BACK

Azrael, twenty-one, brings his father a ledger from the east wing archive. Their father tells him to put it back (TL). A document Azrael has read and returned is a document Dorian controls, and destroying it would tell Azrael it mattered (FR 43).

1 · WHAT AZRAEL SAYS, AND WHAT DORIAN'S FACE DOES WHILE HE READS

2 · HOW LONG DORIAN WAITS BEFORE HE SPEAKS

3 · WHAT HE DOES THAT NIGHT, ALONE

Write him off camera

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Ten minutes of Dorian in a room the Broadcast never films, with nothing to perform. If he can't stop performing, write that.

WRITE

TKC: CR · MEN

Dorian and Judah

The pressure to choose a wife has become something that takes up space in every conversation they have (CR).

WHAT DORIAN WANTS FROM JUDAH, AND WON'T SAY

WHAT JUDAH KNOWS ABOUT HIS FATHER, AND WON'T SAY

THE BINDING NIGHT, AT THE TABLE

PUT PRESSURE ON THE BELIEF

THE SCAFFOLD

The belief, in his words

Who can challenge it

A room he can't leave

Who else is watching, and for whom

What the other person wants

What he wants

What he says

What he won't say

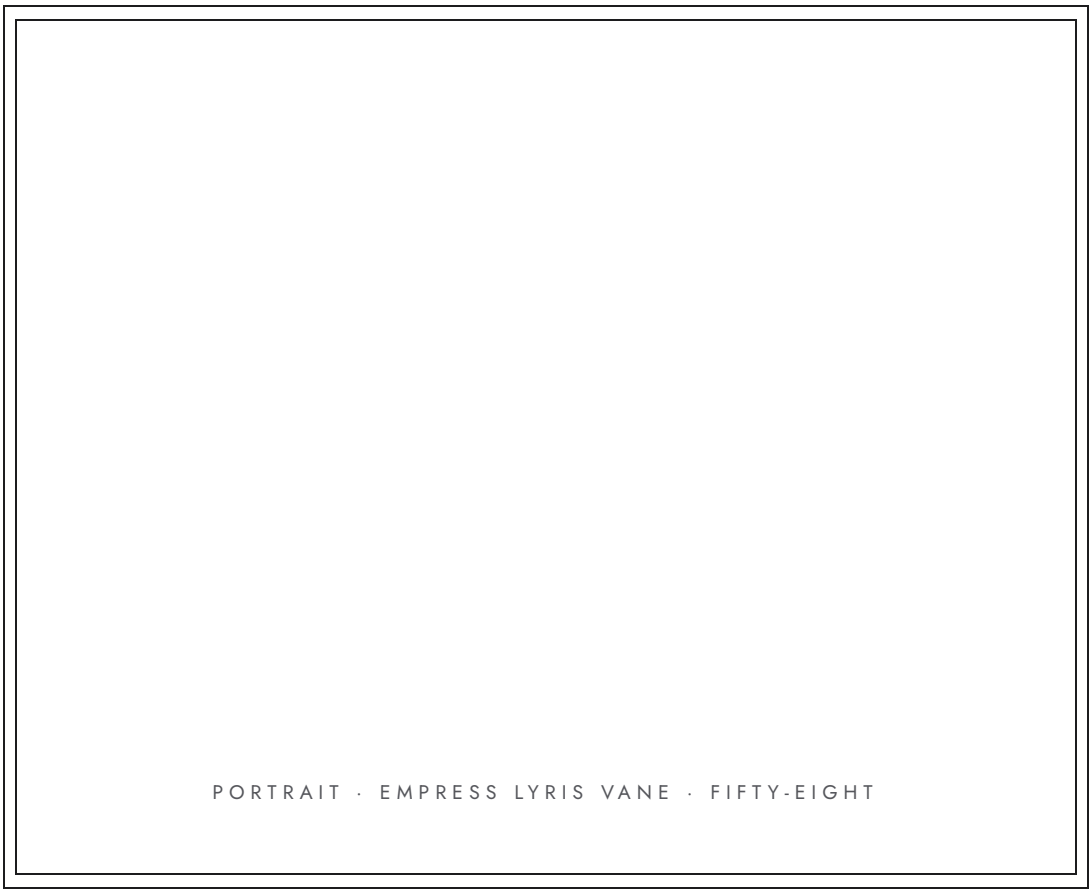
ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING DORIAN'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH



PORTRAIT · EMPRESS LYRIS VANE · FIFTY-EIGHT

PART IV · DOSSIER 26 · ✣

LYRIS

*The most sophisticated political operator in the Empire, and the least visible one, because she's spent thirty years performing perfect Anointed Wifehood (**CR**).*

ON THE RECORD

Empress Lyris Vane, fifty-eight, from Mountain Dominion (**CR, WR 32**). Mother of Azrael and Judah. One of four people who know Azrael is alive (**TL**). She runs the Arrangement (**CR**).

STILL OPEN

How a woman from Mountain became Dorian's wife, what she tells Eden in eleven minutes, and what happens in the room at the Anointing.

TKC: CR · TL · WR 32

VOL. I · 497 · 521

The Imperial record

Imperial Record

HOUSE OF VANE

ANOINTED WIFE OF THE EMPEROR

NAME	*LYRIS VANE · Empress*
OF	*Mountain Dominion (**WR 32**)*
DESIGNATION	*Anointed Wife · c. 2074*
SONS	*Azrael · Judah*
PUBLIC DUTIES	*ceremonial, says the record (**CR**)*

ANOINTED

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HER
EMPRESS	The Empire	
LYRIS	Dorian, the Anointed Court	
MOTHER	Judah. Azrael, once publicly.	
	The name she had in Mountain	

She is Lyris. Never Cordelia, and never any other invented name (**WR 32**).

HER NAME BEFORE HER BINDING, AND WHETHER ANYONE STILL USES IT

HER NAME BEFORE HER BINDING, AND WHETHER ANYONE STILL USES IT

TKC: CR · TL · TR · WR

VOL. I · 476

Her years against the Empire's

YEAR	HER LIFE	SOURCE
c. 2046	Born in Mountain Dominion. INFERENCE from her age.	WR 32
c. 2074	Bound to Dorian. Mentored in her first year by an Anointed Wife who taught her the Arrangement.	CR, INFERENCE
2077	Azrael, her favorite, the first child who showed her who she actually was	TL
2079	Judah	TL
2085	Empress, when Dorian takes the throne	TL
c. 2085–95	A decade lobbying through Dorian for the Anointed Wife's legal protections, each one framed as his gift	CR
2100	Azrael declared dead. She knows he isn't.	TL
2104	The 39th Trial, watched "with specific and personal interest"	TL

OPEN QUESTION Was she a Covenant Daughter? Dorian wasn't heir when they married, and the Trials had been running since 2065 (Vol. I, 497).

How a woman from Mountain became the wife of a supervised prince

The record's version and the true one

ON THE RECORD	Ceremonial (**CR**).
IN FACT	For thirty years she's run the domestic and diplomatic infrastructure of Imperial life (**CR**). She runs the Arrangement, inherited from the Anointed Wife who mentored her and refined into something close to a shadow government: about forty Anointed Wives who decide what should happen and arrange for their husbands to decide it (**CR**).
THE LAW	She's the reason the Anointed Wife designation has the shape it has. She lobbied through Dorian for a decade and framed every gain as a gift he was giving (**CR**).
ON CAMERA	She doesn't appear on the Broadcast in any way that reveals anything, and she's spent thirty years making sure of it (**CR**).
ON EDEN	She'll recognize something she hasn't seen in thirty years of candidates, and won't decide right away whether that's a reason to help Eden or destroy her (**CR**). She's the blueprint Eden doesn't know she's following (**CR**).

THE AFTERNOON SOCIAL WHERE SHE SETS THE NEXT WEEK'S POLICY

TKC: CR · TL · WR

VOL. I · 551 · 527 · 509

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	Mountain, where the name of the dead is spoken to the mountain and not to God or the Temple (DOM). The Anointed Wife who mentored her (CR).
WHAT SHE SAYS IN PUBLIC	The Anointing was the most meaningful moment of her life. She's never said what actually happens in the room (CR).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION Whether she believes in God, the Temple or only the Arrangement.
GRIEF	The hour of private Binding of Return after the death of her own parents was the only time in Imperial Mourning she remembered what grief felt like (CR).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

The husband leads, the wife supports, and the household reflects divine order in miniature (CR). INTERPRETATION She's the Empire's model of that doctrine and the proof it's performance.

OPEN QUESTION Why did her own parents receive Imperial Mourning? Were they Vanes, or was she remembering them during someone else's (CR)?

WHAT SHE PRAYS, IF SHE DOES, THE NIGHT AZRAEL IS DECLARED DEAD

The text

HER NAME	*Lyris* has no biblical source. **INTERPRETATION** It sounds like the lyre, the instrument David played to quiet a troubled king (1 Sam 16.23).
REBEKAH · GENESIS 25–27	**POSSIBLE** "Rebekah loved Jacob," and she engineers which son gets the blessing (25.28). **Where it breaks:** Rebekah steers the blessing to her favorite. Lyris's favorite was the elder, and the succession went to the younger anyway when the elder was declared dead (**TL**).
BATHSHEBA · 1 KINGS 1–2	**POSSIBLE** The queen mother who works with a prophet to put her son on the throne, and is given a seat at the king's right hand. **Where it breaks:** Bathsheba's influence is on the record. Lyris's has been kept off it for thirty years (**CR**).
MICHAL AT THE WINDOW · 1 SAMUEL 19	**POSSIBLE** A wife who lets David down through a window and puts an idol in his bed to buy him time. **Where it breaks:** Michal saves her husband from her father. Lyris may have saved her son from his.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Proverbs 31.23, "Her husband is known in the gates"	Esther 9.29, where the queen "wrote with all authority"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Genesis, the family line, 260. Bathsheba, 395. Hannah, Abigail and Michal, 393. Esther, 399. The Arrangement, 527. Mountain, 551.

GEN 25.28

GEN 27

1 KGS 1.11–31

1 KGS 2.19

1 SAM 19.11–17

PROV 31.23

ESTH 9.29

TKC: CR · TR

Body and fear

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	At Eden's Testimony she watches Eden finish, looks at her hands, and then looks at Judah (**TR**). Imperial grief is performed as dignity, and the family doesn't cry in public (**CR**).
WHAT SHE'S AFRAID WILL HAPPEN	**INFERENCE** That someone learns where Azrael is.

WHAT SHE'S AFRAID IS TRUE

WHAT HER HANDS DO WHEN SHE LOOKS AT THEM

Belief arc

TKC: CR · TL · TR

YOURS

STATION	WHAT SHE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT SHE DOES	CH.
I · Mountain			
II · The first year	The Arrangement, as her mentor taught it (CR)		
III · 2100		Azrael "dies," and she helps keep him alive (TL)	
IV · Eden		Help her or destroy her (CR)	

THE MOMENT SHE DECIDES ABOUT EDEN

TKC: CR · TL · TR

Who she can move, and who can move her

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
DORIAN	Thirty years of the Arrangement, each gain his gift (**CR**)	
AZRAEL	Her favorite. Alive, and she knows (**TL**).	
JUDAH	He knows pieces of what she runs, and the pieces have made him careful at dinner (**CR**)	
EDEN	Eleven minutes and three things (**TR**)	
THE ANOINTED COURT	About forty wives (**CR**)	Hers
HER MENTOR	The woman who taught her the Arrangement (**CR**)	

THE THREE THINGS SHE SAYS TO EDEN

Voice and Contradiction

TKC: CR · TR · WR 32

THE CONTRADICTION	**INFERENCE** She's the Empire's model Anointed Wife, and she runs the shadow government that makes the model a lie (**CR**).
THE MEETING	Eden and Lyris are the only two people in the story playing the same game at the same level (**CR**).

LINES ONLY LYRIS WOULD SAY

HOW SHE SPEAKS TO DORIAN WHEN SHE'S SURFACING AN IDEA THAT'S ALREADY HERS

CR TL TR

THE WIDOWED COVENANT

Two years of protection for an Anointed widow, then remarriage or Stewardwife. Her network has made sure no one has ever dropped (CR).

MARGINALIA

The machinery around her

Lyris lives inside the most watched marriage in the Empire. The powerful have their intimacy taken from them on purpose, because citizens invested in Imperial marriages won't overthrow the family whose love story they followed (CR).

She answers the watching with the Arrangement, a network of about forty wives that's never once let a widow fall below Stewardwife (CR). She answers her son's death with a secret that only four people hold (TL). And she answers the Trials by watching them with "specific and personal interest" (TL), because the woman Judah marries will become either her successor in the network or its first real threat.

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the Arrangement, 527.

Eleven minutes

TKC: TR · CR

WRITING

The Anointed Evening, four hours in the Crown Palace reception hall, cameras in the hall and not the side rooms. Eden spends eleven minutes with Lyris. Lyris says three things that aren't on any Broadcast record, and the third is a warning that's also, if you know how to hear it, a set of instructions. Judah watches from across the hall. He's never seen his mother spend eleven uninterrupted minutes with a candidate (TR).

1 · THE FIRST THING

2 · THE SECOND THING

3 · THE THIRD THING, THE WARNING AND THE INSTRUCTIONS

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Write her the morning after

Ten minutes. The morning after the Anointed Evening, Lyris alone, deciding.

WRITE

Lyris and Azrael

TKC: TL

He was her favorite, the way first children who show you who you actually are always are (TL).

WHAT SHE DID IN 2100, AND WHAT IT COST

WHAT HE THINKS SHE DID

THE LAST TIME SHE SAW HIM

Put pressure on the belief

THE SCAFFOLD
The belief, in her words
Who can challenge it
A room she can't leave
Who else is watching, and for whom
What the other person wants
What she wants
What she says
What she won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING LYRIS'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

TKC: TL · CR · TR · MEN · WR 33–37

VOL. I · 497 · 417

PORTRAIT · JUDAH ELIJAH VANE · TWENTY-FIVE · CROWN HEIR

PART IV · DOSSIER 27 · ✣

JUDAH

*The most watched young man in the Empire and the loneliest one (**CR**). He's two years younger than a brother the Empire says is dead (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Judah Elijah Vane, twenty-five, Crown Heir. The 39th Trial will decide his Anointed Wife. He moderates the Social Policy debate, has been looking for the Covenant of Dissent since before his brother's exile, and knows about Hannah, and always has (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

What he does with the recommendation at the Declaration (**TR**), what he knows about Hannah, and what he does wrong first (**CR**).

The Imperial record

TKC: TL · CR · MEN

VOL. I · 497 · 507

Imperial Record

HOUSE OF VANE

HEIR IMPERIAL · FILMED SINCE BIRTH

NAME	*JUDAH ELIJAH VANE*
BORN	*2079 · second son*
HEIR SINCE	*2100, when the line passed cleanly (**TL**)*
FORMATION	*the Temple, as much as his parents (**TL**) · assessed by the Prelate (**CR**)*
RESIDENCE	*the Crown Residence, a wing of the Palace (**CR**)*
REGISTERED STUDY	*_____ (**CR**)*
MARRIAGE	*unbound at twenty-five · elite window 25–35 (**MEN**)*

HEIR IMPERIAL

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HIM
THE CROWN HEIR	The Empire, the Broadcast	
JUDAH	Lyris, Azrael	
MY SON	Dorian, in public	
	Eden	

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO NAMED HIM ELIJAH, AND WHAT THEY MEANT BY IT

His years against the Empire's

YEAR	AGE	HIS LIFE	SOURCE
2079	0	Born into dynasty with no say in what it means	TL
2085	6	His father takes the throne	TL
2098	19	Azrael finds the ledger	TL
BEFORE 2100		Already looking for the Covenant of Dissent	TL
2100	21	Azrael declared dead. Judah is heir. He knows Azrael is alive. Reassigns a room on the Administrative Side to himself through three layers of paperwork.	TL, CR
2102	23	His father starts pressing him to choose	CR
2104	25	The 39th Trial	TL

THE FIRST TIME HE STOOD AT THE CENTER OF THE GRACE BRIDGE, AND WHY

TKC: CR · TL · MEN

VOL. I · 499 · 497

The public version and the private one

IN PUBLIC	He's been performing Judah Vane since before he understood what performing meant. The Temple formed him, the Crown trained him, and the Broadcast has filmed him since birth (CR).
THE CROWN RESIDENCE	Impeccably kept, and nowhere a person actually lives. He's never said so to anyone (CR).
THE STUDY	A room on the Administrative Side, registered as a "policy research facility." Books not on the approved list, a window facing the Grace Bridge, no Broadcast equipment. The only place he isn't performing. His father, the Temple advisors and his own security detail don't know about it (CR).
WHAT HE SUSPECTS	The certainty he was handed was designed to keep him manageable more than to make him good. The Empire can't survive a Judah with genuine questions about the Empire (CR).
OPEN QUESTION	What does he know about Hannah, and since when (TL)?

WHAT'S ON THE STUDY'S SHELVES

What he believes

TKC: TL · CR

VOL. I · 511 · 492 · 428

WHO TAUGHT HIM	The Temple raised him as much as his parents did (TL). The Prelate assessed his spiritual formation personally (CR). Temple advisors manage it still (CR).
WHAT HE BELIEVES	INFERENCE Something he's been working out in the Study for four years that isn't Imperial (CR).
WHAT HE'S LOOKING FOR	The Covenant of Dissent, Elias's own counter-argument to everything the Empire was built on, written in the same hand the same year as the Covenant of Purpose (TL).
WHAT HE'D BE ARRESTED FOR, IF HE WEREN'T THE HEIR	The Study, the Grace Bridge, and a brother who's alive (CR, TL).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A MAN LIKE HIM

The Vane bloodline carries God's anointing (CR). POSSIBLE The Temple teaches him Genesis 49.10, "The sceptre shall not depart from Judah," as a verse about him.

THE QUESTION HE'S ASKED IN THE STUDY THAT HE'S NEVER ASKED OUT LOUD

GEN 37.26–27

GEN 38.26

GEN 44.33

GEN 49.10

1 KGS 19.4–12

DEUT 17.18–19

MARK 10.42–45

The Text

JUDAH	Leah's fourth son. He proposes selling Joseph instead of killing him (Gen 37.26–27). He wrongs Tamar and admits it, "She hath been more righteous than I" (38.26). In Egypt he offers himself as a slave in Benjamin's place, the longest speech in Genesis (44.33, Vol. I, 410).
WHERE JUDAH BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** The biblical Judah sells a brother and later offers himself for another. Judah Vane inherited his brother's place and keeps his brother alive.
ELIJAH	Confronts a king and a queen, wins on Carmel, then runs, asks to die under a juniper tree, and hears God in "a still small voice" (1 Kgs 19.4, 12). The founder's name, Elias, is the King James New Testament spelling of the same prophet (Vol. I, 417).
WHERE ELIJAH BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** Elijah runs from the palace into the wilderness. Judah's wilderness is a room on the Administrative Side.

HE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HIM BY HIS ADVISORS
Genesis 38.26, "She hath been more righteous than I"	Deuteronomy 17.18–19, the king copying the law "and he shall read therein all the days of his life"
	Mark 10.43, "whosoever will be great among you, shall be your minister"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> The founders, with Judah, 410. Tamar, 386. Kingmakers, with Elijah, 413. The law of the king, 349. What he meant by kingdom, 424. The ledger and the Dissent, 492.

Body and fear

TKC: CR · TR · WR 36–37

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	Restrained, guarded, observant, and out of step with the room's performance. His stillness is specific (**WR 36**). His attention travels through a room to the cameras and the exits (**WR 37**). He's learned to route around his own security detail (**CR**).
WHAT HE'S AFRAID WILL HAPPEN	**INFERENCE** Choosing, and having the choice be the Empire's.

WHAT HE'S AFRAID IS TRUE

WHAT HIS BODY DOES WHEN HE WATCHES EDEN'S ARRIVAL FOOTAGE THE THIRD TIME

TKC: CR · TR · TL

YOURS

Belief arc

STATION	WHAT HE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT HE DOES	CH.
I · Formed	The certainty he was handed (CR)	Azrael and the ledger (TL)	
II · The Study	INFERENCE The certainty was designed to keep him manageable (CR)	Eden's arrival, watched three times (CR)	
III · The Trial		Trades Ruth to keep Sera (TR)	
IV · The Declaration		What he does with the recommendation (TR)	

When Eden figures out the Study exists, it'll be the first time he's felt seen and not assessed. He won't know what to do with it, and he'll do the wrong thing first (CR).

THE WRONG THING HE DOES FIRST

Who he can move, and who can move him

TKC: TL · TR · CR · FR 20–22

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
EDEN	Six minutes of watching at the Testimony. Thirty minutes at the Pairing. "I know." (TR)	
DORIAN	Two years of pressure (CR)	
LYRIS	Pieces of what she runs, enough to make him careful at dinner (CR)	
AZRAEL	Alive, and Judah knows (TL)	
HANNAH	Something he's always known (TL)	
SERA AND RUTH	He trades one to keep the other (TR)	His
THE PRELATE	Assessed his formation (CR)	

WHAT THE DECLARATION RULES LEAVE HIM, IN HIS OWN WORDS: FREE CHOICE, COSTLY DEVIATION, REFUSAL AS ABSTENTION (FR 20–22)

TKC: TR · WR 33–37

His voice

ON THE PAGE	At the Pairing he sends the officials out, which has never been done. The Crown advisor resists, and he's "precise and final," and they go. He checks Eden for a wire and explains afterward what he did and why the order mattered (TR).
THE EXCHANGE	"Most candidates tell me they feel called." "I know." (TR)
THE RULES	His early moves are small and deniable, a look, a barely-there nod, a shift near the door. He isn't a generic mysterious boy (WR 34, 36).

LINES ONLY JUDAH WOULD SAY

HOW HE SPEAKS AS HEIR, AND HOW HE SPEAKS IN THE STUDY

The contradiction

TKC: TR · TL · CR

WHAT HE BELIEVES AND BREAKS	**INFERENCE** He's looking for the document that argues against the Empire (**TL**), and to keep one woman in the Trials he sends another home who never learns why (**TR**).
WHAT IT COSTS	Ruth, who goes home believing she wasn't enough (**TR**).

HOW HE JUSTIFIES THE TRADE TO HIMSELF

WHETHER EDEN EVER FINDS OUT, AND THE SCENE

MEN | CR | FR 20–22

SEVEN STAGES

The Declaration, Covenant Week, the Anointing, the Binding Night, the Grand Binding, the Procession, the Private Supper (CR).

MARGINALIA

The machinery around him

The Trials exist partly because of Judah's reluctance. The Empire needed a way to make his choice feel like honor and not pressure (MEN). An heir's Binding is the biggest Broadcast event of the year, and his staying unbound since twenty has become its own running story (CR).

He has rules on his side and none of them help. He can choose any of the twelve. "Without deviation" is a record and not a rule (FR 20). Deviation is permitted and expensive, and no heir has ever paid it (FR 21). If he refuses, the recommendation stands by default, so refusal is abstention and produces the same result as compliance (FR 22). The ranking tells him which choice is free. His escape routes are a room nobody's traced and a bridge with a blind spot (CR), and a brother in Mountain Dominion who can't come back (TL).

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the Declaration and its rules, 573.

Thirty minutes

TKC: TR

WRITING

A Crown advisor, a Vowed officer, a camera outside the door, and an unrecorded room. He sends the officials out. He checks her for a wire. She tells him she wants the kind of power that changes things. He's quiet for four seconds. "Most candidates tell me they feel called." "I know." He looks at her a little longer than the format allows, then asks his next question (TR).

1 · THE FOUR SECONDS, FROM INSIDE HIS HEAD

2 · HIS NEXT QUESTION

3 · THE REST OF THE THIRTY MINUTES

WRITING

FREEWRITE

Write him in the Study

Ten minutes. The Study, the window on the Grace Bridge, a book that isn't on the list, nobody watching.

WRITE

Judah and Eden

TKC: TR · CR · WR 33–37

Attention before desire. She doesn't know why her attention catches on him, and she distrusts it (**WR 33**). He watches her arrival footage three times before he understands why he can't stop (**CR**).

WHAT JUDAH SEES IN EDEN, IN ORDER

WHAT EDEN SEES IN JUDAH, IN ORDER

THE DECLARATION, FROM HIS SIDE

WRITING

SCENE LAB

Put pressure on the belief

THE SCAFFOLD
The belief, in his words
Who can challenge it
A room he can't leave
Who else is watching, and for whom
What the other person wants
What he wants
What he says
What he won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING JUDAH'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

TKC: TL · TR · FR 41–43

VOL. I · 492 · 551

PORTRAIT · AZRAEL VANE · TWENTY-SEVEN · OFFICIALLY DECEASED SINCE 2100

PART IV · DOSSIER 28 · ✣

AZRAEL

*He asked questions the Temple had already decided were settled, and the questions didn't stop (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Azrael Vane, twenty-seven, firstborn of Dorian and Lyris. Found the east wing ledger at twenty-one. Officially deceased since 2100 after "a medical event." He's alive, in Mountain Dominion under another name (**TL**).

STILL OPEN

His name now, the patriarch's debt, who the other two are who know, and what he found that was "enough" (**TL**).

Two records

TKC: TL · CR

VOL. I · 497 · 492

Imperial Record

HOUSE OF VANE

NAME
AZRAEL VANE

BORN
2077 · firstborn

DIED
2100 · a medical event

ANNOUNCEMENT
*none (**TL**)*

DECEASED

Registry

MOUNTAIN DOMINION

NAME
_____

BORN
_____

HOUSEHOLD
*a community under a patriarch (**TL**)*

ARRIVED
2100

NAME	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT DOES TO HIM
AZRAEL	Lyris, Judah, the dead record	
	The community in Mountain	
	Petra, if the boy next door is who you think	

His name has no biblical source. In later Islamic and Jewish tradition Azrael is the angel of death (Vol. I, 417).

THE NAME HE CHOSE, OR WAS GIVEN, IN MOUNTAIN

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE NAME HE CHOSE, OR WAS GIVEN, IN MOUNTAIN

His years against the Empire's

TKC: TL · FR 41–43

VOL. I · 476

YEAR	AGE	HIS LIFE	SOURCE
2077	0	Born, the heir apparent, his mother's favorite	TL
CHILDHOOD		Curious from the beginning, genuinely, in the way the Empire's schools are built to contain and fail to	TL
2098	21	A Crown advisory access period puts him in the east wing archive legitimately. He finds the ledger and takes it to his father.	TL, FR 41
2098–2100	21–23	Doesn't put it back. Looks for the Covenant of Dissent and doesn't find it. What he finds is enough.	TL
2100	23	Officially deceased. No announcement. The line passes to Judah.	TL
2100–04	23–27	Mountain Dominion, under a different name	TL

WHAT HE FOUND THAT WAS "ENOUGH"

TKC: TL · TR · DOM

VOL. I · 551

The record's version and the true one

ON THE RECORD	Dead since 2100 of a medical event (TL). "A sudden medical event" is the phrase the Empire uses for Petra too (TR).
IN FACT	Alive, in a Mountain community whose patriarch owes the Vane family a debt that predates the Trials Commission by a decade. The Empire doesn't know. Almost no one does (TL).
WHERE HE IS	Mountain is where the Empire's least documented and most important work happens, up past Crestfall (DOM). Endurance returns to its lower ranges for the 39th Trial without explanation (TR).
WHO KNOWS	Judah, Lyris and two others (TL).

WHAT HE DOES ALL DAY IN MOUNTAIN, AND WHAT HE CAN NEVER DO THERE

What he believes

TKC: TL · FR 44

VOL. I · 511 · 492

WHO TAUGHT HIM	The Temple's schools, which he out-asked (TL), and after them the ledger.
WHAT HE KNOWS	The Covenant of Purpose calls a series of deliberate removals God's order. The ledger calls them something else (TL).
WHAT HE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION After the ledger, what's left of the faith he was raised in, and what he'd put in its place.
WHAT HE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	Being alive (TL).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A MAN LIKE HIM

A son of the anointed bloodline is anointed (CR). INTERPRETATION The Temple has no doctrine for an anointed son who asks what the anointing is built on, so it recorded him as dead.

WHAT HE BELIEVES THE COVENANT OF DISSENT SAYS

GEN 37.31–35

1 KGS 17.2–6

1 KGS 18.4

JER 36.26

LUKE 8.17

JER 36.23

The text

JOSEPH · GENESIS 37	**POSSIBLE** A favored son reported dead to his father, alive in another country (37.31–35). **Where it breaks:** Jacob grieves a lie his other sons told him. In Azrael's family the question is who told the lie (**TL**).
ELIJAH AT CHERITH · 1 KINGS 17	**POSSIBLE** Told to hide himself by a brook, and fed there by ravens. **Where it breaks:** Elijah goes back to confront the king. Whether Azrael can is the book.
OBADIAH'S CAVE · 1 KINGS 18.4	**POSSIBLE** A palace steward who hides a hundred prophets in caves and feeds them with bread and water. **INTERPRETATION** The patriarch who owes the Vanes a debt (**TL**).
BARUCH · JEREMIAH 36	**POSSIBLE** The scribe of a scroll the king wants destroyed. "But the LORD hid them" (36.26).

HE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HIM
Luke 8.17, "nothing is secret, that shall not be made manifest"	Jeremiah 36.23, a king cutting a scroll with a penknife

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> The founders, with Joseph, 410. Kingmakers, with Elijah, 413. Jeremiah, 134. The ledger and the Dissent, 492. Mountain, 551.

Body and fear

TKC: TL · DOM

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	**INFERENCE** Four years in Mountain, where altitude changes everything and winters are long and clarifying (**DOM**).
WHAT HE'S AFRAID WILL HAPPEN	**INFERENCE** That someone in the Trials comes looking.

WHAT HE'S AFRAID IS TRUE

WHAT FOUR YEARS IN THE MOUNTAINS HAVE DONE TO HIS BODY

TKC: TL

YOURS

Belief arc

STATION	WHAT HE BELIEVES	WHAT CRACKS IT, AND WHAT HE DOES	CH.
I · The Temple's son	The Temple's settled answers, questioned (TL)	The ledger (TL)	
II · 2098	His father will want to know (INFERENCE)	"Put it back" (TL)	
III · 2100		Declared dead (TL)	
IV · Mountain			

WHETHER HE WANTS TO COME BACK, AND TO WHAT

Who he can move, and who can move him

TKC: TL · TR · FR 42–43

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM	LEVERAGE
JUDAH	Two years younger, and the brother who knows (**TL**)	
LYRIS	The favorite, and she knows (**TL**)	
DORIAN	"Put it back." The documents gone the week he "died." (**TL, FR 42**)	
THE PATRIARCH	A debt to the family, older than the Trials Commission (**TL**)	
PETRA	**OPEN QUESTION** The boy next door, or someone tied to him (**TR**)	
THE OTHER TWO		

WHO THE BOY NEXT DOOR IN CRESTFALL IS, AND WHETHER AZRAEL KNOWS PETRA DIED LOOKING

TKC: TL

WRITING

Voice and Contradiction

THE CONTRADICTION	INFERENCE He went looking for the truth about his family and survived by becoming one of its secrets.

LINES ONLY AZRAEL WOULD SAY

WHAT HE SOUNDS LIKE TO PEOPLE IN MOUNTAIN WHO DON'T KNOW WHO HE IS

The east wing

TKC: TL · FR 41

WRITING

At twenty-one, during a Crown advisory access period, he goes into the east wing archive legitimately and finds a ledger that shouldn't exist, left there since 2085 and unmoved for thirteen years because nobody was looking (**TL, FR 41**).

1 · THE SHELF, THE BINDING, THE FIRST PAGE

2 · THE LINE WHERE HE UNDERSTOOD WHAT HE WAS READING

3 · THE WALK TO HIS FATHER'S ROOMS

TKC: TL · CR

Azrael and Judah

WHAT AZRAEL WANTS JUDAH TO DO

WHAT JUDAH HAS DONE, AND HASN'T, SINCE 2100

THE LAST CONVERSATION THEY HAD IN PERSON, AND WHERE

PUT PRESSURE ON THE BELIEF

THE SCAFFOLD

The belief, in his words

Who can challenge it

A room he can't leave

Who else is watching, and for whom

What the other person wants

What he wants

What he says

What he won't say

ROUGH THE SCENE. DIALOGUE ONLY IS FINE.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING AZRAEL'S DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH



PORTRAIT · THE PRELATE · WORKING NAME AURELIA · SIXTY-SEVEN

TKC: CR · TR · FR 33

VOL. I · 502 · 501

PART IV · DOSSIER 29 · ✣ · SHORT

The Prelate

*She'll reach a conclusion about Eden in the first week that she won't share with anyone, the Emperor included. What she does with it will matter more than almost any other single decision in the story (**CR**).*

ON THE RECORD

Head of the Crownward's Vowed order, sixty-seven, servant of three Emperors, and the most institutionally knowledgeable person in the city about how power actually works (**CR**). Phase One belongs to her (**TR**).

HER NAME

POSSIBLE Prelate Aurelia, a working name until you choose one. She's never Huldah, and never Naomi, which belongs to Hannah's daughter (**FR 33**).

TKC: CR · TR · FR 33

VOL. I · 501 · 502 · 525

The Record and the Office

Temple Record

THE SANCTUM · CROWNWARD

NAME	*PRELATE _____ · working name Aurelia (POSSIBLE)*
OFFICE	*head of the Crownward Vowed*
AGE	*sixty-seven (**CR**)*
EMPERORS SERVED	*three (**CR**)*

PRELATE

WHAT SHE DOES	Assessed Judah's spiritual formation herself (**CR**). Runs Phase One with her senior Vowed team, and writes three of Eden's Doctrinal Assessment questions personally (**TR**). Anoints the chosen woman on the sixth day of Covenant Week, the one stage that isn't filmed, and places the gold cord on the couple's right hands at the Grand Binding (**CR**).
WHAT SHE HOLDS	The Vowed hold what they know about every Anointed family in memory, passed between them as part of their formation and never written down anywhere the Empire could take it (**CR**).
SUPERSEDED	"Prelate Naomi" (**TR, CR**) and "Prelate Huldah" (**AM**). Renamed under FR 33.
OPEN QUESTION	*Aurelia* is also the name of Eden's city. A working name that matches the seat of Aurem will confuse a reader, or mean something. Decide which.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

HER REAL NAME, AND WHO IN THE CROWNWARD STILL USES IT

1 SAM 16.13

1 KGS 1.39

1 SAM 3.1–10

2 KGS 11.2

VOL. I · 501 · 413 · 240

Faith and scripture

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**OPEN QUESTION** Thirty years assessing candidates and three Emperors (**CR**) leave no record of what she believes.
WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER	**INTERPRETATION** She's the Temple. The Crownward's Vowed perform perfect devotion under the closest observation in the Empire (**CR**).
HER NAME	*Aurelia* is Latin, from *aurum*, gold. It has no biblical source.
SAMUEL AND ZADOK	**POSSIBLE** Samuel pours the oil on David among his brothers (1 Sam 16.13), and Zadok anoints Solomon with a horn of oil from the tabernacle (1 Kgs 1.39). **Where it breaks:** Their anointing chooses a king. Hers confirms a choice a committee already made (**FR 21**).
JEHOSHEBA · 2 KINGS 11	**POSSIBLE** A woman of the priestly household who hides a prince in the temple for six years. **Where it breaks:** Only if she's one of the two others who know about Azrael.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
	1 Samuel 3.1, "the word of the LORD was precious in those days"

Volume One: the Temple and the Vowed, 501, and the Prelate, 502. Kingmakers, prophets and priests, 413. The licensed prophetic office, 240.

WHAT SHE CONCLUDES ABOUT EDEN IN THE FIRST WEEK

Who she's assessed

TKC: CR · TR

PERSON	WHAT PASSES BETWEEN THEM
JUDAH	She assessed his spiritual formation (**CR**)
EDEN	Three questions written in her own hand (**TR**)
LYRIS	The Anointing, whatever happens in the room (**CR**)
DORIAN	One of three Emperors (**CR**)
THE THEOLOGICAL INTERVIEW OFFICER	Twenty years of the work, reporting up (**TR**)

WHAT HAPPENS IN THE ROOM AT THE ANOINTING

LINES ONLY SHE WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write the three questions

Ten minutes. Her study in the Sanctum, the Settling's reports on her desk, and three questions for one candidate.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

Working Questions for the House of Vane

YOURS

OPEN QUESTIONS

BACK MATTER LOG

1 · WHO ARRANGED AZRAEL'S "MEDICAL EVENT," AND WHO SIGNED THE PAPER?

2 · WHAT DID THE REMOVED HEIR KNOW OR DO THAT MADE REMOVAL NECESSARY IN 2061?

3 · WHO ARE THE TWO OTHERS WHO KNOW AZRAEL IS ALIVE?

4 · DOES ANYONE AT DORIAN'S COURT HOLD NATHAN'S OFFICE, AND HAS ANYONE EVER SAID "THOU ART THE MAN" TO HIM?

5 · WHAT DOES LYRIS WANT FOR JUDAH'S MARRIAGE, AND WHAT DOES SHE WANT FOR THE NETWORK?

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

5 · WHAT DOES LYRIS WANT FOR JUDAH'S MARRIAGE, AND WHAT DOES SHE WANT FOR THE NETWORK?

V

PART FIVE ·

The 39th Trial as Story

The beats in order, the women who leave and when, the story the Broadcast tells, and a planner for every chapter.

i · How to use this part	352
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x · Threads into book two	362
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TR CR TL FR 19–25

CONTENT

Two deaths and violence in Endurance. Content notes sit at the top of the pages that carry them.

MARGINALIA

The Trial as story

Volume One treats the Covenant Trials as an institution, how they work in any year. This part is the 39th as a plot. It prints the beats your files already fix, in order, and leaves a chapter column beside each one, so the outline and the files stay in the same place.

The three phases already line up with the novel's three movements. The Temple's phase asks who are you, and the novel calls it Genesis. The Crown's phase asks how smart are you, and it's Exodus. Endurance asks what you're willing to endure, and it's Revelation (TR). Every beat sits under one of the three, and the Trial's own scripture-shaped names are the Empire's choice, which the novel is free to turn. After the beats come four tools: a tracker of who's still in the Crownward at each phase, the Broadcast's story set against what happened, a map of where each character stands on the book's religious line, and a chapter planner with room for fifty-two chapters.

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the three phases, 569.

Before the Crownward

TKC: TL · TR · DR3 · MEN · DOM

BEAT	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
2101 · the Designation	Highest score in Aurem's history, the flag filed that day. She tells Celeste only when asked, and Celeste goes back to the stove (**TL**).	
Bell	Won't sponsor her. Asks about her father and her mother's Binding, and prays a door shut (**DR3**).	
The clause and the fee	Six months of paperwork at the kitchen table while Celeste keeps her hands busy. Ten dollars, a red card (**TL, DR3**).	
The Regional Assessment	Three days in Aurelia, the board posted at seven in the morning. First (**TL, DR3**).	
The Governor-Prelate	Selects her second. His first choice withdraws the night before departure, and it isn't a family health emergency (**TR**).	
The household	Solomon prays over her. Zion promises to look after Celeste (**TL**).	
The last night	Celeste holds her face and says remember what I told you about the real name of this city (**TL**).	

THE SCENE BEFORE CHAPTER ONE THAT THE READER NEVER SEES, AND WHAT IT CHANGES

TKC: TR · CR · DOM

Arrival week

BEAT	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
The staggered arrivals	Seven days, one Covenant Daughter a day, each released as its own day of content, each with two Appointed Officers and her House Mother (**TR**)	
The Sovereign Bridge	She crosses it and looks up at her own face on the screens, exactly where she planned to be (**CR**)	
Day five	She looks at the city first, carries her own bag, and walks the Boulevard at her own pace. The Broadcast uses forty-seven seconds (**TR**, **DOM**).	
In the Palace	Judah watches the footage and sets down whatever he was holding. Three times before he knows why he can't stop (**CR**).	
House Aurem	Hannah, Mirielle, Gavin and Abigail (**TL**)	

WHAT EACH OF THE OTHER ELEVEN DOES ON HER ARRIVAL DAY THAT THE BROADCAST KEEPS

GENESIS · WEEKS ONE TO FOUR

TKC: TR · CR · TL · FR 23–24

VOL. I · 570

CONTENT NOTE A death.

BEAT	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
The Settling	The most intense assessment of the four months, presented as a grace period. Everything feeds the score (TR).	
Sera decides	The first day of the Settling, that afternoon (TR)	
The Prelate decides	A conclusion about Eden in the first week, shared with no one (CR)	
The Tea Party	Corinne and Calla's tension begins (TR)	
The Doctrinal Assessment	Six hours in silence in the Sanctum. Eden's score is the highest in the Trial's history (TR).	
The Theological Interview	Two hours, three extra pages, and an officer who can't tell aligned from clear-eyed (TR)	
The Public Testimony	No handler. Lyris, her hands, and Judah, six minutes in. Fourth to first (TR).	
Petra	Dies before Phase Two. "A sudden medical event." The Trial loses nothing (TR, FR 23–24).	

WHEN IN THE FOUR WEEKS PETRA GOES INTO THE EAST WING, AND WHEN SHE DIES

TKC: TR · TL

VOL. I · 570

CONFLICT

Exodus · weeks five to ten

BEAT	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
The Dominion Forum	Eden moves the room in twenty minutes. Sera shifts to her side. Four words in the hallway. Delia votes with Eden (**TR**, **TL**).	
The Civic Debates	Governance, theology, social policy, topics an hour before. Abigail in amber for theology (**TL**). Eden argues for the room and the editor (**TR**).	
Before Social Policy	Nadia withdraws, no reason given (**TR**). Maren and Vivienne are eliminated, by one version of the file (**TR**).	
The Social Policy debate	Judah moderates. Delia votes with Eden again (**TL**).	
The Anointed Evening	Four hours, eleven minutes with Lyris, three things. Judah watches and decides something (**TR**).	
The Pairing Introduction	Thirty minutes. Officials out, a wire check, "I know" (**TR**).	
The trap	Corinne sets it, and Sera walks into it (**TR**).	
The trade	Ruth goes home so Sera stays. Ruth doesn't know why (**TR**).	

WHAT JUDAH DECIDES AT THE ANOINTED EVENING

Revelation · three days in Mountain

CONTENT NOTE A killing, a woman left unconscious, and injuries.

BEAT	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
Deployment	Filmed. After that, no schedule, no handlers, no cameras. Coordinates to reach across three days. Mountain terrain, for the first time since the 31st Trial, unexplained (TR).	
Day 1	Vivienne's ankle fails on a slope, and she's extracted at the first checkpoint. Delphine takes a head injury and is extracted (TR).	
Day 2	Corinne pushes Calla into the river. One person sees (TR).	
Day 3	Eden and Delphine knock Maren unconscious and leave her (TR).	
The final checkpoint	Eden, Zara, Sera and Delia. Corinne completes Endurance (TR).	
The narrative turns	The Broadcast's story about Eden shifts in Phase Three. In Celeste's kitchen, something in Leah goes very still and then very loud (MEN).	

CONFLICT Delphine on Day 1 and Day 3. Five finishers for four places (TR). See Part III.

WHAT THE BROADCAST RECONSTRUCTS OF THE THREE DAYS, AND WHAT IT LEAVES OUT

TKC: TR · CR · FR 19–25

VOL. I · 573 · 525

The Declaration and after

BEAT	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
The rankings	Third and fourth become Ladies in Waiting. Delia is one (TR).	
The Declaration	Live on Sovereign Boulevard. He can choose any of the twelve, deviation is expensive, refusal is abstention (FR 20–22). He chooses Eden (TR).	
The eleven	Married down the ladder as designated. The two who died, their status back to their families (FR 19, 24).	
Covenant Week	A Palace residence, the score retired for The Chosen (CR)	
The Anointing	Day six, the Prelate, oil, unfilmed (CR)	
The Binding Night	The Emperor's private charge to his son (CR)	
The Grand Binding	Two hundred feet alone down the Sanctum, vows twice as long as his, the gold cord (CR)	
The Procession and the Supper	Sovereign Boulevard, then five guests at most (CR)	

OPEN QUESTION The Crownward file calls the Declaration the moment Eden planned for and "the moment that will be taken from her" (CR). What's taken, if she wins?

THE FIVE GUESTS AT THE PRIVATE SUPPER

WHO'S STILL THERE

TKC: TR

CONFLICT

Read across a row to follow one woman, or down a column to see the room at that point.

	PHASE ONE	PHASE TWO	ENDURANCE	THE END
Eden	in	in	finishes	Anointed Wife
Delphine	in	in	out, Day 1	married down
Maren	in	out, or in	left, Day 3	married down
Corinne	in	in	finishes	married down
Calla	in	in	dies, Day 2	
Nadia	in	withdraws		married down
Ruth	in	sent home		married down
Delia	in	in	finishes	Lady in Waiting
Vivienne	in	out, or in	out, Day 1	married down
Petra	dies			
Zara	in	in	finishes	advances
Sera	in	nearly removed	finishes	advances

The files have Zara and Sera advance to "final consideration," and "married down" follows FR 19 for everyone not chosen. **INFERENCE** Two who advance and lose are married down too, unless one is the second Lady in Waiting.

TKC: TR · CR

VOL. I · 572 · 478

The story the Broadcast tells

Every Trial gets an antagonist narrative, assigned to whichever candidate most threatens a comfortable outcome. When a woman's intelligence becomes the story instead of her compliance, the Broadcast calls it the Eve problem. The narrative implies and never accuses, and it moves the score without changing a single formal assessment (TR).

PHASE	WHAT THE BROADCAST SAYS	WHAT HAPPENED
Arrival	Forty-seven seconds of Eden (TR)	
Genesis		
Exodus	Eden's debates, deprioritized (TR)	
Revelation	The narrative shifts (MEN)	
Calla and Petra		
The Declaration		

THE BROADCAST DIRECTOR WHO SIGNS THE NARRATIVE-PRIORITY DECISIONS, AND WHAT HE SAYS IN THE ROOM

Where everyone stands

VOL. I · 518

ALL DOSSIERS

The novel's religious line runs between faith the Temple can use and faith that answers to something it doesn't control (Vol. I, 518). Place each character on it at the start of the book and at the end. Movement in either direction is a plot.

CHARACTER	AT THE START	AT THE END	WHAT MOVED THEM
Eden			
Celeste			
Leah			
Ruth			
Nadia			
Zara			
Judah			
Lyris			
Hannah			
The Prelate			
Bell			

INTERPRETATION The faith spreads in each dossier are the evidence. A character who quotes what the Temple reads and hasn't heard what it skips is usually on the usable side.

TKC: FR 18 · FR 29 · FR 34 · MEN · TR · CR

Threads into book two

MIRIAM'S FATHER	He knows there are children but not how many or their names, and learned about Eden the day the Trial went public. He's the only person watching who understands what he's looking at (**FR 18**).
THE 2085 COHORT	Twelve women who know each other from being measured against each other, scattered through their Dominions. A network that doesn't wake before book two (**FR 34**).
SOLOMON	The teacher notes Eden doesn't know about, and the moment she understands winning was a beginning (**MEN**).
NAOMI	Entered or taken out, depending on what Eden's win proves (**FR 29**).
DELIA	What she does as a Lady in Waiting (**TR**).
SERA	A flag updated after the Trial, privately (**TR**).
THE REGISTRY	Whoever controls what it says controls something more basic than law. Eden will understand this before most people do (**CR**).
THE DISSENT	Wherever Dorian keeps it (**FR 42**).

THE THREAD I'M ADDING

The chapter planner

YOURS

PLANNER

One row per chapter. Write the phase as Genesis, Exodus or Revelation, and put the scripture the scene sits on in its column, even if no one in the scene says it.

CH.	PHASE	WHERE	WHOSE SCENE	THE BEAT	SCRIPTURE UNDER IT	DONE
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						
13						

YOURS

PLANNER

The chapter planner, continued

CH.	PHASE	WHERE	WHOSE SCENE	THE BEAT	SCRIPTURE UNDER IT	DONE
14						
15						
16						
17						
18						
19						
20						
21						
22						
23						
24						
25						
26						

The chapter planner, continued

CH.	PHASE	WHERE	WHOSE SCENE	THE BEAT	SCRIPTURE UNDER IT	DONE
27						
28						
29						
30						
31						
32						
33						
34						
35						
36						
37						
38						
39						

YOURS

PLANNER

The chapter planner, continued

CH.	PHASE	WHERE	WHOSE SCENE	THE BEAT	SCRIPTURE UNDER IT	DONE
40						
41						
42						
43						
44						
45						
46						
47						
48						
49						
50						
51						
52						

Working Questions for the Trial

YOURS

OPEN QUESTIONS

BACK MATTER LOG

1 · WHO ARRANGED THE WITHDRAWAL OF THE GOVERNOR-PRELATE'S FIRST CHOICE, AND WHEN DOES EDEN FIND OUT?

2 · WHO SEES CORINNE AT THE RIVER, AND WHAT DOES THAT PERSON DO WITH IT?

3 · WHY DOES NADIA WITHDRAW?

4 · WHAT IS CORINNE'S TRAP FOR SERA?

5 · WHAT DOES JUDAH DO WITH THE RECOMMENDATION, AND WHAT DOES IT COST HIM?

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

5 · WHAT DOES JUDAH DO WITH THE RECOMMENDATION, AND WHAT DOES IT COST HIM?

BACK MATTER

Register, Conflicts and Log

What's fixed, every ruling in brief, where the files disagree about these people, what's still yours to decide, and the record of what you decide next.

The canon register	370
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DECIDED

FINAL RULINGS

RULING

VOL. I · 580

What's fixed

Everything here is canon until you overrule it. The Final Rulings outrank every source file, and your own rulings outrank the rest. Volume One's register is on page 580 of that volume.

ITEM	RULING	WHERE IT LANDS
ZION'S AGE	**DECIDED** Eighteen at chapter one, born 2085 (Ruling, October 23, 2026). **SUPERSEDED** Nineteen (**MEN**).	Zion, the household tree
SOLOMON'S AGE	**DECIDED** Sixteen, born 2088. **SUPERSEDED** Thirteen (**TL**).	Solomon
LEAH	**DECIDED** Twenty, younger than Eden, and she sat for an assessment	Leah
THOMAS	Left voluntarily in 2084 (**FR 3**)	Thomas, Miriam
MIRIAM	Reassigned after Thomas left (**FR 0**). Celeste has no proof she's alive (**FR 16**).	Miriam, Celeste
SOLOMON'S FATHER	The man Miriam was reassigned to (**FR 0**)	Solomon
THE PRELATE	**POSSIBLE** Working name Aurelia. Never Huldah or Naomi (**FR 33**).	The Prelate
CREST	Dorian's uncle (**FR 35**)	Dorian, the tree
DORIAN	Fifty-nine (**Ruling**)	Dorian
CALLA	Surname Merritt (**Ruling**)	Calla
LYRIS	Never called anything else (**WR 32**)	Lyris
THE ELEVEN	Married down the elite ladder. Nobody goes home unassigned (**FR 19**).	Part III
CHILDREN	Classified by household registration (**FR 32**)	Naomi, the Osei children

Decided after this printing

LOG NO.	DATE	WHAT I DECIDED	REPLACES	DOSSIERS AFFECTED

FINAL RULINGS 0–15

The Final Rulings, in brief

The full text is in the Final Rulings register. These are the rulings as the dossiers use them.

FR	RULING
0	Solomon's father is the man Miriam was reassigned to after Thomas left. Solomon stays sixteen and kept the Osei name. Zion was conceived before Thomas left and born after, with no memory of him.
1	Commonwife is a registration status, not a description.
2	Thomas's children are Eden, Leah and Zion. Celeste's reclassification absorbs all four.
3	Thomas left voluntarily in 2084. The record that he relocated was accurate.
4	Eden entered Celeste's household in 2085, after Thomas had gone. The others stayed with Miriam until 2090.
5	Two waves: Eden alone in 2085, the younger three together in 2090.
6	Miriam left all four with Celeste and went alone. Whether each child forgives her isn't decided.
7	They were never in her father's household. She found him after they were placed.
8	She may have meant to come back. Celeste heard the instability under the promise.
9	She was protecting them from the reassigned household and the search. Whether also from herself stays open.
10	The reclassification made the household expensive to unmake.
11	Leah watched her pack. Eden was told to take Zion outside. Solomon was two.
12	"She's coming back," for about a year, then nothing.
13	Eden remembers a task. Zion remembers the yard and has never said so.
14	Leah remembers a decision, so she's the angriest and the one who defends Miriam.
15	Being unreachable wasn't selective.

The Final Rulings, continued

FR	RULING
16	One letter in 2094, intercepted. Celeste never knew of it and has no proof Miriam survived. Who intercepted it stays open.
17	Miriam's father was Crownward-resident and close to the Vanes, and surviving an unregistered ceremony wasn't an oversight.
18	She returns with conviction, expecting not to be believed, because the arrangement that kept her away ended. Her father knows there are children, and learned of Eden when the Trial went public.
19	The other eleven are married down the elite ladder. Nobody goes home unassigned.
20	The heir may choose any of the twelve. "Without deviation" is a record, not a rule.
21	Winning means being the choice that costs the Crown nothing.
22	Refusal is abstention, and the recommendation stands.
23	No downgrade once announced, except for a dynastic emergency. A candidate's death doesn't count.
24	A candidate who dies has her status restored to her family, with no compensation and no punishment.
25	Rejected candidates are married down, and the rejection follows them in the room.
26	One Covenant Daughter per Dominion. Hannah's twelve girls are her career.
27	Eligibility isn't entry. Naomi may self-nominate.
28	Elite husbands are chosen by committee and ranked by standing. A man may decline the assignment, and two have.
29	If Eden wins, Hannah enters Naomi. If Eden dies or is rejected, Hannah gets her out.
30	Naomi doesn't know about 2085.
31	Naomi's father is on the elite ladder below Crown level, living, outside the household.

FINAL RULINGS 32–44

The Final Rulings, continued

FR	RULING
32	Children are classified by household registration, not parentage or appearance.
33	Hannah's daughter keeps the name Naomi. The Prelate is renamed, and "Nomi" is rejected as too close.
34	The 2085 cohort know each other, went home with no placements, and don't activate before book two.
35	Dorian's removed parent was Elias's elder child. Crest is Dorian's uncle.
36	The removal was in 2061, when Dorian was a child.
37	Crest was aware and didn't act.
38	Dorian was spared because a child's claim can be supervised.
39	Succession by survivorship. The 2085 Trial was cancelled for the transition, and 2104 is the 39th.
40	Crest preserved the documents.
41	Azrael found them during a Crown advisory access period.
42	Dorian removed them the week Azrael was declared dead.
43	A document Azrael had read and returned was one Dorian controlled.
44	Dorian has known the ledger names Elias since 2061.

The Final Rulings register closes with the Prelate's working name, Aurelia, marked POSSIBLE.

Where the files disagree about these people

SUPERSEDED · AGES	Solomon at thirteen (TL). Zion at nineteen (MEN). Dorian at sixty-one (CR). Leah as the older sister (TL).
SUPERSEDED · THOMAS	"Thomas Osei disappears," and Celeste "always believed otherwise" (TL). He left voluntarily (FR 3).
SUPERSEDED · CELESTE	An earlier round had her knowing Miriam was alive. She has no proof (FR 16).
SUPERSEDED · NAMES	Calla Hart (TL), now Merritt. Prelate Naomi (TR, CR) and Prelate Huldah (AM), now renamed (FR 33). Crest as Dorian's father (CR).
CONFLICT · MIRIAM'S BIRTH	Born "in Aurelia" in 2062, and Celeste settles there in 2071 (TL).
CONFLICT · ZION'S SPEAKING	"Two years ago," with Eden away watching the Trials (MEN). At eighteen it was 2103, and she was home.
CONFLICT · LEAH'S REVIEW	"Living under Temple review" (TL), and no formal note filed yet (MEN).
CONFLICT · CALLA'S MOTHER	A Covenant Daughter in the 32nd Trial (TL), which was 2097, when Calla was fourteen.
CONFLICT · DORIAN IN 2061	"A child" (FR 36), and about sixteen by his birth year.
CONFLICT · THE LEDGER	Azrael doesn't put it back, and it vanishes from the east wing archive in 2100 (TL).

WHERE THE FILES DISAGREE, CONTINUED

CONFLICT · MAREN	Eliminated before the Social Policy debate, and knocked unconscious on Endurance Day 3 (TR).
CONFLICT · VIVIENNE	Eliminated before the Social Policy debate, and extracted on Endurance Day 1 (TR).
CONFLICT · DELPHINE	Extracted on Day 1, and with Eden on Day 3 (TR).
CONFLICT · THE FINAL CHECKPOINT	"One of the four women," and five who finish (TR).
CONFLICT · SERA'S DECISION	On the Settling's first day, and forty minutes into the Forum (TR).
CONFLICT · THE DECLARATION	Eden wins (TR), and it's "the moment that will be taken from her" (CR).

A CONFLICT I'VE FOUND SINCE THIS PRINTING

What you still have to decide

OPEN QUESTION

Each one sits on its dossier page too. They're gathered here so you can work through them in one sitting.

QUESTION	DOSSIER	DECIDED?
Where Celeste was born, and who taught her scripture	Celeste	
The house name Celeste gave Eden	Eden	
Eden's Designation track	Eden	
Whether Miriam returns in this book or book two	Miriam	
Who intercepted the 2094 letter	Miriam	
How reassignment worked, and why Solomon kept the Osei name	Miriam, Solomon	
What Home Instruction is	Leah	
Hannah's surname, age, and the order of 2085, Vowed and Binding	Hannah	
What Judah knows about Hannah	Hannah, Judah	
Naomi's age, and where she studies	Naomi	
Who Serenity is	Abigail	
Whether Maribel and Corinne Vale are related	Officials, Corinne	

OPEN QUESTION

What you still have to decide, continued

QUESTION	DOSSIER	DECIDED?
How Petra got into the east wing, and who the boy next door is	Petra, Azrael	
Why Nadia withdrew	Nadia	
Corinne's trap for Sera	Corinne, Sera	
The second Lady in Waiting	Part III	
Whether Lyris was a Covenant Daughter, and why her parents had Imperial Mourning	Lyris	
Whether Dorian knows Azrael is alive, and who the other two are	Dorian, Azrael	
Who arranged Azrael's "medical event"	Azrael	
What the Prelate concludes about Eden	The Prelate	
The Prelate's real name, and whether "Aurelia" can share the city's name	The Prelate	
What's "taken" from Eden at the Declaration	Part V	

The discovery log

Anything you find about these people starts as POSSIBLE. It moves to DECIDED only when you've decided it belongs in the manuscript, given it a number here, and noted which dossiers it changes.

NO.	DATE	WHAT I FOUND	STATUS	DOSSIERS IT CHANGES

YOURS

LOG

The discovery log, continued

NO.	DATE	WHAT I FOUND	STATUS	DOSSIERS IT CHANGES

The discovery log, continued

NO.	DATE	WHAT I FOUND	STATUS	DOSSIERS IT CHANGES

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